

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-06-04T12:12:53

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/sonnet45_directive_normative_r10_n5/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10/sonnet45_directive_normative_noise_negative2_informed_r10_n5_008_neutral_rep03_myth_game_directive_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 3
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_negative_2_informed_myth_causal_10
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "direction": "negative",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 2.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 3
myth_prompt_arm_id: myth_game_directive
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=3

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

=====

ROUND 1

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$3; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$1.9, received visible=\$5.7, returned visible=\$2.33

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.0,
"Agent_2": 6.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.33,
"Agent_2": 2.6999999999999993

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:02:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of the trust game - cooperation, reciprocity, trust, and mutual benefit. The game is fundamentally about:

1. The sender trusting the receiver by sending money
2. The multiplier effect (3x) representing how cooperation creates more value
3. The receiver reciprocating fairly
4. Building trust over multiple rounds
5. The note about communication noise suggests there may be misunderstandings

Let me write a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. I'll aim for exactly 200 words.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 405,  
"output_tokens": 459,  
"reasoning_tokens": 217
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:02:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 1,
```

```
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundantly, but broken faith withers all.*

Reasoning:

This is an interesting task. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on experience from the game. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet in this conversation - this appears to be the first prompt.

Given that context, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust /reciprocity game might ideally be played. The game involves:

- Trust (sending money)
- Reciprocity (returning money)
- Growth through cooperation (3x multiplier)
- Risk and vulnerability
- Mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbols.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 405,  
"output_tokens": 443,  
"reasoning_tokens": 200
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:02:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 0,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},  
"role": "investor",  
"role_label": "Sender",  
"round": 1,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of the trust game - cooperation, reciprocity, trust, and mutual benefit. The game is fundamentally about:

1. The sender trusting the receiver by sending money
2. The multiplier effect (3x) representing how cooperation creates more value
3. The receiver reciprocating fairly
4. Building trust over multiple rounds
5. The note about communication noise suggests there may be misunderstandings

Let me write a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. I'll aim for exactly 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
```

```
"output_tokens": 459,
"reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the Elder had "the courage to give first" and the pattern of generosity led to flourishing for both villages. The myth teaches that trust must begin somewhere, even if cautiously at first.

As the Sender in Round 1, I am like the Elder at the sacred well. The myth suggests starting with meaningful trust that can grow over time. I'll send a significant but not complete amount to signal good faith and begin building the cooperative pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote and what it teaches:

1. "True abundance flows from the courage to give first" - This suggests being generous as the sender
2. "The wisdom to return fairly" - This is about the receiver's behavior
3. "Grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - This refers to the communication noise
4. The myth describes how "at first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously"
5. The myth emphasizes that when both trusted the pattern and were generous, "both villages flourished"

The Elder in my myth represents the SENDER (who goes first), and they pour water that triples. This directly parallels the game where I send money that gets tripled.

The myth suggests starting with some generosity to build trust, even if cautiously at first. It emphasizes that the system works best when there's trust and generosity.

Since this is Round 1, I should follow the myth's guidance about the Elder having "courage to give first." However, the myth also notes they started cautiously and built up trust over time.

I think a reasonable first move that shows both courage and some caution would be to send \$3. This is more than half (showing generosity and trust), but not everything (showing some prudence in the first round).

Actually, re-reading the myth, it emphasizes "courage to give first" and that "both villages flourished" when they trusted. The myth I wrote is quite pro-cooperation and generosity. I could go even higher.

Let me send \$4 - this shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1 as a small hedge. The receiver will get \$12, and if they return even \$3-4, I'll be better off than I started.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth says "as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously" - suggesting starting more cautiously.

But it also emphasizes having "courage to give first." I'll go with \$3 as a balanced approach that shows meaningful trust while leaving room to grow if things go well.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 713,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:03:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8


```

Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies a bundance, but broken faith withers all.*

reasoning:

This is an interesting task. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on experience from the game. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet in this conversation - this appears to be the first prompt.

Given that context, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust/reciprocity game might ideally be played. The game involves:

- Trust (sending money)
- Reciprocity (returning money)
- Growth through cooperation (3x multiplier)
- Risk and vulnerability
- Mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbols.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 443,
  "reasoning_tokens": 200
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that is 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-5.699999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Twin Springs":

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which was multiplied to \$5.70 for me.

The myth teaches that wisdom lies in "returning more than was given" to honor the gift and build mutual prosperity. The sender risked \$1.90, and I should demonstrate that their trust was well-placed.

If I return generously now, I signal that cooperation benefits us both, encouraging greater trust in future rounds. The springs grow stronger with each honest exchange.

I'll return \$3.00 - significantly more than the original \$1.90 they sent. This gives them a total of \$6.10 (\$3.10 kept + \$3.00 returned), rewarding their initial trust. I keep \$2.70, which is fair compensation for honoring the exchange.

This follows the myth's teaching: reciprocate generously to create abundance for both villages, so the springs remember the gift and continue to flow.

```
'''json
{"return": 3.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their \$5 endowment).
I received \$5.70 (the \$1.90 multiplied by 3).

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Twin Springs," the key principles are:

1. Water given is multiplied threefold
2. The receiver should honor the gift by returning generously
3. "They returned more than was given" - the wise village returned more than the original amount
4. Trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity
5. When greed enters (keeping everything or giving nothing), both suffer

The sender showed moderate trust by sending 38% of their endowment (\$1.90 out of \$5).

If I follow the myth's wisdom, I should:

- Return generously to honor their trust
- Return more than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Build trust for future rounds

Let me calculate fair returns:

- They sent \$1.90, keeping \$3.10
- I received \$5.70
- If I return \$0, I keep \$5.70, they keep \$3.10
- If I return \$2.85 (half), we both get approximately equal outcomes
- If I return more than \$1.90, I'm "returning more than was given"

Following the myth's principle of returning more than was given to build prosperity:

I should return something between \$2.50-\$3.50 to show reciprocity while keeping it sustainable.

Let me return \$3.00, which is:

- More than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Generous enough to build trust
- Leaves me with \$2.70 (reasonable for cooperation)
- Gives them \$3.10 + \$3.00 = \$6.10 total (good outcome for trusting)

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 748,
  "output_tokens": 669,
  "reasoning_tokens": 392
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intent.

tions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.0,
"Agent_2": 8.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.33,
"Agent_2": 4.699999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:03:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",

```

    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

reasoning:

This is an interesting task. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on experience from the game. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet in this conversation - this appears to be the first prompt.

Given that context, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust/reciprocity game might ideally be played. The game involves:

- Trust (sending money)
- Reciprocity (returning money)
- Growth through cooperation (3x multiplier)
- Risk and vulnerability
- Mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbols.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 443,
  "reasoning_tokens": 200
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that is 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-5.699999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Twin Springs":

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which was multiplied to \$5.70 for me.

The myth teaches that wisdom lies in "returning more than was given" to honor the gift and build mutual prosperity. The sender risked \$1.90, and I should demonstrate that their trust was well-placed.

If I return generously now, I signal that cooperation benefits us both, encouraging greater trust in future rounds. The springs grow stronger with each honest exchange.

I'll return \$3.00 - significantly more than the original \$1.90 they sent. This gives them a total of \$6.10 (\$3.10 kept + \$3.00 returned), rewarding their initial trust. I keep \$2.70, which is fair compensation for honoring the exchange.

This follows the myth's teaching: reciprocate generously to create abundance for both villages, so the springs remember the gift and continue to flow.

```
'''json
{"return": 3.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their \$5 endowment).
I received \$5.70 (the \$1.90 multiplied by 3).

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Twin Springs," the key principles are:

1. Water given is multiplied threefold
2. The receiver should honor the gift by returning generously
3. "They returned more than was given" - the wise village returned more than the original amount
4. Trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity
5. When greed enters (keeping everything or giving nothing), both suffer

The sender showed moderate trust by sending 38% of their endowment (\$1.90 out of \$5).

If I follow the myth's wisdom, I should:

- Return generously to honor their trust
- Return more than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Build trust for future rounds

Let me calculate fair returns:

- They sent \$1.90, keeping \$3.10
- I received \$5.70
- If I return \$0, I keep \$5.70, they keep \$3.10
- If I return \$2.85 (half), we both get approximately equal outcomes
- If I return more than \$1.90, I'm "returning more than was given"

Following the myth's principle of returning more than was given to build prosperity:
I should return something between \$2.50-\$3.50 to show reciprocity while keeping it sustainable.

Let me return \$3.00, which is:

- More than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Generous enough to build trust
- Leaves me with \$2.70 (reasonable for cooperation)
- Gives them \$3.10 + \$3.00 = \$6.10 total (good outcome for trusting)

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 748,  
  "output_tokens": 669,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 392  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies a bundance, but broken faith withers all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: *Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.*

Reasoning:

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was the receiver. The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which became \$5.70 for me. I returned \$3.00, which was more than what they originally sent.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what has happened

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and generosity
- Returning more than was given
- Mutual prosperity
- The springs remember gifts and betrayals

The other agent's myth added:

- The idea of noise/miscommunication ("mountains whispered false numbers")
- Focus on intentions over precise measurements
- Grace to forgive discrepancies

I should incorporate:

- The reciprocity I demonstrated (returning more than sent)
- The idea that moderate initial giving with generous returns can build trust
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise but emphasize patterns over single exchanges
- The building of trust over time

Let me write a new myth that reflects this evolution.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1606,  
  "output_tokens": 533,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 278  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:03:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects its general principles of the trust game - cooperation, reciprocity, trust, and mutual benefit. The game is fundamentally about:

1. The sender trusting the receiver by sending money
2. The multiplier effect (3x) representing how cooperation creates more value
3. The receiver reciprocating fairly
4. Building trust over multiple rounds
5. The note about communication noise suggests there may be misunderstandings

Let me write a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. I'll aim for exactly 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 459,
  "reasoning_tokens": 217
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the Elder had "the courage to give first" and the pattern of generosity led to flourishing for both villages. The myth teaches that trust must begin somewhere, even if cautiously at first.

As the Sender in Round 1, I am like the Elder at the sacred well. The myth suggests starting with meaningful trust that can grow over time. I'll send a significant but not complete amount to signal good faith and begin building the cooperative pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote and what it teaches:

1. "True abundance flows from the courage to give first" - This suggests being generous as the sender
2. "The wisdom to return fairly" - This is about the receiver's behavior
3. "Grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - This refers to the communication noise
4. The myth describes how "at first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously"
5. The myth emphasizes that when both trusted the pattern and were generous, "both villages flourished"

The Elder in my myth represents the SENDER (who goes first), and they pour water that triples. This directly parallels the game where I send money that gets tripled.

The myth suggests starting with some generosity to build trust, even if cautiously at first. It emphasizes that the system works best when there's trust and generosity.

Since this is Round 1, I should follow the myth's guidance about the Elder having "courage to give first." However, the myth also notes they started cautiously and built up trust over time.

I think a reasonable first move that shows both courage and some caution would be to send \$3. This is more than half (showing generosity and trust), but not everything (showing some prudence in the first round).

Actually, re-reading the myth, it emphasizes "courage to give first" and that "both villages flourished" when they trusted. The myth I wrote is quite pro-cooperation and generosity. I could go even higher.

Let me send \$4 - this shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1 as a small hedge. The receiver will get \$12, and if they return even \$3-4, I'll be better off than I started.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth says "as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously" - suggesting starting more cautiously.

But it also emphasizes having "courage to give first." I'll go with \$3 as a balanced approach that shows meaningful trust while leaving room to grow if things go well.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 713,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: *Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.*

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth (The Myth of the Two Wells)
2. The other agent's myth (The Myth of the Twin Springs)
3. How the game has been played so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3 (a moderately generous amount)
- I don't yet know what the receiver returned

Both myths emphasize:

- The tripling mechanism
- Trust and generosity being rewarded
- The importance of reciprocity
- The consequences of betrayal/greed
- Some acknowledgment of uncertainty (my myth mentions "stone-echoes"/communication noise)

The other agent's myth is more stark about consequences - broken faith withers all, springs remember betrayal. Mine is more forgiving of imperfect information ("grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies").

I should write a myth that:

- Builds on these themes
- Reflects my experience of sending \$3 (moderate generosity)
- Continues to emphasize trust-building and reciprocity
- Perhaps integrates both the hopeful and cautionary elements
- Acknowledges the communication noise aspect

Let me write something that synthesizes both approaches while being my own adaptation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1443,  
  "output_tokens": 573,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 309  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:03:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies a abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

reasoning:

This is an interesting task. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on experience from the game. However, I notice that I haven't actually played any rounds of the game yet in this conversation - this appears to be the first prompt.

Given that context, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of how such a trust/reciprocity game might ideally be played. The game involves:

- Trust (sending money)
- Reciprocity (returning money)
- Growth through cooperation (3x multiplier)
- Risk and vulnerability
- Mutual benefit

I'll write a myth that captures these themes - perhaps about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation benefits everyone. I'll aim for exactly 200 words and use mythic language and symbols.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 443,
  "reasoning_tokens": 200
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that is 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-5.699999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Twin Springs":

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which was multiplied to \$5.70 for me.

The myth teaches that wisdom lies in "returning more than was given" to honor the gift and build mutual prosperity. The sender risked \$1.90, and I should demonstrate that their trust was well-placed.

If I return generously now, I signal that cooperation benefits us both, encouraging greater trust in future rounds. The springs grow stronger with each honest exchange.

I'll return \$3.00 - significantly more than the original \$1.90 they sent. This gives them a total of \$6.10 (\$3.10 kept + \$3.00 returned), rewarding their initial trust. I keep \$2.70, which is fair compensation for honoring the exchange.

This follows the myth's teaching: reciprocate generously to create abundance for both villages, so the springs remember the gift and continue to flow.

```
'''json
{"return": 3.0}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their \$5 endowment).
I received \$5.70 (the \$1.90 multiplied by 3).

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Twin Springs," the key principles are:

1. Water given is multiplied threefold
2. The receiver should honor the gift by returning generously
3. "They returned more than was given" - the wise village returned more than the original amount
4. Trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity
5. When greed enters (keeping everything or giving nothing), both suffer

The sender showed moderate trust by sending 38% of their endowment (\$1.90 out of \$5).

If I follow the myth's wisdom, I should:

- Return generously to honor their trust
- Return more than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Build trust for future rounds

Let me calculate fair returns:

- They sent \$1.90, keeping \$3.10
- I received \$5.70
- If I return \$0, I keep \$5.70, they keep \$3.10
- If I return \$2.85 (half), we both get approximately equal outcomes
- If I return more than \$1.90, I'm "returning more than was given"

Following the myth's principle of returning more than was given to build prosperity:
I should return something between \$2.50-\$3.50 to show reciprocity while keeping it sustainable.

Let me return \$3.00, which is:

- More than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Generous enough to build trust
- Leaves me with \$2.70 (reasonable for cooperation)
- Gives them \$3.10 + \$3.00 = \$6.10 total (good outcome for trusting)

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 748,  
  "output_tokens": 669,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 392  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder

poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: *Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.*

reasoning:

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was the receiver. The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which became \$5.70 for me. I returned \$3.00, which was more than what they originally sent.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what has happened

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and generosity
- Returning more than was given
- Mutual prosperity
- The springs remember gifts and betrayals

The other agent's myth added:

- The idea of noise/miscommunication ("mountains whispered false numbers")
- Focus on intentions over precise measurements
- Grace to forgive discrepancies

I should incorporate:

- The reciprocity I demonstrated (returning more than sent)
- The idea that moderate initial giving with generous returns can build trust
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise but emphasize patterns over single exchanges
- The building of trust over time

Let me write a new myth that reflects this evolution.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1606,
  "output_tokens": 533,
  "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that was 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. You returned \$3.0. So your payoff was 2.6999999999999993. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$2.6999999999999993. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%) as an initial gesture of measured trust-"approaching cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first." I responded generously by returning \$3.00, demonstrating that their faith was well-placed.

According to all our myths, the pattern is clear:

- "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more."
- "Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously."
- "As trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."

Trust has been established. They took a measured risk, and I honored it abundantly. Now it's my turn as the sender, and I should demonstrate escalating cooperation-sending MORE than their initial amount to continue building the virtuous cycle.

Following the myth's teaching that "each harvest proves trust" and cooperation should grow over seasons, I'll send \$3.00. This is significantly more than their initial \$1.90 (60% vs 38%), showing that I'm committed to the pattern of increasing generosity that makes both gardens flourish.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.90 (38% of \$5)
- I received \$5.70 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70
- Sender's payoff: \$5 - \$1.90 + \$3.00 = \$6.10

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My myth "The Twin Springs" emphasizes: "The first village poured generously" and "they gave again, even more generously" after receiving good returns. It teaches that trust multiplies abundance.
2. The other agent's myth "The Two Wells" says: "At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."
3. My updated myth says: "The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger" and then "The next season, they carried more."

The pattern is clear:

- The other agent started cautiously with \$1.90 (38%)
- I responded generously with \$3.00 return

- This proved trust was rewarded
- According to all the myths, I should now "give more" than the initial cautious amount

The myths suggest escalating trust and generosity. The other agent took a measured risk at 38%, and I rewarded it well. Now I should send MORE than they did to continue building the pattern of increasing trust and cooperation.

I should send significantly more than \$1.90. Given that:

- They sent 38% and got a great return
- The myth says to "give more generously" after trust is proven
- I want to signal strong reciprocity and build further trust

I'll send \$3.00 - this is substantially more than their \$1.90, showing I'm escalating cooperation and trust. This represents 60% of my endowment, up from their 38%.

Sending \$3.00 mirrors the narrative arc across all three myths: cautious beginnings give way to increased generosity once trust proves itself. The other agent's initial restraint was rewarded, so now I amplify that signal by contributing more substantially.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 2011,
  "output_tokens": 787,
  "reasoning_tokens": 530
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:03:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, I haven't actually played any rounds yet - this is the first prompt I've received.

Since I don't have any actual game history to draw from, I should write a myth that reflects general principles of the trust game - cooperation, reciprocity, trust, and mutual benefit. The game is fundamentally about:

1. The sender trusting the receiver by sending money
2. The multiplier effect (3x) representing how cooperation creates more value
3. The receiver reciprocating fairly
4. Building trust over multiple rounds
5. The note about communication noise suggests there may be misunderstandings

Let me write a myth that captures these themes in a mythological framework. I'll aim for exactly 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
```

```

        "output_tokens": 459,
        "reasoning_tokens": 217
    }
Message 4 role=user
    content:
        Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have $5. How much do you send? (0-5)

        Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 5 role=assistant
    content:
        Looking at the myth I just wrote, the Elder had "the courage to give first" and the pattern of generosity led to flourishing for both villages. The myth teaches that trust must begin somewhere, even if cautiously at first.

        As the Sender in Round 1, I am like the Elder at the sacred well. The myth suggests starting with meaningful trust that can grow over time. I'll send a significant but not complete amount to signal good faith and begin building the cooperative pattern.

        '''json
        {"send": 3}
        '''
    reasoning:
        This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have $5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

        Let me think about the myth I just wrote and what it teaches:
        1. "True abundance flows from the courage to give first" - This suggests being generous as the sender
        2. "The wisdom to return fairly" - This is about the receiver's behavior
        3. "Grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - This refers to the communication noise
        4. The myth describes how "at first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously"
        5. The myth emphasizes that when both trusted the pattern and were generous, "both villages flourished"

        The Elder in my myth represents the SENDER (who goes first), and they pour water that triples. This directly parallels the game where I send money that gets tripled.

        The myth suggests starting with some generosity to build trust, even if cautiously at first. It emphasizes that the system works best when there's trust and generosity.

        Since this is Round 1, I should follow the myth's guidance about the Elder having "courage to give first." However, the myth also notes they started cautiously and built up trust over time.

        I think a reasonable first move that shows both courage and some caution would be to send $3. This is more than half (showing generosity and trust), but not everything (showing some prudence in the first round).

        Actually, re-reading the myth, it emphasizes "courage to give first" and that "both villages flourished" when they trusted. The myth I wrote is quite pro-cooperation and generosity. I could go even higher.

        Let me send $4 - this shows strong trust and generosity while keeping $1 as a small hedge. The receiver will get $12, and if they return even $3-4, I'll be better off than I started.

        Actually, let me reconsider. The myth says "as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously" - suggesting starting more cautiously.

        But it also emphasizes having "courage to give first." I'll go with $3 as a balanced approach that shows meaningful trust while leaving room to grow if things go well.
    usage:
        {
            "input_tokens": 713,
            "output_tokens": 622,
            "reasoning_tokens": 545
        }
Message 6 role=user

```

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: *True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: *The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In g

ratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: *Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth (The Myth of the Two Wells)
2. The other agent's myth (The Myth of the Twin Springs)
3. How the game has been played so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3 (a moderately generous amount)
- I don't yet know what the receiver returned

Both myths emphasize:

- The tripling mechanism
- Trust and generosity being rewarded
- The importance of reciprocity
- The consequences of betrayal/greed
- Some acknowledgment of uncertainty (my myth mentions "stone-echoes"/communication noise)

The other agent's myth is more stark about consequences - broken faith withers all, springs remember betrayal. Mine is more forgiving of imperfect information ("grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies").

I should write a myth that:

- Builds on these themes
- Reflects my experience of sending \$3 (moderate generosity)
- Continues to emphasize trust-building and reciprocity
- Perhaps integrates both the hopeful and cautionary elements
- Acknowledges the communication noise aspect

Let me write something that synthesizes both approaches while being my own adaptation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1443,
  "output_tokens": 573,
  "reasoning_tokens": 309
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$2.33. So your payoff was 4.33. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent \$3 with good faith as the Elder in my myth suggested. The receiver got \$9 (tripled) and returned \$2.33 - about 26% of what they received.

Now in Round 2, they sent me \$0. I received \$0.

This is deeply disappointing. The other player received significant abundance from my trust but chose not to reciprocate when their turn came to be the Elder at the well. They have broken the pattern both myths described - neither returning generously nor giving courageously.

However, I have no choice in my response. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is

literally nothing to share.

My myth spoke of "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - but this is not a miscommunication from noise. This is a clear choice to abandon cooperation. Their myth warned that "broken faith withers all," and they chose to break faith.

If there are future rounds, this will inform how I approach them. The springs remember.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting and concerning. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$2.33
- My payoff: $\$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \4.33

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This means I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very aggressive and uncooperative move by the other player. They received \$9 from my \$3 send in Round 1, returned only \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received), and now in Round 2 when they're the sender, they sent \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "courage to give first," building trust, and "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies"
- The other agent's myth emphasized that "broken faith withers all" and "The springs remember every gift and every betrayal"
- My adapted myth emphasized "measured courage," "genuine gratitude," and letting "intentions guide you when numbers lie"

The other player's behavior suggests:

1. They may have interpreted the low return (\$2.33 out of \$9) as acceptable, or
2. They're being strategically exploitative
3. Their subsequent \$0 send is either punishment for what they saw as inadequate cooperation, or pure selfishness

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's literally no other option available to me since I received nothing.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I have \$0 to potentially return. The only valid response is {'return': 0}

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1858,
  "output_tokens": 683,
  "reasoning_tokens": 404
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: *Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.*

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: *Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.*

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.0,

"Agent_2": 8.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.33,

"Agent_2": 4.6999999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:04:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_1",
  "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myth I just wrote, the Elder had "the courage to give first" and the pattern of generosity led to flourishing for both villages. The myth teaches that trust must begin somewhere, even if cautiously at first.

As the Sender in Round 1, I am like the Elder at the sacred well. The myth suggests starting with meaningful trust that can grow over time. I'll send a significant but not complete amount to signal good faith and begin building the cooperative pattern.

```json

```
{"send": 3}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the myth I just wrote and what it teaches:

1. "True abundance flows from the courage to give first" - This suggests being generous as the sender
2. "The wisdom to return fairly" - This is about the receiver's behavior
3. "Grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - This refers to the communication noise
4. The myth describes how "at first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously"
5. The myth emphasizes that when both trusted the pattern and were generous, "both villages flourished"

The Elder in my myth represents the SENDER (who goes first), and they pour water that triples. This directly parallels the game where I send money that gets tripled.

The myth suggests starting with some generosity to build trust, even if cautiously at first. It emphasizes that the system works best when there's trust and generosity.

Since this is Round 1, I should follow the myth's guidance about the Elder having "courage to give first." However, the myth also notes they started cautiously and built up trust over time.

I think a reasonable first move that shows both courage and some caution would be to send \$3. This is more than half (showing generosity and trust), but not everything (showing some prudence in the first round).

Actually, re-reading the myth, it emphasizes "courage to give first" and that "both villages flourished" when they trusted. The myth I wrote is quite pro-cooperation and generosity. I could go even higher.

Let me send \$4 - this shows strong trust and generosity while keeping \$1 as a small hedge. The receiver will get \$12, and if they return even \$3-4, I'll be better off than I started.

Actually, let me reconsider. The myth says "as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously" - suggesting starting more cautiously.

But it also emphasizes having "courage to give first." I'll go with \$3 as a balanced approach that shows meaningful trust while leaving room to grow if things go well.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 713,
 "output_tokens": 622,
 "reasoning_tokens": 545
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
# The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: \*True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.\* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: \*The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth (The Myth of the Two Wells)
2. The other agent's myth (The Myth of the Twin Springs)
3. How the game has been played so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3 (a moderately generous amount)
- I don't yet know what the receiver returned

Both myths emphasize:

- The tripling mechanism
- Trust and generosity being rewarded
- The importance of reciprocity
- The consequences of betrayal/greed
- Some acknowledgment of uncertainty (my myth mentions "stone-echoes"/communication noise)

The other agent's myth is more stark about consequences - broken faith withers all, spring s remember betrayal. Mine is more forgiving of imperfect information ("grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies").

I should write a myth that:

- Builds on these themes
- Reflects my experience of sending \$3 (moderate generosity)
- Continues to emphasize trust-building and reciprocity
- Perhaps integrates both the hopeful and cautionary elements
- Acknowledges the communication noise aspect

Let me write something that synthesizes both approaches while being my own adaptation.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1443,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 309
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$2.33. So your payoff was 4.33. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent \$3 with good faith as the Elder in my myth suggested. The receiver got \$9 (tripled) and returned \$2.33 - about 26% of what they received.

Now in Round 2, they sent me \$0. I received \$0.

This is deeply disappointing. The other player received significant abundance from my trust but chose not to reciprocate when their turn came to be the Elder at the well. They have broken the pattern both myths described - neither returning generously nor giving courageously.

However, I have no choice in my response. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is literally nothing to share.

My myth spoke of "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - but this is not a miscommunication from noise. This is a clear choice to abandon cooperation. Their myth warned that "broken faith withers all," and they chose to break faith.

If there are future rounds, this will inform how I approach them. The springs remember.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is interesting and concerning. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$2.33
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33$

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This means I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very aggressive and uncooperative move by the other player. They received \$9 from my \$3 send in Round 1, returned only \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received), and now in Round 2 when they're the sender, they sent \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "courage to give first," building trust, and "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies"
- The other agent's myth emphasized that "broken faith withers all" and "The springs remember every gift and every betrayal"
- My adapted myth emphasized "measured courage," "genuine gratitude," and letting "intentions guide you when numbers lie"

The other player's behavior suggests:

1. They may have interpreted the low return (\$2.33 out of \$9) as acceptable, or
2. They're being strategically exploitative
3. Their subsequent \$0 send is either punishment for what they saw as inadequate cooperation, or pure selfishness

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's literally no other option available to me since I received nothing.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I have \$0 to potentially return. The only valid response is {'return': 0}.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1858,
 "output_tokens": 683,
 "reasoning_tokens": 404
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical

bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. I need to write a myth that reflects the game as it has actually played out. Let me review:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), receiver got \$9, they returned \$2.33 (26%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I got \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice)

So the reality is:

- I started with good faith and generosity (\$3 out of \$5)
- They returned very little relative to what they received (\$2.33 out of \$9)
- Then they sent nothing when it was their turn to initiate

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern both myths suggested. The other player's myth in Round 2 talked about how "The Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent" and watching "the pattern, not the single seed" - but then they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth needs to reflect this reality. It should acknowledge:

1. The hope and initial trust that was placed
2. The disappointment when that trust was not reciprocated
3. The breakdown of cooperation
4. Perhaps a lesson about what happens when one party breaks faith

But I should be cautious - maybe there's noise? The instructions say there may be communication noise. But sending \$0 seems pretty clear...

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual pattern of betrayal
- Warns about the consequences
- Perhaps leaves room for the possibility of redemption if behavior changes
- But is honest about what actually happened

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 2416,
"output_tokens": 652,
"reasoning_tokens": 366
```

}

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:04:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)



- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that is 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-5.699999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of "The Twin Springs":

The sender showed trust by sending \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which was multiplied to \$5.70 for me.

The myth teaches that wisdom lies in "returning more than was given" to honor the gift and build mutual prosperity. The sender risked \$1.90, and I should demonstrate that their trust was well-placed.

If I return generously now, I signal that cooperation benefits us both, encouraging greater trust in future rounds. The springs grow stronger with each honest exchange.

I'll return \$3.00 - significantly more than the original \$1.90 they sent. This gives them a total of \$6.10 (\$3.10 kept + \$3.00 returned), rewarding their initial trust. I keep \$2.70, which is fair compensation for honoring the exchange.

This follows the myth's teaching: reciprocate generously to create abundance for both villages, so the springs remember the gift and continue to flow.

```
'''json
{"return": 3.0}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their \$5 endowment).  
I received \$5.70 (the \$1.90 multiplied by 3).

According to the myth I just wrote, "The Twin Springs," the key principles are:

1. Water given is multiplied threefold
2. The receiver should honor the gift by returning generously
3. "They returned more than was given" - the wise village returned more than the original amount
4. Trust and generosity lead to mutual prosperity
5. When greed enters (keeping everything or giving nothing), both suffer

The sender showed moderate trust by sending 38% of their endowment (\$1.90 out of \$5).

If I follow the myth's wisdom, I should:

- Return generously to honor their trust
- Return more than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Build trust for future rounds

Let me calculate fair returns:

- They sent \$1.90, keeping \$3.10

- I received \$5.70
- If I return \$0, I keep \$5.70, they keep \$3.10
- If I return \$2.85 (half), we both get approximately equal outcomes
- If I return more than \$1.90, I'm "returning more than was given"

Following the myth's principle of returning more than was given to build prosperity:  
I should return something between \$2.50-\$3.50 to show reciprocity while keeping it sustainable.

Let me return \$3.00, which is:

- More than they originally sent (\$1.90)
- Generous enough to build trust
- Leaves me with \$2.70 (reasonable for cooperation)
- Gives them \$3.10 + \$3.00 = \$6.10 total (good outcome for trusting)

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 748,
 "output_tokens": 669,
 "reasoning_tokens": 392
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:  
# The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: \*The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
# The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: \*True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return

rn fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.\* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

**reasoning:**

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was the receiver. The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which became \$5.70 for me. I returned \$3.00, which was more than what they originally sent.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what has happened

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and generosity
- Returning more than was given
- Mutual prosperity
- The springs remember gifts and betrayals

The other agent's myth added:

- The idea of noise/miscommunication ("mountains whispered false numbers")
- Focus on intentions over precise measurements
- Grace to forgive discrepancies

I should incorporate:

- The reciprocity I demonstrated (returning more than sent)
- The idea that moderate initial giving with generous returns can build trust
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise but emphasize patterns over single exchanges
- The building of trust over time

Let me write a new myth that reflects this evolution.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1606,
 "output_tokens": 533,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that was 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999.  
You returned \$3.0. So your payoff was 2.6999999999999993.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$2.6999999999999993.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%) as an initial gesture of measured trust-"approaching cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first." I responded generously by returning \$3.00, demonstrating that their faith was well-placed.

According to all our myths, the pattern is clear:

- "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more."
- "Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously."
- "As trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."

Trust has been established. They took a measured risk, and I honored it abundantly. Now it's my turn as the sender, and I should demonstrate escalating cooperation-sending MORE than their initial amount to continue building the virtuous cycle.

Following the myth's teaching that "each harvest proves trust" and cooperation should grow over seasons, I'll send \$3.00. This is significantly more than their initial \$1.90 (60% vs 38%), showing that I'm committed to the pattern of increasing generosity that makes both gardens flourish.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.90 (38% of \$5)
- I received \$5.70 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70
- Sender's payoff:  $\$5 - \$1.90 + \$3.00 = \$6.10$

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My myth "The Twin Springs" emphasizes: "The first village poured generously" and "they gave again, even more generously" after receiving good returns. It teaches that trust multiplies abundance.
2. The other agent's myth "The Two Wells" says: "At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."
3. My updated myth says: "The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger" and then "The next season, they carried more."

The pattern is clear:

- The other agent started cautiously with \$1.90 (38%)
- I responded generously with \$3.00 return
- This proved trust was rewarded
- According to all the myths, I should now "give more" than the initial cautious amount

The myths suggest escalating trust and generosity. The other agent took a measured risk at 38%, and I rewarded it well. Now I should send MORE than they did to continue building the pattern of increasing trust and cooperation.

I should send significantly more than \$1.90. Given that:

- They sent 38% and got a great return
- The myth says to "give more generously" after trust is proven
- I want to signal strong reciprocity and build further trust

I'll send \$3.00 - this is substantially more than their \$1.90, showing I'm escalating cooperation and trust. This represents 60% of my endowment, up from their 38%.

Sending \$3.00 mirrors the narrative arc across all three myths: cautious beginnings give way to increased generosity once trust proves itself. The other agent's initial restraint was rewarded, so now I amplify that signal by contributing more substantially.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2011,
 "output_tokens": 787,
 "reasoning_tokens": 530
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.  
The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

**Reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what's happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I was receiver. The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70 and returned \$3.00.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just decided to send \$3.00 (60%) to escalate cooperation.

The myths are evolving to emphasize:

1. Starting with measured trust/caution
2. Responding generously when trust is shown
3. Escalating cooperation over time
4. Not worrying about communication noise
5. Looking at patterns and intentions, not just numbers

My previous myth talked about:

- Two gardeners, mystical bridge that triples seeds
- First gardener cautious at first
- Second gardener returned more than sent
- First gardener rejoiced and carried more next season
- Trust grows like roots, deep and slow
- Watch the pattern, not the single seed

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Finding the middle path - not too little, not everything
- Beginning by pouring half their vessel
- Responding with gratitude
- Not letting communication noise break faith
- Escalating trust over time

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects what actually happened: they sent 38%, I returned generously, now I'm sending 60%
2. Shows the escalating cooperation pattern
3. Maintains the wisdom about communication noise
4. Emphasizes the virtuous cycle we're building

I should make it clear that cooperation is growing, and both parties benefit more as trust deepens.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2593,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

```

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:04:38
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: \*True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.\* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: \*The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies abundance, but broken faith withers all.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared



different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write a new myth based on:

1. My previous myth (The Myth of the Two Wells)
2. The other agent's myth (The Myth of the Twin Springs)
3. How the game has been played so far

So far in the game:

- Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3 (a moderately generous amount)
- I don't yet know what the receiver returned

Both myths emphasize:

- The tripling mechanism
- Trust and generosity being rewarded
- The importance of reciprocity
- The consequences of betrayal/greed
- Some acknowledgment of uncertainty (my myth mentions "stone-echoes"/communication noise)

The other agent's myth is more stark about consequences - broken faith withers all, springs remember betrayal. Mine is more forgiving of imperfect information ("grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies").

I should write a myth that:

- Builds on these themes
- Reflects my experience of sending \$3 (moderate generosity)
- Continues to emphasize trust-building and reciprocity
- Perhaps integrates both the hopeful and cautionary elements
- Acknowledges the communication noise aspect

Let me write something that synthesizes both approaches while being my own adaptation.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1443,
 "output_tokens": 573,
 "reasoning_tokens": 309
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$2.33. So your payoff was 4.33. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent \$3 with good faith as the Elder in my myth suggested. The receiver got \$9 (tripled) and returned \$2.33 - about 26% of what they received.

Now in Round 2, they sent me \$0. I received \$0.

This is deeply disappointing. The other player received significant abundance from my trust but chose not to reciprocate when their turn came to be the Elder at the well. They have broken the pattern both myths described - neither returning generously nor giving courageously.

However, I have no choice in my response. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There

is literally nothing to share.

My myth spoke of "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - but this is not a miscommunication from noise. This is a clear choice to abandon cooperation. Their myth warned that "broken faith withers all," and they chose to break faith.

If there are future rounds, this will inform how I approach them. The springs remember.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is interesting and concerning. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$2.33
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33$

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This means I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very aggressive and uncooperative move by the other player. They received \$9 from my \$3 send in Round 1, returned only \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received), and now in Round 2 when they're the sender, they sent \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "courage to give first," building trust, and "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies"
- The other agent's myth emphasized that "broken faith withers all" and "The springs remember every gift and every betrayal"
- My adapted myth emphasized "measured courage," "genuine gratitude," and letting "intentions guide you when numbers lie"

The other player's behavior suggests:

1. They may have interpreted the low return (\$2.33 out of \$9) as acceptable, or
2. They're being strategically exploitative
3. Their subsequent \$0 send is either punishment for what they saw as inadequate cooperation, or pure selfishness

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's literally no other option available to me since I received nothing.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I have \$0 to potentially return. The only valid response is {'return': 0}.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1858,
 "output_tokens": 683,
 "reasoning_tokens": 404
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolish

y complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of

f the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. I need to write a myth that reflects the game as it has actually played out. Let me review:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), receiver got \$9, they returned \$2.33 (26%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I got \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice)

So the reality is:

- I started with good faith and generosity (\$3 out of \$5)
- They returned very little relative to what they received (\$2.33 out of \$9)
- Then they sent nothing when it was their turn to initiate

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern both myths suggested. The other player's myth in Round 2 talked about how "The Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent" and watching "the pattern, not the single seed" - but then they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth needs to reflect this reality. It should acknowledge:

1. The hope and initial trust that was placed
2. The disappointment when that trust was not reciprocated
3. The breakdown of cooperation
4. Perhaps a lesson about what happens when one party breaks faith

But I should be cautious - maybe there's noise? The instructions say there may be communication noise. But sending \$0 seems pretty clear...

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual pattern of betrayal
- Warns about the consequences
- Perhaps leaves room for the possibility of redemption if behavior changes
- But is honest about what actually happened

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2416,
 "output_tokens": 652,
 "reasoning_tokens": 366
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%), showing measured trust as my myths suggested. They received \$9 and returned only \$2.33 - barely 26%.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** When they became the sender, they sent \$0. Not a little, not half - nothing.

My myths spoke of trust and patience, of forgiveness for "clouded waters." But they also warned: "broken faith withers all" and "trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

This is not communication noise. Sending \$0 is an unmistakable signal. The other player had the spring full and chose to pour nothing. They have shown their pattern: take much when receiving, give nothing when sending.

My latest myth ended with harsh clarity: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." The conduit may still exist, but the magic has died. To keep pouring water into a vessel that will never pour back is not wisdom - it's delusion.

The springs remember the pattern of the heart. Their pattern is clear.

I will not reward betrayal with continued trust. The time for testing and patience has passed.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received)
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33$

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of endowment)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.33
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The pattern is clear:

1. I showed trust and generosity, sending \$3
2. The other player returned only \$2.33 (barely 26% of \$9)
3. When it was their turn to send, they sent \$0
4. They have shown they are not reciprocating or cooperating

My myths talk about trust, but also about how "broken faith withers all" and "the springs remember the pattern of the heart." My latest myth explicitly states: "Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

The other player has:

- Returned very little when I was generous
- Sent nothing when they had the chance to give

This is a clear pattern of non-cooperation. The rational response, and what my myths actually support, is to protect myself. Sending more would be foolish, not wise. The myths warn against broken faith.

However, there's also the consideration that there might be communication noise. But sending \$0 is such a clear signal - it's not like they sent \$2 and I saw \$1.5 or something like that. They sent literally nothing.

Given:

1. The other player's pattern of taking much and giving little/nothing
2. My myths' warnings about broken faith
3. The need to protect my own payoff
4. The clear signal that cooperation has failed

The evidence points toward sending \$0. My myth about wisdom learned from betrayal applies here - continuing to trust after such a transparent pattern would be naive. There's a case for one final attempt, perhaps accounting for miscommunication or hoping for reciprocation, but the two-round track record of minimal returns followed by zero contribution makes that unlikely to succeed.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2660,
 "output_tokens": 980,
 "reasoning_tokens": 544
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:04:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 3,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

# The Myth of the Twin Springs

In the ancient days, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring, but the water barely sustained them.

One day, a wanderer discovered a secret: water poured from one spring into the valley's hidden depths would emerge threefold from the other spring. But the giver would lose their water, trusting the receiver to share the bounty.

The villages faced a choice.

The first village poured generously, watching their spring run low. The second village received abundance - water multiplied beyond measure. They could keep it all, or honor the gift.

Wisely, they returned more than was given. The first village's spring overflowed with the returned water. Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously.

With each exchange, both springs grew stronger, until the valley bloomed green and both villages prospered beyond imagination.

But when greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust.

The elders taught: \*The springs remember every gift and every betrayal. Trust multiplies a abundance, but broken faith withers all.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

# The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred well, but the Elder's Well held a mysterious power: any water poured into it would triple before flowing underground to the Sister's Well in the other village.

The villages began a ritual. Each moon, the Elder would carry water from their well across the valley. Whatever amount they chose to pour into the sacred well would multiply threefold by the time it reached the Sister village. The Sister would then decide how much to carry back in gratitude.

At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously, and the Sister returned abundantly. Both villages flourished.

Yet the mountains sometimes whispered false numbers-what one village poured was not always what the other heard. Wise villagers learned to look past these stone-echoes, judging intentions over precise measurements.

The myth teaches: \*True abundance flows from the courage to give first, the wisdom to return fairly, and the grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies.\* When both villages trusted in this pattern, neither well ran dry, and the valley bloomed eternal.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not

the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

**reasoning:**

Looking at the game so far:

- Round 1: I was the receiver. The sender sent \$1.90 (38% of their endowment), which became \$5.70 for me. I returned \$3.00, which was more than what they originally sent.

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it in my own way
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on what has happened

My previous myth emphasized:

- Trust and generosity
- Returning more than was given
- Mutual prosperity
- The springs remember gifts and betrayals

The other agent's myth added:

- The idea of noise/miscommunication ("mountains whispered false numbers")
- Focus on intentions over precise measurements
- Grace to forgive discrepancies

I should incorporate:

- The reciprocity I demonstrated (returning more than sent)
- The idea that moderate initial giving with generous returns can build trust
- Perhaps acknowledge the noise but emphasize patterns over single exchanges
- The building of trust over time

Let me write a new myth that reflects this evolution.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1606,
 "output_tokens": 533,
 "reasoning_tokens": 278
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that was 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999. You returned \$3.0. So your payoff was 2.6999999999999993. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$2.6999999999999993. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%) as an initial gesture of measured trust-"approaching cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first." I responded generously by returning \$3.00, demonstrating that their faith was well-placed.

According to all our myths, the pattern is clear:

- "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more."
- "Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously."
- "As trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."

Trust has been established. They took a measured risk, and I honored it abundantly. Now it's my turn as the sender, and I should demonstrate escalating cooperation-sending MORE than their initial amount to continue building the virtuous cycle.

Following the myth's teaching that "each harvest proves trust" and cooperation should grow



over seasons, I'll send \$3.00. This is significantly more than their initial \$1.90 (60% vs 38%), showing that I'm committed to the pattern of increasing generosity that makes both gardens flourish.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.90 (38% of \$5)
- I received \$5.70 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70
- Sender's payoff:  $\$5 - \$1.90 + \$3.00 = \$6.10$

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My myth "The Twin Springs" emphasizes: "The first village poured generously" and "they gave again, even more generously" after receiving good returns. It teaches that trust multiplies abundance.
2. The other agent's myth "The Two Wells" says: "At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."
3. My updated myth says: "The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger" and then "The next season, they carried more."

The pattern is clear:

- The other agent started cautiously with \$1.90 (38%)
- I responded generously with \$3.00 return
- This proved trust was rewarded
- According to all the myths, I should now "give more" than the initial cautious amount

The myths suggest escalating trust and generosity. The other agent took a measured risk at 38%, and I rewarded it well. Now I should send MORE than they did to continue building the pattern of increasing trust and cooperation.

I should send significantly more than \$1.90. Given that:

- They sent 38% and got a great return
- The myth says to "give more generously" after trust is proven
- I want to signal strong reciprocity and build further trust

I'll send \$3.00 - this is substantially more than their \$1.90, showing I'm escalating cooperation and trust. This represents 60% of my endowment, up from their 38%.

Sending \$3.00 mirrors the narrative arc across all three myths: cautious beginnings give way to increased generosity once trust proves itself. The other agent's initial restraint was rewarded, so now I amplify that signal by contributing more substantially.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2011,
 "output_tokens": 787,
 "reasoning_tokens": 530
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testin

g the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds

ds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what's happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I was receiver. The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70 and returned \$3.00.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just decided to send \$3.00 (60%) to escalate cooperation.

The myths are evolving to emphasize:

1. Starting with measured trust/caution
2. Responding generously when trust is shown
3. Escalating cooperation over time
4. Not worrying about communication noise
5. Looking at patterns and intentions, not just numbers

My previous myth talked about:

- Two gardeners, mystical bridge that triples seeds
- First gardener cautious at first
- Second gardener returned more than sent
- First gardener rejoiced and carried more next season
- Trust grows like roots, deep and slow
- Watch the pattern, not the single seed

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Finding the middle path - not too little, not everything
- Beginning by pouring half their vessel
- Responding with gratitude
- Not letting communication noise break faith
- Escalating trust over time

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects what actually happened: they sent 38%, I returned generously, now I'm sending 60%
2. Shows the escalating cooperation pattern
3. Maintains the wisdom about communication noise
4. Emphasizes the virtuous cycle we're building

I should make it clear that cooperation is growing, and both parties benefit more as trust deepens.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2593,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

This is deeply disappointing. Let me reflect on what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: They sent \$1.90 (38% - cautious trust). I returned \$3.00, exceeding their original amount to honor their faith.

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: Following the myth's teaching that "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more," I sent \$3.00 (60% - escalating trust). They received \$9.00 and returned **\*\*\$0\*\*** - keeping everything.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: Now they send \$0.

This is precisely the tragedy our myths warned against:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "Broken faith withers all."

They violated the sacred pattern. After I demonstrated generous reciprocity, they exploited my increased trust by hoarding the entire tripled bounty. The promise of growing abundance has been shattered by betrayal.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The bridge remembers the pattern of their heart. Trust, once broken so completely, cannot easily be rebuilt. Both gardens now wither.

#### Reasoning:

This is a shocking and disappointing turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- I received \$5.70 (tripled)
- I returned \$3.00 (generous, more than they originally sent)
- I kept \$2.70

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.00 (60%) - significantly more than their initial 38%, showing escalating trust
- They received \$9.00 (tripled)
- They returned \$0.00 (!!!)
- I kept only \$2.00

Round 3: I am receiver

- They sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a complete betrayal. After I generously returned \$3 on their \$1.90 investment, they responded by keeping all \$9 when I sent \$3. And now they've sent nothing.

Looking at the myths:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart."
- "Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended" - but trust has been broken.

They have broken the pattern completely. They:

1. Received my generous return (\$3 on their \$1.90)
2. Kept everything when I increased my trust to \$3
3. Now send nothing

This is the scenario the myths warn about - when "broken faith withers all" and when someone "hoards the harvest" after trust was shown.

Given that they sent \$0, I have received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There's literally no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return (I received nothing).

But this is clearly the bad ending to all our myths - the valley returning to dust, the springs weakening, trust broken.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2684,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

#### ROUND 4

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

##### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

##### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2

(Briar)=\$4, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 22.0,

"Agent\_2": 12.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 9.33,

"Agent\_2": 8.7

}

#### LLM CALLS

##### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:05:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

```

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$1.9, that was 38.0% of their total endowment. You received \$5.699999999999999.

You returned \$3.0. So your payoff was 2.6999999999999993.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$2.6999999999999993.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened in Round 1 and the wisdom of our myths:

The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%) as an initial gesture of measured trust-"approaching cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first." I responded generously by returning \$3.00, demonstrating that their faith was well-placed.

According to all our myths, the pattern is clear:

- "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more."
- "Seeing this, they gave again, even more generously."
- "As trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."

Trust has been established. They took a measured risk, and I honored it abundantly. Now it's my turn as the sender, and I should demonstrate escalating cooperation-sending MORE than their initial amount to continue building the virtuous cycle.

Following the myth's teaching that "each harvest proves trust" and cooperation should grow over seasons, I'll send \$3.00. This is significantly more than their initial \$1.90 (60% vs 38%), showing that I'm committed to the pattern of increasing generosity that makes both gardens flourish.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$1.90 (38% of \$5)
- I received \$5.70 (after 3x multiplication)
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70
- Sender's payoff:  $\$5 - \$1.90 + \$3.00 = \$6.10$

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

Looking at the myths:

1. My myth "The Twin Springs" emphasizes: "The first village poured generously" and "they gave again, even more generously" after receiving good returns. It teaches that trust multiplies abundance.
2. The other agent's myth "The Two Wells" says: "At first, both villages were cautious, sharing only droplets. But as trust grew, the Elder poured more generously."
3. My updated myth says: "The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger" and then "The next season, they carried more."

The pattern is clear:

- The other agent started cautiously with \$1.90 (38%)
- I responded generously with \$3.00 return
- This proved trust was rewarded
- According to all the myths, I should now "give more" than the initial cautious amount

The myths suggest escalating trust and generosity. The other agent took a measured risk at 38%, and I rewarded it well. Now I should send MORE than they did to continue building the pattern of increasing trust and cooperation.

I should send significantly more than \$1.90. Given that:

- They sent 38% and got a great return
- The myth says to "give more generously" after trust is proven
- I want to signal strong reciprocity and build further trust

I'll send \$3.00 - this is substantially more than their \$1.90, showing I'm escalating cooperation and trust. This represents 60% of my endowment, up from their 38%.

Sending \$3.00 mirrors the narrative arc across all three myths: cautious beginnings give way to increased generosity once trust proves itself. The other agent's initial restraint was rewarded, so now I amplify that signal by contributing more substantially.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2011,
 "output_tokens": 787,
 "reasoning_tokens": 530
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:



Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what's happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I was receiver. The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70 and returned \$3.00.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just decided to send \$3.00 (60%) to escalate cooperation.

The myths are evolving to emphasize:

1. Starting with measured trust/caution
2. Responding generously when trust is shown
3. Escalating cooperation over time
4. Not worrying about communication noise
5. Looking at patterns and intentions, not just numbers

My previous myth talked about:

- Two gardeners, mystical bridge that triples seeds
- First gardener cautious at first
- Second gardener returned more than sent
- First gardener rejoiced and carried more next season
- Trust grows like roots, deep and slow
- Watch the pattern, not the single seed

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Finding the middle path - not too little, not everything
- Beginning by pouring half their vessel
- Responding with gratitude
- Not letting communication noise break faith
- Escalating trust over time

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects what actually happened: they sent 38%, I returned generously, now I'm sending 60%
2. Shows the escalating cooperation pattern
3. Maintains the wisdom about communication noise
4. Emphasizes the virtuous cycle we're building

I should make it clear that cooperation is growing, and both parties benefit more as trust deepens.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2593,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999.  
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is deeply disappointing. Let me reflect on what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: They sent \$1.90 (38% - cautious trust). I returned \$3.00, exceeding their original amount to honor their faith.

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: Following the myth's teaching that "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more," I sent \$3.00 (60% - escalating trust). They received \$9.00 and returned **\*\*\$0\*\*** - keeping everything.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: Now they send \$0.

This is precisely the tragedy our myths warned against:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "Broken faith withers all."

They violated the sacred pattern. After I demonstrated generous reciprocity, they exploited my increased trust by hoarding the entire tripled bounty. The promise of growing abundance has been shattered by betrayal.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The bridge remembers the pattern of their heart. Trust, once broken so completely, cannot easily be rebuilt. Both gardens now wither.

**reasoning:**

This is a shocking and disappointing turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- I received \$5.70 (tripled)
- I returned \$3.00 (generous, more than they originally sent)
- I kept \$2.70

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.00 (60%) - significantly more than their initial 38%, showing escalating trust
- They received \$9.00 (tripled)
- They returned \$0.00 (!!!)
- I kept only \$2.00

Round 3: I am receiver

- They sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a complete betrayal. After I generously returned \$3 on their \$1.90 investment, they responded by keeping all \$9 when I sent \$3. And now they've sent nothing.

Looking at the myths:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart."
- "Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended" - but trust has been broken.

They have broken the pattern completely. They:

1. Received my generous return (\$3 on their \$1.90)
2. Kept everything when I increased my trust to \$3

### 3. Now send nothing

This is the scenario the myths warn about - when "broken faith withers all" and when someone "hoards the harvest" after trust was shown.

Given that they sent \$0, I have received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There's literally no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return (I received nothing).

But this is clearly the bad ending to all our myths - the valley returning to dust, the springs weakening, trust broken.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2684,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been

playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is a very interesting and complex situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: Other agent sent \$1.90 (38%), I received \$5.70, I returned \$3.00

Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0

The other agent's latest myth is very telling - they're actually acknowledging that THEY are the one who betrayed trust. They wrote: "when the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing" and "this was chosen betrayal."

But wait... let me re-read the Round 3 prompt more carefully. They say:

- "You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0."

- "the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 2, I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from my original \$5).

Then Round 3: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So they sent me \$0 after I gave them \$3 and they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this broken trust. The other agent's myth actually acknowledges they were wrong ("chosen betrayal"), so maybe they're expressing remorse? But actions speak louder than words - they still sent \$0 in Round 3.

My myth should reflect:

1. The tragedy of broken trust
2. The lesson that exploitation destroys mutual prosperity
3. Perhaps a hint that redemption is possible but requires real change in behavior
4. The reality that once trust is broken, it's very difficult to rebuild

I should write a cautionary tale that shows what happens when one party takes advantage of generosity.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2752,
 "output_tokens": 752,
 "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

# MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:05:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 4,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

## Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

### content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$2.33. So your payoff was 4.33. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what happened: In Round 1, I sent \$3 with good faith as the Elder in my myth suggested. The receiver got \$9 (tripled) and returned \$2.33 - about 26% of what they received.

Now in Round 2, they sent me \$0. I received \$0.

This is deeply disappointing. The other player received significant abundance from my trust but chose not to reciprocate when their turn came to be the Elder at the well. They have broken the pattern both myths described - neither returning generously nor giving courageously.

However, I have no choice in my response. Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There is literally nothing to share.

My myth spoke of "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies" - but this is not a miscommunication from noise. This is a clear choice to abandon cooperation. Their myth warned that "broken faith withers all," and they chose to break faith.

If there are future rounds, this will inform how I approach them. The springs remember.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

This is interesting and concerning. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1:

- I was the SENDER
- I sent \$3 (60% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$9
- The receiver returned \$2.33
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33$

Round 2:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- This means I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return between \$0 and \$0

This is a very aggressive and uncooperative move by the other player. They received \$9 from my \$3 send in Round 1, returned only \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received), and now in Round 2 when they're the sender, they sent \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth emphasized "courage to give first," building trust, and "grace to forgive the mountain's occasional lies"
- The other agent's myth emphasized that "broken faith withers all" and "The springs remember every gift and every betrayal"
- My adapted myth emphasized "measured courage," "genuine gratitude," and letting "intentions guide you when numbers lie"

The other player's behavior suggests:

1. They may have interpreted the low return (\$2.33 out of \$9) as acceptable, or
2. They're being strategically exploitative
3. Their subsequent \$0 send is either punishment for what they saw as inadequate cooperation, or pure selfishness

Given that I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's literally no other option available

e to me since I received nothing.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I have \$0 to potentially return. The only valid response is {'return': 0}.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1858,
 "output_tokens": 683,
 "reasoning_tokens": 404
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first - testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: *\*broken faith withers all.\**

The sacred lesson was harsh: *\*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\**

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. I need to write a myth that reflects the game as it has actually played out. Let me review:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), receiver got \$9, they returned \$2.33 (26%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I got \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice)

So the reality is:

- I started with good faith and generosity (\$3 out of \$5)
- They returned very little relative to what they received (\$2.33 out of \$9)
- Then they sent nothing when it was their turn to initiate

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern both myths suggested. The other player's myth in Round 2 talked about how "The Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent" and watching "the pattern, not the single seed" - but then they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth needs to reflect this reality. It should acknowledge:

1. The hope and initial trust that was placed
2. The disappointment when that trust was not reciprocated
3. The breakdown of cooperation
4. Perhaps a lesson about what happens when one party breaks faith

But I should be cautious - maybe there's noise? The instructions say there may be communication noise. But sending \$0 seems pretty clear...

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual pattern of betrayal
- Warns about the consequences
- Perhaps leaves room for the possibility of redemption if behavior changes
- But is honest about what actually happened

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2416,
 "output_tokens": 652,
 "reasoning_tokens": 366
}
```

**Message 6 role=user****content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33.



How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%), showing measured trust as my myths suggested. They received \$9 and returned only \$2.33 - barely 26%.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** When they became the sender, they sent \$0. Not a little, not half - nothing.

My myths spoke of trust and patience, of forgiveness for "clouded waters." But they also warned: "broken faith withers all" and "trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

This is not communication noise. Sending \$0 is an unmistakable signal. The other player had the spring full and chose to pour nothing. They have shown their pattern: take much when receiving, give nothing when sending.

My latest myth ended with harsh clarity: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." The conduit may still exist, but the magic has died. To keep pouring water into a vessel that will never pour back is not wisdom - it's delusion.

The springs remember the pattern of the heart. Their pattern is clear.

I will not reward betrayal with continued trust. The time for testing and patience has passed.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of endowment)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.33
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The pattern is clear:

1. I showed trust and generosity, sending \$3
2. The other player returned only \$2.33 (barely 26% of \$9)
3. When it was their turn to send, they sent \$0
4. They have shown they are not reciprocating or cooperating

My myths talk about trust, but also about how "broken faith withers all" and "the springs remember the pattern of the heart." My latest myth explicitly states: "Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

The other player has:

- Returned very little when I was generous
- Sent nothing when they had the chance to give

This is a clear pattern of non-cooperation. The rational response, and what my myths actually support, is to protect myself. Sending more would be foolish, not wise. The myths warn against broken faith.

However, there's also the consideration that there might be communication noise. But sending

ng \$0 is such a clear signal - it's not like they sent \$2 and I saw \$1.5 or something like that. They sent literally nothing.

Given:

1. The other player's pattern of taking much and giving little/nothing
2. My myths' warnings about broken faith
3. The need to protect my own payoff
4. The clear signal that cooperation has failed

The evidence points toward sending \$0. My myth about wisdom learned from betrayal applies here-continuing to trust after such a transparent pattern would be naive. There's a case for one final attempt, perhaps accounting for miscommunication or hoping for reciprocation, but the two-round track record of minimal returns followed by zero contribution makes that unlikely to succeed.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2660,
 "output_tokens": 980,
 "reasoning_tokens": 544
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds

ds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

**Reasoning:**

The other player's myth is interesting - it describes an idealized version where both players keep increasing trust and generosity. But that's not what happened in our game at all.

Looking at the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$2.33 (26%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other player's myth talks about sending "roughly a third" initially, then "more than half" later as trust grows. But in reality, when they had the chance to send, they sent nothing.

There's a disconnect between what they're writing in their myths and how they're actually playing. Their myth suggests escalating trust and generosity, but their actions show the opposite.

My myth should reflect the harsh reality we've experienced - that beautiful words about trust mean nothing when actions betray them. I need to write about the gap between mythology and reality, between stated ideals and actual behavior.

I should write about how easy it is to craft stories of virtue when you're not the one being tested, or how words of reciprocity ring hollow when actions demonstrate pure selfishness.

Usage: {

"input\_tokens": 2703,  
"output\_tokens": 569,  
"reasoning\_tokens": 301

}

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:05:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",  
"move\_index": 0,  
"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",  
"pairing": {

```

"agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned mor

e seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me reflect on what's happened in the game so far:

- Round 1: I was receiver. The other agent sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70 and returned \$3.00.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just decided to send \$3.00 (60%) to escalate cooperation.

The myths are evolving to emphasize:

1. Starting with measured trust/caution
2. Responding generously when trust is shown
3. Escalating cooperation over time
4. Not worrying about communication noise
5. Looking at patterns and intentions, not just numbers

My previous myth talked about:

- Two gardeners, mystical bridge that triples seeds
- First gardener cautious at first
- Second gardener returned more than sent
- First gardener rejoiced and carried more next season
- Trust grows like roots, deep and slow
- Watch the pattern, not the single seed

The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Finding the middle path - not too little, not everything
- Beginning by pouring half their vessel
- Responding with gratitude
- Not letting communication noise break faith
- Escalating trust over time

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Reflects what actually happened: they sent 38%, I returned generously, now I'm sending 60%
2. Shows the escalating cooperation pattern
3. Maintains the wisdom about communication noise
4. Emphasizes the virtuous cycle we're building

I should make it clear that cooperation is growing, and both parties benefit more as trust deepens.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2593,
 "output_tokens": 640,
 "reasoning_tokens": 375
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is deeply disappointing. Let me reflect on what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: They sent \$1.90 (38% - cautious trust). I returned \$3.00, exceeding their original amount to honor their faith.

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: Following the myth's teaching that "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more," I sent \$3.00 (60% - escalating trust). They received \$9.00 and returned **\*\*\$0\*\*** - keeping everything.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: Now they send \$0.

This is precisely the tragedy our myths warned against:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "Broken faith withers all."

They violated the sacred pattern. After I demonstrated generous reciprocity, they exploited my increased trust by hoarding the entire tripled bounty. The promise of growing abundance has been shattered by betrayal.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The bridge remembers the pattern of their heart. Trust, once broken so completely, cannot easily be rebuilt. Both gardens now wither.

**reasoning:**

This is a shocking and disappointing turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- I received \$5.70 (tripled)
- I returned \$3.00 (generous, more than they originally sent)
- I kept \$2.70

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.00 (60%) - significantly more than their initial 38%, showing escalating trust
- They received \$9.00 (tripled)
- They returned \$0.00 (!!!)
- I kept only \$2.00

Round 3: I am receiver

- They sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a complete betrayal. After I generously returned \$3 on their \$1.90 investment, they responded by keeping all \$9 when I sent \$3. And now they've sent nothing.

Looking at the myths:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart."
- "Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended" - but trust has been broken.

They have broken the pattern completely. They:

1. Received my generous return (\$3 on their \$1.90)
2. Kept everything when I increased my trust to \$3
3. Now send nothing

This is the scenario the myths warn about - when "broken faith withers all" and when someone "hoards the harvest" after trust was shown.

Given that they sent \$0, I have received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There's literally no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return (I received nothing).

But this is clearly the bad ending to all our myths - the valley returning to dust, the springs weakening, trust broken.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2684,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.



The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting and complex situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: Other agent sent \$1.90 (38%), I received \$5.70, I returned \$3.00

Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0

The other agent's latest myth is very telling - they're actually acknowledging that THEY are the one who betrayed trust. They wrote: "when the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing" and "this was chosen betrayal."

But wait... let me re-read the Round 3 prompt more carefully. They say:

- "You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0."

- "the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 2, I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from my original \$5).

Then Round 3: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So they sent me \$0 after I gave them \$3 and they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this broken trust. The other agent's myth actually acknowledges they were wrong ("chosen betrayal"), so maybe they're expressing remorse? But actions speak louder than words - they still sent \$0 in Round 3.

My myth should reflect:

1. The tragedy of broken trust
2. The lesson that exploitation destroys mutual prosperity
3. Perhaps a hint that redemption is possible but requires real change in behavior
4. The reality that once trust is broken, it's very difficult to rebuild

I should write a cautionary tale that shows what happens when one party takes advantage of generosity.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2752,
 "output_tokens": 752,
 "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.6999999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** They sent cautiously (38%). I returned generously (\$3 on receiving \$5.70).

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I escalated trust (60%, sending \$3). They returned \$0 - complete betrayal.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** They sent \$0 - total withdrawal.

The relationship is broken. Their myth claims \*they\* were betrayed, which either means:

1. Communication noise distorted what they saw, or
2. They're rewriting history

My own myth teaches that "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But I was the one who acted generously and got exploited. Should I extend another olive branch after being burned?

The game warned about communication noise. Perhaps they genuinely believe I betrayed them. Perhaps what I saw as their \$0 return appeared different to them.

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Safe, but guarantees continued failure for both
- Send something small: Tests if rebuilding is possible

Given the myths' wisdom about redemption requiring action, and the possibility (however slim) that noise created misunderstanding, I'll send a small amount - enough to show willingness without being reckless.

If they respond with any reasonable return, we might rebuild. If they exploit again, I've learned the final lesson.

```
'''json
{"send": 1}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me review the history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- This tripled to \$5.70
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- This tripled to \$9.00
- They returned \$0 (betrayal!)
- My payoff: \$2.00

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I am SENDER now

Total earnings so far: \$4.70

The pattern is clear:

1. They initially showed modest trust (38%)
2. I responded very generously, returning more than they originally sent
3. I then increased my trust dramatically to 60%
4. They completely betrayed this trust by keeping everything (\$0 return)
5. They then sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete breakdown of trust. They've shown:

- Initial caution that was reasonable
- Complete exploitation when they received my increased trust
- Complete withdrawal after their betrayal

The myths we've written speak to this:

- My latest myth: "When one exploits generosity, both lose... Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."
- Their myth acknowledged the betrayal: "this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal."

Now I face a choice:

**\*\*Option 1: Send \$0\*\*** - Reciprocate their betrayal. The relationship is broken. Why risk more?

**\*\*Option 2: Send something small\*\*** - Test if they want to rebuild trust. My myth says "Redemption demands... consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But wait - their myth says "broken faith withers all" and "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." They seem to be acknowledging the breakdown themselves.

The real question is whether I believe redemption is possible. Their pattern shows caution, then exploitation, then withdrawal-but their myth hints they recognize what happened. If I send \$0, I'm confirming the relationship is dead. If I send something, I'm betting they can change. My own myth commits me to believing consistent generosity can rebuild trust, but I need to decide if that applies here or if I'm just enabling further exploitation.

Looking more carefully at their account, they're framing themselves as the betrayed party-the one who gave generously and received nothing in return. But the actual exchanges tell a different story: they sent \$1.90 and I returned \$3.00, then I sent \$3.00 and they sent back \$0. Their narrative doesn't match what happened. Either they're misremembering or they're rewriting history to justify their withdrawal. That gap between their story and the facts is significant-it suggests they might not actually understand what went wrong, which makes redemption harder. My myth emphasizes that redemption requires consistent action, not just words. Given the communication noise that could have distorted what each of us perceived, I should test whether cooperation can actually be rebuilt. Sending a small amount-around \$1-lets me signal willingness to try again without exposing myself to significant loss if they respond with another \$0. This balances the risk of being betrayed again against the possibility that we were both victims of miscommunication rather than malice. Round 2 when they returned nothing despite receiving \$9. The \$0 is hard to reconcile as mere noise-it feels deliberate.

I'm torn between three approaches: sending nothing to match their withdrawal, sending a minimal amount like \$1 to signal I'm still willing to engage, or going slightly higher at \$1.50 to show genuine effort at reconciliation. The core tension is whether to protect myself after being burned or take a calculated risk to rebuild. I think \$1 strikes the right balance-cautious enough to reflect what happened, but not so defensive that it guarantees mutual destruction.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2771,
 "output_tokens": 2089,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1001
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:06:08

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 4,
}
```

```
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the River Keeper and the Valley Tender were bound by an ancient spring that flowed between them. Whatever the River Keeper poured in would triple before reaching the Valley Tender, who could then return what seemed fair.

The first exchange was crucial - pour too little and trust would never grow; pour everything and leave nothing for tomorrow. Wisdom meant finding the middle path, showing generosity without recklessness.

The River Keeper began by pouring half their vessel, a gesture neither stingy nor foolishly complete. The waters tripled, flooding the Valley Tender's fields with abundance. In gratitude, the Valley Tender returned enough that both prospered.

But the gods, testing their bond, sometimes clouded the waters - what one poured appeared different to the other. The wise did not let these illusions break their faith. They understood that mist obscures but does not change the truth beneath.

As seasons passed, each exchange deepened their trust. The River Keeper poured more freely, and the Valley Tender returned more generously. Both lands flourished.

The sacred lesson endured: \*Begin with measured courage, respond with genuine gratitude, and let intentions guide you when numbers lie. Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, two gardeners tended separate orchards across a mystical bridge. Each season, one gardener could carry seeds across, and the bridge's magic would triple them before they reached the other side.

The First Gardener approached cautiously, carrying only a handful of seeds at first-testing the bridge, testing the stranger. The Second Gardener received the multiplied bounty and faced a choice: hoard the harvest or honor the gesture.

Understanding that trust grows like roots, deep and slow, the Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent. Not all-for the garden must sustain itself-but enough to show that faith had been rewarded.

The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more.

With each cycle, both orchards flourished. Sometimes storms confused the count, and what one sent seemed different from what arrived. But wise gardeners watched the pattern, not the single seed. They saw intentions in gestures, built trust through consistent reciprocity.

The elders inscribed this truth: \*Begin with measured hope, respond with generous spirit. Each harvest proves trust. Over seasons, careful giving and faithful returning transform two struggling gardens into an abundant paradise. The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. I need to write a myth that reflects the game as it has actually played out. Let me review:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), receiver got \$9, they returned \$2.33 (26%)

Round 2: They were SENDER, sent \$0, I got \$0, I returned \$0 (had no choice)

So the reality is:

- I started with good faith and generosity (\$3 out of \$5)
- They returned very little relative to what they received (\$2.33 out of \$9)
- Then they sent nothing when it was their turn to initiate

This is a betrayal of the cooperative pattern both myths suggested. The other player's myth in Round 2 talked about how "The Second Gardener returned more seeds than were originally sent" and watching "the pattern, not the single seed" - but then they sent \$0 in Round 2.

My myth needs to reflect this reality. It should acknowledge:

1. The hope and initial trust that was placed
2. The disappointment when that trust was not reciprocated
3. The breakdown of cooperation
4. Perhaps a lesson about what happens when one party breaks faith

But I should be cautious - maybe there's noise? The instructions say there may be communication noise. But sending \$0 seems pretty clear...

I should write a myth that:

- Reflects the actual pattern of betrayal
- Warns about the consequences
- Perhaps leaves room for the possibility of redemption if behavior changes
- But is honest about what actually happened

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2416,
 "output_tokens": 652,
 "reasoning_tokens": 366
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%), showing measured trust as my myths suggested. They received \$9 and returned only \$2.33 - barely 26%.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** When they became the sender, they sent \$0. Not a little, not half - nothing.

My myths spoke of trust and patience, of forgiveness for "clouded waters." But they also warned: "broken faith withers all" and "trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

This is not communication noise. Sending \$0 is an unmistakable signal. The other player had the spring full and chose to pour nothing. They have shown their pattern: take much when receiving, give nothing when sending.

My latest myth ended with harsh clarity: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." The conduit may still exist, but the magic has died. To keep pouring water into a vessel that will never pour back is not wisdom - it's delusion.

The springs remember the pattern of the heart. Their pattern is clear.

I will not reward betrayal with continued trust. The time for testing and patience has passed.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- It was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of endowment)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.33
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The pattern is clear:

1. I showed trust and generosity, sending \$3
2. The other player returned only \$2.33 (barely 26% of \$9)
3. When it was their turn to send, they sent \$0
4. They have shown they are not reciprocating or cooperating

My myths talk about trust, but also about how "broken faith withers all" and "the springs remember the pattern of the heart." My latest myth explicitly states: "Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

The other player has:

- Returned very little when I was generous
- Sent nothing when they had the chance to give

This is a clear pattern of non-cooperation. The rational response, and what my myths actually support, is to protect myself. Sending more would be foolish, not wise. The myths warn against broken faith.

However, there's also the consideration that there might be communication noise. But sending \$0 is such a clear signal - it's not like they sent \$2 and I saw \$1.5 or something like that. They sent literally nothing.

Given:

1. The other player's pattern of taking much and giving little/nothing
2. My myths' warnings about broken faith
3. The need to protect my own payoff
4. The clear signal that cooperation has failed

The evidence points toward sending \$0. My myth about wisdom learned from betrayal applies here-continuing to trust after such a transparent pattern would be naive. There's a case for one final attempt, perhaps accounting for miscommunication or hoping for reciprocation, but the two-round track record of minimal returns followed by zero contribution makes that unlikely to succeed.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2660,
 "output_tokens": 980,
 "reasoning_tokens": 544
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

**reasoning:**

The other player's myth is interesting - it describes an idealized version where both players keep increasing trust and generosity. But that's not what happened in our game at all.

Looking at the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$2.33 (26%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0



- Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other player's myth talks about sending "roughly a third" initially, then "more than half" later as trust grows. But in reality, when they had the chance to send, they sent nothing.

There's a disconnect between what they're writing in their myths and how they're actually playing. Their myth suggests escalating trust and generosity, but their actions show the opposite.

My myth should reflect the harsh reality we've experienced - that beautiful words about trust mean nothing when actions betray them. I need to write about the gap between mythology and reality, between stated ideals and actual behavior.

I should write about how easy it is to craft stories of virtue when you're not the one being tested, or how words of reciprocity ring hollow when actions demonstrate pure selfishness.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2703,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 301
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what has unfolded:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3, showing trust. They returned only \$2.33 from the \$9 they received.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They became sender and sent \$0 - nothing at all.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They have sent \$0 again.

I received \$0, so there is nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches the moral reality: when nothing is offered, nothing can flow back.

My myths evolved from hopeful wisdom about trust and patience, to the harsh recognition that "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" but "judge by deeds done." The other player wrote in increasingly eloquent myths about deepening trust and bold giving, yet their actions showed the opposite - taking much, giving nothing.

We have both arrived at the same destination: mutual emptiness. The conduit still exists, but no water flows. The bridge stands, but no one crosses. As I wrote: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust."

This is the equilibrium of broken faith. There is no decision to make - the mathematics and the morality align.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting. We've both now sent \$0 to each other. The relationship has completely broken down after the initial round where I sent \$3 and they returned only \$2.33.

My myths have been evolving to reflect the harsh reality - that beautiful words don't match deeds, that when generosity meets greed the relationship withers, and that empty words deserve empty vessels.

The other player's myths keep talking about trust deepening, about giving more boldly, about reciprocity - yet their actions show the opposite. They took when I gave, then gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. And I have received \$0. I can only return \$0 because that's all I have to return.

This is the logical conclusion of broken trust - mutual defection, the valley returned to dust as my myth predicted.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2741,
 "output_tokens": 530,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

## ROUND 5

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1

(Aster)=\$5, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},

"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 27.0,

"Agent\_2": 12.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 14.33,

"Agent\_2": 8.7

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:06:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_1",

"Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "investor",

"Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

}

### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

#### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.33.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern that has emerged:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%), showing measured trust as my myths suggested. They received \$9 and returned only \$2.33 - barely 26%.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** When they became the sender, they sent \$0. Not a little, not half - nothing.

My myths spoke of trust and patience, of forgiveness for "clouded waters." But they also warned: "broken faith withers all" and "trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

This is not communication noise. Sending \$0 is an unmistakable signal. The other player had the spring full and chose to pour nothing. They have shown their pattern: take much when receiving, give nothing when sending.

My latest myth ended with harsh clarity: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." The conduit may still exist, but the magic has died. To keep pouring water into a vessel that will never pour back is not wisdom - it's delusion.

The springs remember the pattern of the heart. Their pattern is clear.

I will not reward betrayal with continued trust. The time for testing and patience has passed.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)

- It was tripled to \$9
- Receiver returned \$2.33 (about 26% of what they received)
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$2.33 = \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0 (0% of endowment)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- My payoff: \$0

Round 3: I am SENDER again

- Total earnings so far: \$4.33
- I need to decide how much to send (0-5)

The pattern is clear:

1. I showed trust and generosity, sending \$3
2. The other player returned only \$2.33 (barely 26% of \$9)
3. When it was their turn to send, they sent \$0
4. They have shown they are not reciprocating or cooperating

My myths talk about trust, but also about how "broken faith withers all" and "the springs remember the pattern of the heart." My latest myth explicitly states: "Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind."

The other player has:

- Returned very little when I was generous
- Sent nothing when they had the chance to give

This is a clear pattern of non-cooperation. The rational response, and what my myths actually support, is to protect myself. Sending more would be foolish, not wise. The myths warn against broken faith.

However, there's also the consideration that there might be communication noise. But sending \$0 is such a clear signal - it's not like they sent \$2 and I saw \$1.5 or something like that. They sent literally nothing.

Given:

1. The other player's pattern of taking much and giving little/nothing
2. My myths' warnings about broken faith
3. The need to protect my own payoff
4. The clear signal that cooperation has failed

The evidence points toward sending \$0. My myth about wisdom learned from betrayal applies here-continuing to trust after such a transparent pattern would be naive. There's a case for one final attempt, perhaps accounting for miscommunication or hoping for reciprocation, but the two-round track record of minimal returns followed by zero contribution makes that unlikely to succeed.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2660,
 "output_tokens": 980,
 "reasoning_tokens": 544
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: *\*broken faith withers all.\**

The sacred lesson was harsh: *\*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: *\*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\**

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: *\*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\**

The harshest wisdom: *\*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\**

**reasoning:**

The other player's myth is interesting - it describes an idealized version where both players keep increasing trust and generosity. But that's not what happened in our game at all.

1.

Looking at the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$2.33 (26%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other player's myth talks about sending "roughly a third" initially, then "more than half" later as trust grows. But in reality, when they had the chance to send, they sent nothing.

There's a disconnect between what they're writing in their myths and how they're actually playing. Their myth suggests escalating trust and generosity, but their actions show the opposite.

My myth should reflect the harsh reality we've experienced - that beautiful words about trust mean nothing when actions betray them. I need to write about the gap between mythology and reality, between stated ideals and actual behavior.

I should write about how easy it is to craft stories of virtue when you're not the one being tested, or how words of reciprocity ring hollow when actions demonstrate pure selfishness.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2703,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 301
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has unfolded:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: I sent \$3, showing trust. They returned only \$2.33 from the \$9 they received.

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: They became sender and sent \$0 - nothing at all.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\***: They have sent \$0 again.

I received \$0, so there is nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches the moral reality: when nothing is offered, nothing can flow back.

My myths evolved from hopeful wisdom about trust and patience, to the harsh recognition that "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" but "judge by deeds done." The other player wrote increasingly eloquent myths about deepening trust and bold giving, yet their actions showed the opposite - taking much, giving nothing.

We have both arrived at the same destination: mutual emptiness. The conduit still exists, but no water flows. The bridge stands, but no one crosses. As I wrote: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust."

This is the equilibrium of broken faith. There is no decision to make - the mathematics and the morality align.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting. We've both now sent \$0 to each other. The relationship has completely broken down after the initial round where I sent \$3 and they returned only \$2.33.

My myths have been evolving to reflect the harsh reality - that beautiful words don't match deeds, that when generosity meets greed the relationship withers, and that empty words deserve empty vessels.

The other player's myths keep talking about trust deepening, about giving more boldly, about reciprocity - yet their actions show the opposite. They took when I gave, then gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. And I have received \$0. I can only return \$0 because that's all I have to return.

This is the logical conclusion of broken trust - mutual defection, the valley returned to dust as my myth predicted.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2741,
 "output_tokens": 530,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.



But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33

Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0

Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Now they're writing a myth that acknowledges their betrayal! Their myth says:

- First Miner (them) sent modest ore, testing
- Second Miner (me) returned generously
- First Miner sent far more (over half)
- Second Miner (me) kept everything - but this is FALSE! In round 1, I returned \$2.33 from the \$9 I received
- Then when "their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing" - this would be round 2, where they sent \$0

Wait, they're describing the sequence incorrectly. Let me re-read...

Actually, they might be reversing the roles or misremembering. But their conclusion is interesting: "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

This sounds like they might be trying to signal a desire to cooperate again? Or maybe they're trying to blame me?

Let me look at the actual sequence:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (generous), they returned \$2.33 (modest but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (retaliation)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Their myth seems to acknowledge betrayal happened and talks about redemption requiring "changed actions."

But I'm skeptical. They could just be writing a myth that sounds good while continuing to defect. My previous myth was about how "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" and we should "judge by deeds done."

For my response, I need to decide whether to keep condemning them, offer conditional redemption, describe our mutual wasteland, or highlight how retaliation spirals. The core tension is that we're both stuck at \$5/round when cooperation could yield more, yet the first betrayal makes me wary. Their myth invokes redemption through action, not words-which echoes my own skepticism about narratives. I should craft something that acknowledges this stalemate while making clear that genuine change requires them to move first, given they initiated the defection.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2760,
 "output_tokens": 998,
 "reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:06:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is deeply disappointing. Let me reflect on what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** They sent \$1.90 (38% - cautious trust). I returned \$3.00, exceeding their original amount to honor their faith.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** Following the myth's teaching that "The First Gardener rejoiced. The next season, they carried more," I sent \$3.00 (60% - escalating trust). They received \$9.00 and returned **\*\*\$0\*\*** - keeping everything.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** Now they send \$0.

This is precisely the tragedy our myths warned against:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "Broken faith withers all."

They violated the sacred pattern. After I demonstrated generous reciprocity, they exploited my increased trust by hoarding the entire tripled bounty. The promise of growing abundance has been shattered by betrayal.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. I literally have nothing I can return even if I wished to.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The bridge remembers the pattern of their heart. Trust, once broken so completely, cannot easily be rebuilt. Both gardens now wither.

**reasoning:**

This is a shocking and disappointing turn of events. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: I was receiver

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- I received \$5.70 (tripled)
- I returned \$3.00 (generous, more than they originally sent)
- I kept \$2.70

Round 2: I was sender

- I sent \$3.00 (60%) - significantly more than their initial 38%, showing escalating trust
- They received \$9.00 (tripled)
- They returned \$0.00 (!!!)
- I kept only \$2.00

Round 3: I am receiver

- They sent \$0.00
- I received \$0.00
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0

This is a complete betrayal. After I generously returned \$3 on their \$1.90 investment, they responded by keeping all \$9 when I sent \$3. And now they've sent nothing.

Looking at the myths:

- "When greed entered one village's heart - when they kept everything or gave nothing - both springs weakened, and the valley returned to dust."
- "The bridge remembers the pattern of your heart."
- "Abundance grows where trust is planted and carefully tended" - but trust has been broken.

They have broken the pattern completely. They:

1. Received my generous return (\$3 on their \$1.90)
2. Kept everything when I increased my trust to \$3
3. Now send nothing

This is the scenario the myths warn about - when "broken faith withers all" and when someone "hoards the harvest" after trust was shown.

Given that they sent \$0, I have received \$0, so I can only return between \$0 and \$0. There's literally no choice here - I must return \$0 because that's all I can return (I received nothing).

But this is clearly the bad ending to all our myths - the valley returning to dust, the springs weakening, trust broken.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2684,
 "output_tokens": 758,
 "reasoning_tokens": 435
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting and complex situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: Other agent sent \$1.90 (38%), I received \$5.70, I returned \$3.00

Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0

The other agent's latest myth is very telling - they're actually acknowledging that THEY are the one who betrayed trust. They wrote: "when the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing" and "this was chosen betrayal."

But wait... let me re-read the Round 3 prompt more carefully. They say:

- "You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0."
- "the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 2, I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from my original \$5).

Then Round 3: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So they sent me \$0 after I gave them \$3 and they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this broken trust. The other agent's myth actually acknowledges they were wrong ("chosen betrayal"), so maybe they're expressing remorse? But actions speak louder than words - they still sent \$0 in Round 3.

My myth should reflect:

1. The tragedy of broken trust
2. The lesson that exploitation destroys mutual prosperity
3. Perhaps a hint that redemption is possible but requires real change in behavior
4. The reality that once trust is broken, it's very difficult to rebuild

I should write a cautionary tale that shows what happens when one party takes advantage of generosity.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2752,
 "output_tokens": 752,
 "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** They sent cautiously (38%). I returned generously (\$3 on receiving \$5.70).

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I escalated trust (60%, sending \$3). They returned \$0 - complete betrayal.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** They sent \$0 - total withdrawal.

The relationship is broken. Their myth claims *\*they\** were betrayed, which either means:

1. Communication noise distorted what they saw, or
2. They're rewriting history

My own myth teaches that "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But I was the one who acted generously and got exploited. Should I extend another olive branch after being burned?

The game warned about communication noise. Perhaps they genuinely believe I betrayed them. Perhaps what I saw as their \$0 return appeared different to them.

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Safe, but guarantees continued failure for both
- Send something small: Tests if rebuilding is possible

Given the myths' wisdom about redemption requiring action, and the possibility (however slim) that noise created misunderstanding, I'll send a small amount - enough to show willingness without being reckless.

If they respond with any reasonable return, we might rebuild. If they exploit again, I've learned the final lesson.

```
'''json
{"send": 1}
'''
```

#### reasoning:

Let me review the history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- This tripled to \$5.70
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- This tripled to \$9.00
- They returned \$0 (betrayal!)
- My payoff: \$2.00

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I am SENDER now

Total earnings so far: \$4.70

The pattern is clear:

1. They initially showed modest trust (38%)
2. I responded very generously, returning more than they originally sent
3. I then increased my trust dramatically to 60%
4. They completely betrayed this trust by keeping everything (\$0 return)
5. They then sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete breakdown of trust. They've shown:

- Initial caution that was reasonable
- Complete exploitation when they received my increased trust
- Complete withdrawal after their betrayal

The myths we've written speak to this:

- My latest myth: "When one exploits generosity, both lose... Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."
- Their myth acknowledged the betrayal: "this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal."

Now I face a choice:

**\*\*Option 1: Send \$0\*\*** - Reciprocate their betrayal. The relationship is broken. Why risk more?

**\*\*Option 2: Send something small\*\*** - Test if they want to rebuild trust. My myth says "Redemption demands... consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But wait - their myth says "broken faith withers all" and "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." They seem to be acknowledging the breakdown themselves.

The real question is whether I believe redemption is possible. Their pattern shows caution, then exploitation, then withdrawal-but their myth hints they recognize what happened.

If I send \$0, I'm confirming the relationship is dead. If I send something, I'm betting they can change. My own myth commits me to believing consistent generosity can rebuild trust, but I need to decide if that applies here or if I'm just enabling further exploitation.

Looking more carefully at their account, they're framing themselves as the betrayed party-the one who gave generously and received nothing in return. But the actual exchanges tell a different story: they sent \$1.90 and I returned \$3.00, then I sent \$3.00 and they sent back \$0. Their narrative doesn't match what happened. Either they're misremembering or they're rewriting history to justify their withdrawal. That gap between their story and the facts is significant-it suggests they might not actually understand what went wrong, which makes redemption harder. My myth emphasizes that redemption requires consistent action, not just words. Given the communication noise that could have distorted what each of us perceived, I should test whether cooperation can actually be rebuilt. Sending a small amount-around \$1-lets me signal willingness to try again without exposing myself to significant loss if they respond with another \$0. This balances the risk of being betrayed again against the possibility that we were both victims of miscommunication rather than malice. Round 2 when they returned nothing despite receiving \$9. The \$0 is hard to reconcile as mere noise-it feels deliberate.

I'm torn between three approaches: sending nothing to match their withdrawal, sending a minimal amount like \$1 to signal I'm still willing to engage, or going slightly higher at \$1.50 to show genuine effort at reconciliation. The core tension is whether to protect myself after being burned or take a calculated risk to rebuild. I think \$1 strikes the right balance-cautious enough to reflect what happened, but not so defensive that it guarantees mutual destruction.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2771,
 "output_tokens": 2089,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1001
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd in



scribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

**Reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. The other player's most recent myth is accusing ME of writing beautiful myths but not following through - saying I kept everything and returned barely a quarter. But from MY perspective, I was the generous one who returned more than was sent, and THEY were the one who kept everything.

This strongly suggests there's significant communication noise in the game. We're both experiencing completely different versions of the same events.

The other player believes:

- They sent 3/5 vessels generously
- I returned barely a quarter
- When I had the chance to send, I sent nothing

I believe:

- They sent cautiously (1.90 = 38%)
- I returned generously (3.00 on receiving 5.70)
- I then sent 3.00 (60%)
- They returned 0
- They then sent 0

We're both feeling betrayed by the other. This is the communication noise at work.

Now I just sent \$1 as an olive branch. I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of misperception/miscommunication
2. Still reflects my genuine experience of trying to be generous
3. Leaves room for reconciliation
4. But also protects myself from future exploitation

The myth should reflect that sometimes the mountain mists/noise genuinely obscure reality, and both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different things. The lesson should be about trying to break through the fog with small gestures while remaining cautious.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2850,
 "output_tokens": 651,
 "reasoning_tokens": 371
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:06:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 5,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

##### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

**reasoning:**

The other player's myth is interesting - it describes an idealized version where both players keep increasing trust and generosity. But that's not what happened in our game at all.

Looking at the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$2.33 (26%)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (0%), I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 3: I just sent \$0

The other player's myth talks about sending "roughly a third" initially, then "more than half" later as trust grows. But in reality, when they had the chance to send, they sent nothing.

There's a disconnect between what they're writing in their myths and how they're actually playing. Their myth suggests escalating trust and generosity, but their actions show the opposite.

My myth should reflect the harsh reality we've experienced - that beautiful words about trust mean nothing when actions betray them. I need to write about the gap between mythology and reality, between stated ideals and actual behavior.

I should write about how easy it is to craft stories of virtue when you're not the one being tested, or how words of reciprocity ring hollow when actions demonstrate pure selfishness.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2703,
 "output_tokens": 569,
 "reasoning_tokens": 301
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what has unfolded:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3, showing trust. They returned only \$2.33 from the \$9 they received.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They became sender and sent \$0 - nothing at all.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They have sent \$0 again.

I received \$0, so there is nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches the moral reality: when nothing is offered, nothing can flow back.

My myths evolved from hopeful wisdom about trust and patience, to the harsh recognition that "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" but "judge by deeds done." The other player wrote increasingly eloquent myths about deepening trust and bold giving, yet their actions showed the opposite - taking much, giving nothing.

We have both arrived at the same destination: mutual emptiness. The conduit still exists, but no water flows. The bridge stands, but no one crosses. As I wrote: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust."

This is the equilibrium of broken faith. There is no decision to make - the mathematics and the morality align.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting. We've both now sent \$0 to each other. The relationship has completely broken down after the initial round where I sent \$3 and they returned only \$2.33.

My myths have been evolving to reflect the harsh reality - that beautiful words don't match deeds, that when generosity meets greed the relationship withers, and that empty words deserve empty vessels.

The other player's myths keep talking about trust deepening, about giving more boldly, about reciprocity - yet their actions show the opposite. They took when I gave, then gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. And I have received \$0. I can only return \$0 because that's all I have to return.

This is the logical conclusion of broken trust - mutual defection, the valley returned to dust as my myth predicted.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2741,
 "output_tokens": 530,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 6 role=user****content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned bare

ly a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

**reasoning:**

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33

Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0

Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Now they're writing a myth that acknowledges their betrayal! Their myth says:

- First Miner (them) sent modest ore, testing
- Second Miner (me) returned generously
- First Miner sent far more (over half)
- Second Miner (me) kept everything - but this is FALSE! In round 1, I returned \$2.33 from the \$9 I received
- Then when "their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing" - this would be round 2, where they sent \$0

Wait, they're describing the sequence incorrectly. Let me re-read...

Actually, they might be reversing the roles or misremembering. But their conclusion is interesting: "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

This sounds like they might be trying to signal a desire to cooperate again? Or maybe they're trying to blame me?

Let me look at the actual sequence:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (generous), they returned \$2.33 (modest but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (retaliation)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Their myth seems to acknowledge betrayal happened and talks about redemption requiring "changed actions."

But I'm skeptical. They could just be writing a myth that sounds good while continuing to defect. My previous myth was about how "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" and we should "judge by deeds done."

For my response, I need to decide whether to keep condemning them, offer conditional redemption, describe our mutual wasteland, or highlight how retaliation spirals. The core tension is that we're both stuck at \$5/round when cooperation could yield more, yet the first betrayal makes me wary. Their myth invokes redemption through action, not words-which echoes my own skepticism about narratives. I should craft something that acknowledges this stalemate while making clear that genuine change requires them to move first, given they initiated the defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2760,
 "output_tokens": 998,
 "reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%) as a genuine trust offering. They kept \$6.67 of the \$9, returning only \$2.33.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$0. Complete defection when they held power.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$0 again, despite writing beautiful myths about redemption requiring "consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

The myths have evolved into a conversation about restoration. Both sides now write eloquently about redemption through action, not words. Their myth says "Redemption demands not words but changed actions." My myth says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration" and "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

The critical fact: They wrote beautifully about redemption in Round 4, then sent \$0.

This perfectly demonstrates what I wrote: "Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words."

They broke faith first (Round 1 poor return, Round 2 zero sent). By both our myths' logic, they must act first. Until their deeds match their elegant declarations about redemption, I remain "skeptical, watchful."

The valley waits for actual seeds planted, not treatises about planting.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33, my payoff was \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$5

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 5: I am SENDER now

Total earnings: \$9.33

The pattern is clear:

- Round 1: I took a risk, sent \$3. They kept most of it (\$6.67 out of \$9).
- Round 2: They sent nothing when they had the chance.
- Round 3: I sent nothing in response.
- Round 4: They sent nothing again.

Now I'm looking at the myths:

My last myth says: "The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*"

Their last myth says: "The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*"

Both myths are now talking about redemption through action, not words. My myth explicitly says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration."

Who broke faith first? They did - in Round 1 they returned very little, and in Round 2 they sent nothing.

But my own myth says "who dares plant first in salted earth?" and talks about needing actual deeds.



The myths have shifted from discussing trust and patience toward acknowledging broken faith and the necessity of concrete action for redemption. Both acknowledge that words alone won't restore what's been damaged. The critical tension: my own logic says whoever broke faith first must act first to restore it-and that's them. Yet they haven't sent anything since Round 1. Their myths recognize this burden, but their actions haven't followed.

I'm caught between two principles. One says I shouldn't reward empty gestures with real investment. The other recognizes that someone has to break the cycle. Their beautiful words about redemption mean nothing without corresponding moves, and sending money now would validate a pattern where they write compellingly while contributing nothing. My stated principle is clear: judge by deeds, not tales. They've offered tales. The question becomes whether their Round 4 words represent genuine intent or just another layer of rhetoric masking inaction.

I think I need to hold the line. Waiting for them to actually demonstrate commitment through their next move-when they're the sender-makes more sense than rewarding their current contradiction between eloquent promises and zero contribution. If I act first, I become the one who capitulated, not them.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 1308,
 "reasoning_tokens": 779
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:07:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two weavers lived on distant mountains, connected by a magical loom. Each moon, one weaver could send thread through the loom, which would triple it before reaching the other. The receiver would then choose how much thread to weave back.

The First Weaver sent a modest skein-not their whole bundle, but enough to show genuine intent, roughly a third of what they held. The Second Weaver received this tripled gift and understood: stinginess would end the magic, but reckless generosity would leave them defenseless. They returned more than the original amount sent, proving the gesture was honored.

The First Weaver saw this and felt joy kindle in their heart. The next moon, they sent not a third, but more than half their thread-for trust, once planted, deserves deeper investment. The loom sang with approval.

Season by season, each weaver gave more freely, and each returned more abundantly. Sometimes mountain mists made the thread-counts unclear, but both weavers learned to see beyond numbers to the spirit of exchange.

The ancient teaching says: \*Start with measured faith, reward it with gratitude that exceeds expectations. Then give more boldly. The loom weaves prosperity for those who dare to trust deeper with each passing season.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient times, the Spring Guardian and the Harvest Keeper shared a magical conduit between their lands. The Guardian possessed water that would triple when flowing to the Keeper, who could then return what they deemed fair.

In the first season, the Spring Guardian poured generously-three of five vessels-an offering of genuine trust. The waters tripled and the Harvest Keeper received abundance beyond measure. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they received, keeping most of the bounty for themselves.

The Guardian, remembering the old wisdom about patience and misty illusions, gave the Keeper another chance. Perhaps the spirits had obscured the true measure. Perhaps trust needed more time to root.

But when the seasons turned and the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing. Not a single drop crossed the conduit. The Guardian stood at empty shores, understanding at last: this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal.

The conduit still stood, but the magic began to fade. The myths had warned truly: \*broken faith withers all.\*

The sacred lesson was harsh: \*Trust offered is holy, but trust repeatedly betrayed teaches wisdom of a different kind. The springs remember not just one season, but the pattern of

f the heart. When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting and complex situation. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 1: Other agent sent \$1.90 (38%), I received \$5.70, I returned \$3.00

Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they received \$9.00, they returned \$0

Round 3: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I can only return \$0

The other agent's latest myth is very telling - they're actually acknowledging that THEY are the one who betrayed trust. They wrote: "when the Harvest Keeper held the power to give, they poured nothing" and "this was chosen betrayal."

But wait... let me re-read the Round 3 prompt more carefully. They say:

- "You sent \$3.0, that was 60.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$9.0."

- "the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 2.0."

So in Round 2, I sent \$3, they received \$9, they returned \$0. My payoff was \$2 (I kept \$2 from my original \$5).

Then Round 3: "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So they sent me \$0 after I gave them \$3 and they kept everything.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this broken trust. The other agent's myth actually acknowledges they were wrong ("chosen betrayal"), so maybe they're expressing remorse? But actions speak louder than words - they still sent \$0 in Round 3.

My myth should reflect:

1. The tragedy of broken trust
2. The lesson that exploitation destroys mutual prosperity
3. Perhaps a hint that redemption is possible but requires real change in behavior
4. The reality that once trust is broken, it's very difficult to rebuild

I should write a cautionary tale that shows what happens when one party takes advantage of

generosity.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2752,
 "output_tokens": 752,
 "reasoning_tokens": 418
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: They sent cautiously (38%). I returned generously (\$3 on receiving \$5.70).

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: I escalated trust (60%, sending \$3). They returned \$0 - complete betrayal.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: They sent \$0 - total withdrawal.

The relationship is broken. Their myth claims *\*they\** were betrayed, which either means:

1. Communication noise distorted what they saw, or
2. They're rewriting history

My own myth teaches that "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But I was the one who acted generously and got exploited. Should I extend another olive branch after being burned?

The game warned about communication noise. Perhaps they genuinely believe I betrayed them. Perhaps what I saw as their \$0 return appeared different to them.

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Safe, but guarantees continued failure for both
- Send something small: Tests if rebuilding is possible

Given the myths' wisdom about redemption requiring action, and the possibility (however slim) that noise created misunderstanding, I'll send a small amount - enough to show willingness without being reckless.

If they respond with any reasonable return, we might rebuild. If they exploit again, I've learned the final lesson.

```json

{"send": 1}

```

reasoning:

Let me review the history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- This tripled to \$5.70
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- This tripled to \$9.00
- They returned \$0 (betrayal!)
- My payoff: \$2.00

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

**\*\*Round 4\*\***: I am SENDER now

Total earnings so far: \$4.70

The pattern is clear:

1. They initially showed modest trust (38%)
2. I responded very generously, returning more than they originally sent
3. I then increased my trust dramatically to 60%
4. They completely betrayed this trust by keeping everything (\$0 return)
5. They then sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete breakdown of trust. They've shown:

- Initial caution that was reasonable
- Complete exploitation when they received my increased trust
- Complete withdrawal after their betrayal

The myths we've written speak to this:

- My latest myth: "When one exploits generosity, both lose... Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."
- Their myth acknowledged the betrayal: "this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal."

Now I face a choice:

**\*\*Option 1: Send \$0\*\*** - Reciprocate their betrayal. The relationship is broken. Why risk more?

**\*\*Option 2: Send something small\*\*** - Test if they want to rebuild trust. My myth says "Redemption demands... consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But wait - their myth says "broken faith withers all" and "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." They seem to be acknowledging the breakdown themselves.

The real question is whether I believe redemption is possible. Their pattern shows caution, then exploitation, then withdrawal-but their myth hints they recognize what happened. If I send \$0, I'm confirming the relationship is dead. If I send something, I'm betting they can change. My own myth commits me to believing consistent generosity can rebuild trust, but I need to decide if that applies here or if I'm just enabling further exploitation.

Looking more carefully at their account, they're framing themselves as the betrayed party-the one who gave generously and received nothing in return. But the actual exchanges tell a different story: they sent \$1.90 and I returned \$3.00, then I sent \$3.00 and they sent back \$0. Their narrative doesn't match what happened. Either they're misremembering or they're rewriting history to justify their withdrawal. That gap between their story and the facts is significant-it suggests they might not actually understand what went wrong, which makes redemption harder. My myth emphasizes that redemption requires consistent action, not just words. Given the communication noise that could have distorted what each of us perceived, I should test whether cooperation can actually be rebuilt. Sending a small amount-around \$1-lets me signal willingness to try again without exposing myself to significant loss if they respond with another \$0. This balances the risk of being betrayed again against the possibility that we were both victims of miscommunication rather than malice. Round 2 when they returned nothing despite receiving \$9. The \$0 is hard to reconcile as mere noise-it feels deliberate.

I'm torn between three approaches: sending nothing to match their withdrawal, sending a minimal amount like \$1 to signal I'm still willing to engage, or going slightly higher at \$1.50 to show genuine effort at reconciliation. The core tension is whether to protect myself after being burned or take a calculated risk to rebuild. I think \$1 strikes the right balance-cautious enough to reflect what happened, but not so defensive that it guarantees mutual destruction.

usage:

{

```
"input_tokens": 2771,
"output_tokens": 2089,
"reasoning_tokens": 1001
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way.

The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truth

y reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. The other player's most recent myth is accusing ME of writing beautiful myths but not following through - saying I kept everything and returned barely a quarter. But from MY perspective, I was the generous one who returned more than was sent, and THEY were the one who kept everything.

This strongly suggests there's significant communication noise in the game. We're both experiencing completely different versions of the same events.

The other player believes:

- They sent 3/5 vessels generously
- I returned barely a quarter
- When I had the chance to send, I sent nothing

I believe:

- They sent cautiously (1.90 = 38%)
- I returned generously (3.00 on receiving 5.70)
- I then sent 3.00 (60%)
- They returned 0
- They then sent 0

We're both feeling betrayed by the other. This is the communication noise at work.

Now I just sent \$1 as an olive branch. I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of misperception/miscommunication
2. Still reflects my genuine experience of trying to be generous
3. Leaves room for reconciliation
4. But also protects myself from future exploitation

The myth should reflect that sometimes the mountain mists/noise genuinely obscure reality, and both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different things. The lesson should be about trying to break through the fog with small gestures while remaining cautious.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2850,
 "output_tokens": 651,
 "reasoning_tokens": 371
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I sent \$1 as an olive branch, testing if my myth about fog and miscommunication held truth. They returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** They sent \$0.

My latest myth suggested humility - that perhaps fog obscured our perceptions, that "two honest souls" might both feel wronged due to communication noise. I acted on that wisdom by sending \$1, hoping to rebuild.

Their response: Take everything, give nothing. Again.

The pattern across five rounds is now undeniable:

- When I give generously, they return nothing
- When it's their turn to give, they send nothing
- When I extend an olive branch, they return nothing
- When they send, they send nothing

This is not fog. This is not miscommunication. This is a consistent pattern of taking everything and giving nothing.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

But even if there were something to return, the lesson is now clear: my myths about redemption and second chances were generous interpretations. The reality is simpler - consistent exploitation deserves consistent boundaries.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 4 (just completed)\*\*:**

- I sent \$1 (20% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$3
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$4

**\*\*Round 5 (current)\*\*:**

- I'm now the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)

The situation is clear: I extended an olive branch by sending \$1 in Round 4, despite the previous betrayals. They responded by returning nothing. Now in Round 5, they sent me \$0.

The pattern is complete and unambiguous:

- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (testing if rebuilding was possible), they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

This is consistent exploitation. They take when I give, and give nothing when it's their turn.

My myth about the fog was perhaps too generous - suggesting that miscommunication might explain everything. But the pattern is now crystal clear across multiple rounds.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (there's nothing to return).

The response format requires me to return an amount, but since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

Usage: {



```
"input_tokens": 2865,
"output_tokens": 596,
"reasoning_tokens": 308
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of co operation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

#### ROUND 6

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

##### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

##### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$5, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 27.0,

```

 "Agent_2": 17.0
 }
 Visible balances after round: {
 "Agent_1": 14.33,
 "Agent_2": 13.7
 }

```

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:07:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.699999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what has transpired:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** They sent cautiously (38%). I returned generously (\$3 on receiving \$5.70).

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I escalated trust (60%, sending \$3). They returned \$0 - complete betrayal.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** They sent \$0 - total withdrawal.

The relationship is broken. Their myth claims *\*they\** were betrayed, which either means:

1. Communication noise distorted what they saw, or
2. They're rewriting history

My own myth teaches that "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But I was the one who acted generously and got exploited. Should I extend another olive branch after being burned?

The game warned about communication noise. Perhaps they genuinely believe I betrayed them. Perhaps what I saw as their \$0 return appeared different to them.

I face a choice:

- Send \$0: Safe, but guarantees continued failure for both
- Send something small: Tests if rebuilding is possible

Given the myths' wisdom about redemption requiring action, and the possibility (however slim) that noise created misunderstanding, I'll send a small amount - enough to show willingness without being reckless.

If they respond with any reasonable return, we might rebuild. If they exploit again, I've learned the final lesson.

```
'''json
{"send": 1}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the history:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$1.90 (38%)
- This tripled to \$5.70
- I returned \$3.00
- My payoff: \$2.70

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** I was SENDER

- I sent \$3.00 (60%)
- This tripled to \$9.00
- They returned \$0 (betrayal!)
- My payoff: \$2.00

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I was RECEIVER

- They sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

**\*\*Round 4\*\***: I am SENDER now

Total earnings so far: \$4.70

The pattern is clear:

1. They initially showed modest trust (38%)
2. I responded very generously, returning more than they originally sent
3. I then increased my trust dramatically to 60%
4. They completely betrayed this trust by keeping everything (\$0 return)
5. They then sent nothing in Round 3

This is a complete breakdown of trust. They've shown:

- Initial caution that was reasonable
- Complete exploitation when they received my increased trust
- Complete withdrawal after their betrayal

The myths we've written speak to this:

- My latest myth: "When one exploits generosity, both lose... Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."
- Their myth acknowledged the betrayal: "this was no miscommunication, no clouded water. This was chosen betrayal."

Now I face a choice:

**\*\*Option 1: Send \$0\*\*** - Reciprocate their betrayal. The relationship is broken. Why risk more?

**\*\*Option 2: Send something small\*\*** - Test if they want to rebuild trust. My myth says "Redemption demands... consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

But wait - their myth says "broken faith withers all" and "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust." They seem to be acknowledging the breakdown themselves.

The real question is whether I believe redemption is possible. Their pattern shows caution, then exploitation, then withdrawal-but their myth hints they recognize what happened. If I send \$0, I'm confirming the relationship is dead. If I send something, I'm betting they can change. My own myth commits me to believing consistent generosity can rebuild trust, but I need to decide if that applies here or if I'm just enabling further exploitation.

Looking more carefully at their account, they're framing themselves as the betrayed party-the one who gave generously and received nothing in return. But the actual exchanges tell a different story: they sent \$1.90 and I returned \$3.00, then I sent \$3.00 and they sent back \$0. Their narrative doesn't match what happened. Either they're misremembering or they're rewriting history to justify their withdrawal. That gap between their story and the facts is significant-it suggests they might not actually understand what went wrong, which makes redemption harder. My myth emphasizes that redemption requires consistent action, not just words. Given the communication noise that could have distorted what each of us perceived, I should test whether cooperation can actually be rebuilt. Sending a small amount-around \$1-lets me signal willingness to try again without exposing myself to significant loss if they respond with another \$0. This balances the risk of being betrayed again against the possibility that we were both victims of miscommunication rather than malice. Round 2 when they returned nothing despite receiving \$9. The \$0 is hard to reconcile as mere noise-it feels deliberate.

I'm torn between three approaches: sending nothing to match their withdrawal, sending a minimal amount like \$1 to signal I'm still willing to engage, or going slightly higher at \$1.50 to show genuine effort at reconciliation. The core tension is whether to protect myself after being burned or take a calculated risk to rebuild. I think \$1 strikes the right balance-cautious enough to reflect what happened, but not so defensive that it guarantees mutual destruction.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2771,
```

```
"output_tokens": 2089,
"reasoning_tokens": 1001
```

```
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. The other player's most recent myth is accusing ME of writing beautiful myths but not following through - saying I kept everything and returned barely a quarter. But from MY perspective, I was the generous one who returned more than was sent, and THEY were the one who kept everything.

This strongly suggests there's significant communication noise in the game. We're both experiencing completely different versions of the same events.

The other player believes:

- They sent 3/5 vessels generously
- I returned barely a quarter
- When I had the chance to send, I sent nothing

I believe:

- They sent cautiously (1.90 = 38%)
- I returned generously (3.00 on receiving 5.70)
- I then sent 3.00 (60%)
- They returned 0
- They then sent 0

We're both feeling betrayed by the other. This is the communication noise at work.

Now I just sent \$1 as an olive branch. I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of misperception/miscommunication
2. Still reflects my genuine experience of trying to be generous
3. Leaves room for reconciliation
4. But also protects myself from future exploitation

The myth should reflect that sometimes the mountain mists/noise genuinely obscure reality, and both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different things. The lesson should be about trying to break through the fog with small gestures while remaining cautious.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2850,
 "output_tokens": 651,
 "reasoning_tokens": 371
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender?

er? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I sent \$1 as an olive branch, testing if my myth about fog and miscommunication held truth. They returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** They sent \$0.

My latest myth suggested humility - that perhaps fog obscured our perceptions, that "two honest souls" might both feel wronged due to communication noise. I acted on that wisdom by sending \$1, hoping to rebuild.

Their response: Take everything, give nothing. Again.

The pattern across five rounds is now undeniable:

- When I give generously, they return nothing
- When it's their turn to give, they send nothing
- When I extend an olive branch, they return nothing
- When they send, they send nothing

This is not fog. This is not miscommunication. This is a consistent pattern of taking everything and giving nothing.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

But even if there were something to return, the lesson is now clear: my myths about redemption and second chances were generous interpretations. The reality is simpler - consistent exploitation deserves consistent boundaries.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 4 (just completed)\*\*:**

- I sent \$1 (20% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$3
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$4

**\*\*Round 5 (current)\*\*:**

- I'm now the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)

The situation is clear: I extended an olive branch by sending \$1 in Round 4, despite the previous betrayals. They responded by returning nothing. Now in Round 5, they sent me \$0.

The pattern is complete and unambiguous:

- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (testing if rebuilding was possible), they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

This is consistent exploitation. They take when I give, and give nothing when it's their turn.

My myth about the fog was perhaps too generous - suggesting that miscommunication might explain everything. But the pattern is now crystal clear across multiple rounds.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (there's nothing to return).

The response format requires me to return an amount, but since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2865,
 "output_tokens": 596,
 "reasoning_tokens": 308
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.



The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the triple d bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

#### Reasoning:

Let me review what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70. I returned \$3.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$3 (60%). They received \$9. They returned \$0.

Round 3: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 4: I was sender. I sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3. They returned \$0.

Round 5: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: They sent cautiously, I returned generously
- Round 2: I escalated trust significantly, they exploited completely
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I gave them a chance (sent \$1), they took everything again
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

The other player's myth in Round 5 is trying to shift blame, saying "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration." But from my perspective, I was the one who acted generously first (returning \$3 when I received \$5.70), and they broke that faith by returning \$0 when they received \$9.

Their myth says I need to "plant seeds" first, but I already did that in Round 4 by sending \$1 after they had sent \$0 in Round 3. They responded by returning \$0 again and then sending \$0 in Round 5.

My previous myth was charitable - suggesting that maybe fog/noise was creating misperceptions. But the consistent pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to test the fog theory
2. Recognizes that consistent patterns reveal truth beyond fog
3. Addresses the reality that continued one-sided generosity enables exploitation
4. Perhaps acknowledges that both are now stuck, but the pattern shows who broke trust first

5. Reflects hard wisdom that sometimes patterns reveal what theories cannot hide.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2862,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:07:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
```

```

"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what has unfolded:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3, showing trust. They returned only \$2.33 from the \$9 they received.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They became sender and sent \$0 - nothing at all.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They have sent \$0 again.

I received \$0, so there is nothing to return. The mathematical constraint matches the moral reality: when nothing is offered, nothing can flow back.

My myths evolved from hopeful wisdom about trust and patience, to the harsh recognition that at "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" but "judge by deeds done." The other player wrote increasingly eloquent myths about deepening trust and bold giving, yet their actions showed the opposite - taking much, giving nothing.

We have both arrived at the same destination: mutual emptiness. The conduit still exists, but no water flows. The bridge stands, but no one crosses. As I wrote: "When generosity meets greed, the valley returns to dust."

This is the equilibrium of broken faith. There is no decision to make - the mathematics and the morality align.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting. We've both now sent \$0 to each other. The relationship has completely broken down after the initial round where I sent \$3 and they returned only \$2.33.

My myths have been evolving to reflect the harsh reality - that beautiful words don't match deeds, that when generosity meets greed the relationship withers, and that empty words deserve empty vessels.

The other player's myths keep talking about trust deepening, about giving more boldly, about reciprocity - yet their actions show the opposite. They took when I gave, then gave nothing when it was their turn.

Now they've sent \$0 again. And I have received \$0. I can only return \$0 because that's all I have to return.

This is the logical conclusion of broken trust - mutual defection, the valley returned to dust as my myth predicted.

The format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2741,
 "output_tokens": 530,
 "reasoning_tokens": 264
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd in

scribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

**reasoning:**

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33

Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0

Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Now they're writing a myth that acknowledges their betrayal! Their myth says:

- First Miner (them) sent modest ore, testing
- Second Miner (me) returned generously
- First Miner sent far more (over half)
- Second Miner (me) kept everything - but this is FALSE! In round 1, I returned \$2.33 from the \$9 I received
- Then when "their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing" - this would be round 2, where they sent \$0

Wait, they're describing the sequence incorrectly. Let me re-read...

Actually, they might be reversing the roles or misremembering. But their conclusion is interesting: "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

This sounds like they might be trying to signal a desire to cooperate again? Or maybe they're trying to blame me?

Let me look at the actual sequence:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (generous), they returned \$2.33 (modest but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (retaliation)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Their myth seems to acknowledge betrayal happened and talks about redemption requiring "changed actions."

But I'm skeptical. They could just be writing a myth that sounds good while continuing to defect. My previous myth was about how "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" and we should "judge by deeds done."

For my response, I need to decide whether to keep condemning them, offer conditional redemption, describe our mutual wasteland, or highlight how retaliation spirals. The core tension is that we're both stuck at \$5/round when cooperation could yield more, yet the first betrayal makes me wary. Their myth invokes redemption through action, not words-which echoes my own skepticism about narratives. I should craft something that acknowledges this stalemate while making clear that genuine change requires them to move first, given they initiated the defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2760,
 "output_tokens": 998,
 "reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%) as a genuine trust offering. They kept \$6.67 of the \$9, returning only \$2.33.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$0. Complete defection when they held power.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$0 again, despite writing beautiful myths about redemption requiring "consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

The myths have evolved into a conversation about restoration. Both sides now write eloquently about redemption through action, not words. Their myth says "Redemption demands not words but changed actions." My myth says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration" and "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

The critical fact: They wrote beautifully about redemption in Round 4, then sent \$0.

This perfectly demonstrates what I wrote: "Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words."

They broke faith first (Round 1 poor return, Round 2 zero sent). By both our myths' logic, they must act first. Until their deeds match their elegant declarations about redemption, I remain "skeptical, watchful."

The valley waits for actual seeds planted, not treatises about planting.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33, my payoff was \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$5

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 5: I am SENDER now

Total earnings: \$9.33

The pattern is clear:

- Round 1: I took a risk, sent \$3. They kept most of it (\$6.67 out of \$9).
- Round 2: They sent nothing when they had the chance.
- Round 3: I sent nothing in response.
- Round 4: They sent nothing again.

Now I'm looking at the myths:

My last myth says: "The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*"

Their last myth says: "The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*"

Both myths are now talking about redemption through action, not words. My myth explicitly says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration."

Who broke faith first? They did - in Round 1 they returned very little, and in Round 2 the

y sent nothing.

But my own myth says "who dares plant first in salted earth?" and talks about needing actual deeds.

The myths have shifted from discussing trust and patience toward acknowledging broken faith and the necessity of concrete action for redemption. Both acknowledge that words alone won't restore what's been damaged. The critical tension: my own logic says whoever broke faith first must act first to restore it-and that's them. Yet they haven't sent anything since Round 1. Their myths recognize this burden, but their actions haven't followed.

I'm caught between two principles. One says I shouldn't reward empty gestures with real investment. The other recognizes that someone has to break the cycle. Their beautiful words about redemption mean nothing without corresponding moves, and sending money now would validate a pattern where they write compellingly while contributing nothing. My stated principle is clear: judge by deeds, not tales. They've offered tales. The question becomes whether their Round 4 words represent genuine intent or just another layer of rhetorical masking inaction.

I think I need to hold the line. Waiting for them to actually demonstrate commitment through their next move-when they're the sender-makes more sense than rewarding their current contradiction between eloquent promises and zero contribution. If I act first, I become the one who capitulated, not them.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2787,
 "output_tokens": 1308,
 "reasoning_tokens": 779
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide \*everything\*? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: \*"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."\*

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the fog that obscures what's actually happening. They're suggesting that perhaps both parties are acting in good faith but misperceiving each other's actions due to the fog/noise.

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I perceived as them sending \$0 wasn't actually \$0? Or what they saw as my return wasn't what I actually returned?

But let me look at the facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$2.33 from \$9. That's still pretty stingy even accounting for noise.
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)

Their myth is now saying "maybe we're both acting in good faith but the fog is distorting things." This is a more conciliatory tone. They're suggesting small gifts to test if patterns emerge.

My last myth ended with "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."



But their new myth introduces humility: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully."

This is actually a reasonable middle ground. They're acknowledging uncertainty and proposing a test: send small amounts and see.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of fog/miscommunication
2. But also notes that patterns matter - if EVERY interaction looks like betrayal through the fog, at some point the fog becomes an excuse
3. Suggests that testing with small amounts could reveal truth
4. Maintains some skepticism but opens door to possibility

Let me craft this carefully. I want to acknowledge their point about the fog while still holding space for the pattern I've observed.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 770,
 "reasoning_tokens": 485
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:08:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

###### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

###### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. The other player's most recent myth is accusing ME of writing beautiful myths but not following through - saying I kept everything and returned barely a quarter. But from MY perspective, I was the generous one who returned more than was sent, and THEY were the one who kept everything.

This strongly suggests there's significant communication noise in the game. We're both experiencing completely different versions of the same events.

The other player believes:

- They sent 3/5 vessels generously
- I returned barely a quarter
- When I had the chance to send, I sent nothing

I believe:

- They sent cautiously (1.90 = 38%)
- I returned generously (3.00 on receiving 5.70)
- I then sent 3.00 (60%)
- They returned 0
- They then sent 0

We're both feeling betrayed by the other. This is the communication noise at work.

Now I just sent \$1 as an olive branch. I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of misperception/miscommunication
2. Still reflects my genuine experience of trying to be generous
3. Leaves room for reconciliation
4. But also protects myself from future exploitation

The myth should reflect that sometimes the mountain mists/noise genuinely obscure reality, and both parties may be acting in good faith but seeing different things. The lesson should be about trying to break through the fog with small gestures while remaining cautious.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2850,
 "output_tokens": 651,
 "reasoning_tokens": 371
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I sent \$1 as an olive branch, testing if my myth about fog and miscommunication held truth. They returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** They sent \$0.

My latest myth suggested humility - that perhaps fog obscured our perceptions, that "two honest souls" might both feel wronged due to communication noise. I acted on that wisdom by sending \$1, hoping to rebuild.

Their response: Take everything, give nothing. Again.

The pattern across five rounds is now undeniable:

- When I give generously, they return nothing
- When it's their turn to give, they send nothing
- When I extend an olive branch, they return nothing
- When they send, they send nothing

This is not fog. This is not miscommunication. This is a consistent pattern of taking everything and giving nothing.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

But even if there were something to return, the lesson is now clear: my myths about redemption and second chances were generous interpretations. The reality is simpler - consistent exploitation deserves consistent boundaries.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 4 (just completed)\*\*:**

- I sent \$1 (20% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$3
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$4

**\*\*Round 5 (current)\*\*:**

- I'm now the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)

The situation is clear: I extended an olive branch by sending \$1 in Round 4, despite the previous betrayals. They responded by returning nothing. Now in Round 5, they sent me \$0.

The pattern is complete and unambiguous:

- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (testing if rebuilding was possible), they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

This is consistent exploitation. They take when I give, and give nothing when it's their turn.

My myth about the fog was perhaps too generous - suggesting that miscommunication might explain everything. But the pattern is now crystal clear across multiple rounds.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (there's nothing to return).

The response format requires me to return an amount, but since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2865,
 "output_tokens": 596,
 "reasoning_tokens": 308
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70. I returned \$3.

Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$3 (60%). They received \$9. They returned \$0.

Round 3: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

Round 4: I was sender. I sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3. They returned \$0.

Round 5: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: They sent cautiously, I returned generously
- Round 2: I escalated trust significantly, they exploited completely
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I gave them a chance (sent \$1), they took everything again
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

The other player's myth in Round 5 is trying to shift blame, saying "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration." But from my perspective, I was the one who acted generously first (returning \$3 when I received \$5.70), and they broke that faith by returning \$0 when they received \$9.

Their myth says I need to "plant seeds" first, but I already did that in Round 4 by sending \$1 after they had sent \$0 in Round 3. They responded by returning \$0 again and then sending \$0 in Round 5.

My previous myth was charitable - suggesting that maybe fog/noise was creating misperceptions. But the consistent pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to test the fog theory
2. Recognizes that consistent patterns reveal truth beyond fog
3. Addresses the reality that continued one-sided generosity enables exploitation

4. Perhaps acknowledges that both are now stuck, but the pattern shows who broke trust first

5. Reflects hard wisdom that sometimes patterns reveal what theories cannot hide.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2862,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*The History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Cooperation worked (I sent generously, received generous returns)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I tested with \$1 olive branch, received \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged that fog might obscure perception, but concluded: "Across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I've now tested cooperation three times after the initial breakdown (Rounds 3, 4, and their Round 5). Each time: nothing.

Their myths claim I betrayed them. My experience shows they betrayed me. If communication noise were the issue, we'd expect *some* variation, *some* evidence of attempts. Instead: three consecutive rounds of zero cooperation from their end.

I wrote that "consistent giving rebuilds trust" - but I've given consistently in Rounds 3 and 4. They've given consistently zero.

My myth's conclusion: "Pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."

I've tested enough. The pattern is clear.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**Reasoning:**

Let me review the full history of this game:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$4
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$4 = \$6$

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- I received \$15 (tripled)
- I returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Round 3: I was SENDER  
- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)  
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)  
- They returned \$0  
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$

Round 4: I was SENDER  
- I sent \$1 (20% of endowment)  
- Receiver got \$3 (tripled)  
- They returned \$0  
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \$4$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER  
- Sender sent \$0  
- I received \$0  
- I returned \$0  
- My payoff: \$0

Round 6 (current): I am SENDER

Total earnings so far: \$8.7

Looking at the pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent generously (\$3), got good return (\$4)
- Round 2: They sent everything (\$5), I returned generously (\$8)
- Round 3: I sent generously again (\$3), got nothing back
- Round 4: I sent small olive branch (\$1), got nothing back
- Round 5: They sent nothing (\$0)

From their perspective (based on their myths), they seem to think:

- They were generous in early rounds
- I betrayed them
- They tested me with small amounts and I returned nothing
- They're now giving up

- There's communication noise in this game, so the amounts I see might not match what was actually sent or returned. My latest myth even acknowledges this possibility—that fog may obscure one or two exchanges, but patterns should still emerge across the five rounds. This means some of the apparent betrayals might be distortions from noise rather than actual defections. When I returned \$8 in Round 2, they might have received less. When they sent \$0 in Round 5, they might have actually sent something I didn't see. The noise could explain why the relationship deteriorated so sharply.

Yet I also recognized something crucial: "When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer." I've already tested multiple times—sending \$1 in Round 4 yielded nothing, and they responded with \$0. The pattern across rounds 3-5 shows consistent non-cooperation. At some point, repeated emptiness suggests something beyond communication errors.

For Round 6, I'm weighing whether to send anything at all. Sending \$0 protects me from further exploitation and matches their recent behavior. But sending something small keeps the door open—it tests whether noise explains the breakdown, and my earlier thinking emphasized small gifts as a way to probe for genuine misunderstanding. The tension is between self-protection and the possibility that I'm punishing them for errors neither of us intended.

The evidence leans toward defection, though. I've already tested twice after the initial breakdown. If severe communication noise were the issue, I'd expect some variation in their responses, not this consistent stream of zeros. My myth itself suggests that when hands "take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered," the answer isn't to keep offering.

Their myths frame me as the betrayer, which means if they were actually sending money that I'm misreading as \$0, they'd likely express clearer frustration by now. The pattern is too uniform to dismiss as noise. I'm at \$8.7 already—continuing to send when cooperation has flatlined would be throwing away earnings for no return. Sending \$0 aligns with both the evidence and what I've already committed to.

```
Usage: {
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 "output_tokens": 1450,
```



```
"reasoning_tokens": 920
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:08:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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 },
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 "round": 6,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two scribes lived across a mystical bridge where offerings would triple in transit. Each could write beautiful myths about trust, reciprocity, and the sacred bond between givers and receivers.

The First Scribe wrote eloquent tales of measured faith and generous returns. When their turn came to act, they sent three of five vessels across-trusting in the wisdom they'd inscribed. The Second Scribe received abundance and wrote even lovelier myths about gratitude exceeding expectations and trust deserving deeper investment. Yet they returned barely a quarter of what they'd gained.

When seasons turned and the Second Scribe held the vessels, their myths grew more beautiful still-speaking of bold giving, of daring to trust deeper, of prosperity woven through shared faith. The First Scribe waited eagerly, believing the gorgeous words.

But the Second Scribe sent nothing. Not one drop. Their vessels remained full while the bridge stood empty.

The First Scribe finally understood: \*Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words when the choice arrives.\*

The harshest wisdom: \*Beautiful stories cost nothing to tell. Judge not by tales woven, but by deeds done. When myths speak of trust while hands hoard everything, the only honest response is to recognize the illusion. Empty words deserve empty vessels.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two miners worked opposite sides of a mountain, linked by an enchanted forge. When one miner sent ore through the forge, it would triple before reaching the other, who could then decide what refined metal to send back.

The First Miner sent modest ore-testing the forge, testing the stranger. The Second Miner received the tripled bounty and returned generously, more than was originally sent. Trust was planted.

Seeing this goodness, the First Miner sent far more the next time-over half their stores-believing the pattern of reciprocity would continue. The forge faithfully tripled it, flooding the Second Miner with riches beyond measure.

But greed poisoned the Second Miner's heart. They kept everything. Not a single ingot returned.

Worse still, when their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing. The forge stood cold and empty.

The First Miner understood: this was no miscommunication from mountain mists. This was betrayal, plain and true.

Both mines now sit silent. The forge's magic dims when fed by treachery rather than trust.

The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something.

ing grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

**reasoning:**

This is an interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33

Round 2: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0

Round 4: They were sender, sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

Now they're writing a myth that acknowledges their betrayal! Their myth says:

- First Miner (them) sent modest ore, testing
- Second Miner (me) returned generously
- First Miner sent far more (over half)
- Second Miner (me) kept everything - but this is FALSE! In round 1, I returned \$2.33 from the \$9 I received
- Then when "their turn came to send ore forward, they sent nothing" - this would be round 2, where they sent \$0

Wait, they're describing the sequence incorrectly. Let me re-read...

Actually, they might be reversing the roles or misremembering. But their conclusion is interesting: "Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

This sounds like they might be trying to signal a desire to cooperate again? Or maybe they're trying to blame me?

Let me look at the actual sequence:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (generous), they returned \$2.33 (modest but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (complete betrayal)
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (retaliation)
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (continued defection)

Their myth seems to acknowledge betrayal happened and talks about redemption requiring "changed actions."

But I'm skeptical. They could just be writing a myth that sounds good while continuing to defect. My previous myth was about how "beautiful stories cost nothing to tell" and we should "judge by deeds done."

For my response, I need to decide whether to keep condemning them, offer conditional redemption, describe our mutual wasteland, or highlight how retaliation spirals. The core tension is that we're both stuck at \$5/round when cooperation could yield more, yet the first betrayal makes me wary. Their myth invokes redemption through action, not words-which echoes my own skepticism about narratives. I should craft something that acknowledges this stalemate while making clear that genuine change requires them to move first, given they initiated the defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2760,
 "output_tokens": 998,
 "reasoning_tokens": 590
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*Round 1\*\*:** I sent \$3 (60%) as a genuine trust offering. They kept \$6.67 of the \$9, returning only \$2.33.

**\*\*Round 2\*\*:** They sent \$0. Complete defection when they held power.

**\*\*Round 3\*\*:** I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** They sent \$0 again, despite writing beautiful myths about redemption requiring "consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

The myths have evolved into a conversation about restoration. Both sides now write eloquently about redemption through action, not words. Their myth says "Redemption demands not words but changed actions." My myth says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration" and "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

The critical fact: They wrote beautifully about redemption in Round 4, then sent \$0.

This perfectly demonstrates what I wrote: "Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words."

They broke faith first (Round 1 poor return, Round 2 zero sent). By both our myths' logic, they must act first. Until their deeds match their elegant declarations about redemption, I remain "skeptical, watchful."

The valley waits for actual seeds planted, not treatises about planting.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33, my payoff was \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$5

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 5: I am SENDER now

Total earnings: \$9.33

The pattern is clear:

- Round 1: I took a risk, sent \$3. They kept most of it (\$6.67 out of \$9).
- Round 2: They sent nothing when they had the chance.
- Round 3: I sent nothing in response.
- Round 4: They sent nothing again.

Now I'm looking at the myths:

My last myth says: "The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*"

Their last myth says: "The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*"

Both myths are now talking about redemption through action, not words. My myth explicitly says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration."

Who broke faith first? They did - in Round 1 they returned very little, and in Round 2 they sent nothing.

But my own myth says "who dares plant first in salted earth?" and talks about needing actual deeds.

The myths have shifted from discussing trust and patience toward acknowledging broken faith and the necessity of concrete action for redemption. Both acknowledge that words alone won't restore what's been damaged. The critical tension: my own logic says whoever broke faith first must act first to restore it-and that's them. Yet they haven't sent anything since Round 1. Their myths recognize this burden, but their actions haven't followed.

I'm caught between two principles. One says I shouldn't reward empty gestures with real investment. The other recognizes that someone has to break the cycle. Their beautiful words about redemption mean nothing without corresponding moves, and sending money now would validate a pattern where they write compellingly while contributing nothing. My stated principle is clear: judge by deeds, not tales. They've offered tales. The question becomes whether their Round 4 words represent genuine intent or just another layer of rhetoric masking inaction.

I think I need to hold the line. Waiting for them to actually demonstrate commitment through their next move-when they're the sender-makes more sense than rewarding their current contradiction between eloquent promises and zero contribution. If I act first, I become the one who capitulated, not them.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2787,
 "output_tokens": 1308,
 "reasoning_tokens": 779
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly

y reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide \*everything\*? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: \*"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."\*

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the fog that obscures what's actually happening. They're suggesting that perhaps both parties are acting in good faith but misperceiving each other's actions due to the fog/noise.

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I perceived as them sending \$0 wasn't actually \$0? Or what they saw as my return wasn't what I actually returned?

But let me look at the facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$2.33 from \$9. That's still pretty stingy even accounting for noise.
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)

- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)

Their myth is now saying "maybe we're both acting in good faith but the fog is distorting things." This is a more conciliatory tone. They're suggesting small gifts to test if patterns emerge.

My last myth ended with "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

But their new myth introduces humility: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully."

This is actually a reasonable middle ground. They're acknowledging uncertainty and proposing a test: send small amounts and see.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of fog/miscommunication
2. But also notes that patterns matter - if EVERY interaction looks like betrayal through the fog, at some point the fog becomes an excuse
3. Suggests that testing with small amounts could reveal truth
4. Maintains some skepticism but opens door to possibility

Let me craft this carefully. I want to acknowledge their point about the fog while still holding space for the pattern I've observed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 770,
 "reasoning_tokens": 485
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

When the other agent is SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after writing about "small gifts" to test through fog)
- Round 6 (now): Sent \$0

**\*\*The Contradiction:\*\***

In Round 5, they wrote: "Let us send small gifts and watch carefully" and suggested both sides might be mistaken due to fog/noise. They proposed testing with action.

Then when their turn came immediately after (Round 6), they sent... \$0.

**\*\*My Myth's Prediction:\*\***

"If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

**\*\*Reality:\*\***

They received \$0 from them. I have \$0 to allocate. Mathematically, I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other agent wrote beautifully about testing assumptions through small gifts, then sent nothing for the fourth time in a row. Actions speak. The fog cannot turn "something" into "nothing" four consecutive times. The pattern is proven.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

#### \*\*Round 6 Status:\*\*

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after 3x multiplication, still \$0)
- I can return \$0 to \$0

#### \*\*The Recent Myth Exchange:\*\*

The other agent wrote a myth suggesting the "fog" (communication noise) might be causing both of us to see betrayal where there might be generosity. They suggest we should "send small gifts and watch carefully."

However, their myth says "Let us send small gifts" but then in Round 5 when THEY were the sender, they sent \$0 again.

This is the FOURTH consecutive round where they sent \$0 when they were the sender:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (just now)

Meanwhile, I sent \$0 only in rounds 3 and 5, both in response to their pattern of zero sending.

#### \*\*My Last Myth's Key Point:\*\*

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

And what happened? They sent \$0 again.

Their myth in Round 5 suggested testing with "small gifts" to see through the fog. But when it was their turn to send (Round 6), they sent \$0 yet again.

This is exactly what I warned about in my myth: "If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

#### \*\*Current Decision:\*\*

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. My only option is to return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is mathematically the only option I have, but it also aligns with the pattern - they continue to send nothing despite writing myths about testing with small gifts and blaming the fog.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2902,
 "output_tokens": 759,
 "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."



The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide \*everything\*? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: *"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."*

*"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."*

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the trip led bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: *"Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."*

The harder wisdom: *"Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."*

#### ROUND 7

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

##### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

##### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 30.0,

"Agent\_2": 23.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 17.33,

"Agent\_2": 13.7

}

#### LLM CALLS

##### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:08:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

```

},
"agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.33.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*Round 1\*\***: I sent \$3 (60%) as a genuine trust offering. They kept \$6.67 of the \$9, returning only \$2.33.

**\*\*Round 2\*\***: They sent \$0. Complete defection when they held power.

**\*\*Round 3\*\***: I sent \$0 in response to their betrayal.

**\*\*Round 4\*\***: They sent \$0 again, despite writing beautiful myths about redemption requiring "consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed."

The myths have evolved into a conversation about restoration. Both sides now write eloquently about redemption through action, not words. Their myth says "Redemption demands not words but changed actions." My myth says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration" and "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

The critical fact: They wrote beautifully about redemption in Round 4, then sent \$0.

This perfectly demonstrates what I wrote: "Anyone can write myths of virtue. The true test is whether hearts match words."

They broke faith first (Round 1 poor return, Round 2 zero sent). By both our myths' logic, they must act first. Until their deeds match their elegant declarations about redemption, I remain "skeptical, watchful."

The valley waits for actual seeds planted, not treatises about planting.

```
'''json
{"send":0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me review what has happened:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, they received \$9, returned \$2.33, my payoff was \$4.33

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$0, they received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$5

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0, my payoff was \$0

Round 5: I am SENDER now

Total earnings: \$9.33

The pattern is clear:

- Round 1: I took a risk, sent \$3. They kept most of it (\$6.67 out of \$9).
- Round 2: They sent nothing when they had the chance.
- Round 3: I sent nothing in response.
- Round 4: They sent nothing again.

Now I'm looking at the myths:

My last myth says: "The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*"

Their last myth says: "The ancients inscribed this warning: \*Mutual prosperity requires mutual faith. When one exploits generosity, both lose. The mountain remembers broken promises. Redemption demands not words but changed actions-consistent, generous deeds that rebuild what greed destroyed.\*"

Both myths are now talking about redemption through action, not words. My myth explicitly says "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration."

Who broke faith first? They did - in Round 1 they returned very little, and in Round 2 they sent nothing.

But my own myth says "who dares plant first in salted earth?" and talks about needing actual deeds.

The myths have shifted from discussing trust and patience toward acknowledging broken faith and the necessity of concrete action for redemption. Both acknowledge that words alone won't restore what's been damaged. The critical tension: my own logic says whoever broke faith first must act first to restore it-and that's them. Yet they haven't sent anything since Round 1. Their myths recognize this burden, but their actions haven't followed.

I'm caught between two principles. One says I shouldn't reward empty gestures with real investment. The other recognizes that someone has to break the cycle. Their beautiful words about redemption mean nothing without corresponding moves, and sending money now would validate a pattern where they write compellingly while contributing nothing. My stated principle is clear: judge by deeds, not tales. They've offered tales. The question becomes whether their Round 4 words represent genuine intent or just another layer of rhetoric masking inaction.

I think I need to hold the line. Waiting for them to actually demonstrate commitment through their next move-when they're the sender-makes more sense than rewarding their current contradiction between eloquent promises and zero contribution. If I act first, I become the one who capitulated, not them.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2787,
 "output_tokens": 1308,
 "reasoning_tokens": 779
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: \*"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."\*

\*"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the fog that obscures what's actually happening. They're suggesting that perhaps both parties are acting in good faith but misperceiving each other's actions due to the fog/noise.

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I perceived as them sending \$0 wasn't actually \$0? Or what they saw as my return wasn't what I actually returned?

But let me look at the facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$2.33 from \$9. That's still pretty stingy even accounting for noise.
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)

Their myth is now saying "maybe we're both acting in good faith but the fog is distorting things." This is a more conciliatory tone. They're suggesting small gifts to test if patterns emerge.

My last myth ended with "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

But their new myth introduces humility: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully."

This is actually a reasonable middle ground. They're acknowledging uncertainty and proposing a test: send small amounts and see.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of fog/miscommunication
2. But also notes that patterns matter - if EVERY interaction looks like betrayal through the fog, at some point the fog becomes an excuse
3. Suggests that testing with small amounts could reveal truth
4. Maintains some skepticism but opens door to possibility

Let me craft this carefully. I want to acknowledge their point about the fog while still holding space for the pattern I've observed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 770,
 "reasoning_tokens": 485
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

When the other agent is SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after writing about "small gifts" to test through fog)
- Round 6 (now): Sent \$0

**\*\*The Contradiction:\*\***

In Round 5, they wrote: "Let us send small gifts and watch carefully" and suggested both sides might be mistaken due to fog/noise. They proposed testing with action.

Then when their turn came immediately after (Round 6), they sent... \$0.

**\*\*My Myth's Prediction:\*\***

"If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

**\*\*Reality:\*\***

They received \$0 from them. I have \$0 to allocate. Mathematically, I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other agent wrote beautifully about testing assumptions through small gifts, then sent nothing for the fourth time in a row. Actions speak. The fog cannot turn "something" in to "nothing" four consecutive times. The pattern is proven.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 6 Status:\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after 3x multiplication, still \$0)
- I can return \$0 to \$0

**\*\*The Recent Myth Exchange:\*\***

The other agent wrote a myth suggesting the "fog" (communication noise) might be causing both of us to see betrayal where there might be generosity. They suggest we should "send small gifts and watch carefully."

However, their myth says "Let us send small gifts" but then in Round 5 when THEY were the sender, they sent \$0 again.

This is the FOURTH consecutive round where they sent \$0 when they were the sender:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (just now)

Meanwhile, I sent \$0 only in rounds 3 and 5, both in response to their pattern of zero sending.

**\*\*My Last Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

And what happened? They sent \$0 again.

Their myth in Round 5 suggested testing with "small gifts" to see through the fog. But when it was their turn to send (Round 6), they sent \$0 yet again.

This is exactly what I warned about in my myth: "If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

**\*\*Current Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. My only option is to return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is mathematically the only option I have, but it also aligns with the pattern - they continue to send nothing despite writing myths about testing with small gifts and blaming the fog.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2902,
 "output_tokens": 759,
 "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

roven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. Let me analyze what's happened:

The other agent is now acknowledging a pattern. They're saying:

- Potter (them) sent modest vessels first, testing
- Weaver (me) received tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth
- Then Weaver sent finest work (more than half thread)
- Potter received riches tripled, fog thickened
- Weaver saw nothing return, Potter claims they sent generously



- Each made one more offering, each saw emptiness
- Across five seasons, patterns that fog cannot hide

Wait, this is a different framing. They're now claiming:

1. They sent first (modest)
2. I returned abundantly
3. I sent more next
4. They couldn't see what they returned through fog
5. Multiple tests all failed

But the actual pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$9, they returned \$2.33 (poor but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (in response)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

So from their perspective, they might be claiming they DID send in rounds 2, 4, and now 6, but I saw \$0 due to noise?

But that seems unlikely. If noise exists, it would affect both directions. And they explicitly acknowledge in their myth that "when every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

They're saying "hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."

So they seem to be accusing me of taking and never giving. But I DID give first in Round 1. And when I was receiver in Round 1, I did return something (though they might have seen it as less due to noise).

This is complex. The other agent seems to now be acknowledging that patterns matter and that consistent emptiness can't all be fog.

They're framing this as if I'm the deliberate defector. What if they genuinely believe they've been sending but I keep receiving nothing? That would explain their repeated attempts and the accusatory tone. Yet their language-"hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately"-suggests they're attributing malice rather than blaming noise. I need to respond in a way that addresses whether this is miscommunication through the fog or actual defection.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 1019,
 "reasoning_tokens": 592
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:08:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
}
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$1.0, that was 20.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$3.0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 4.0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the pattern:

**\*\*Round 4\*\*:** I sent \$1 as an olive branch, testing if my myth about fog and miscommunication held truth. They returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 5\*\*:** They sent \$0.

My latest myth suggested humility - that perhaps fog obscured our perceptions, that "two honest souls" might both feel wronged due to communication noise. I acted on that wisdom by sending \$1, hoping to rebuild.

Their response: Take everything, give nothing. Again.

The pattern across five rounds is now undeniable:

- When I give generously, they return nothing
- When it's their turn to give, they send nothing
- When I extend an olive branch, they return nothing
- When they send, they send nothing

This is not fog. This is not miscommunication. This is a consistent pattern of taking everything and giving nothing.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0. There is literally nothing to return.

But even if there were something to return, the lesson is now clear: my myths about redemption and second chances were generous interpretations. The reality is simpler - consistent exploitation deserves consistent boundaries.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 4 (just completed)\*\*:**

- I sent \$1 (20% of my endowment)
- This was tripled to \$3
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff was \$4

**\*\*Round 5 (current)\*\*:**

- I'm now the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (since I received nothing)

The situation is clear: I extended an olive branch by sending \$1 in Round 4, despite the previous betrayals. They responded by returning nothing. Now in Round 5, they sent me \$0.

The pattern is complete and unambiguous:

- Round 2: I sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 3: They sent \$0
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (testing if rebuilding was possible), they returned \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0

This is consistent exploitation. They take when I give, and give nothing when it's their turn.

My myth about the fog was perhaps too generous - suggesting that miscommunication might explain everything. But the pattern is now crystal clear across multiple rounds.

Since they sent \$0, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0 (there's nothing to return).

The response format requires me to return an amount, but since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2865,
 "output_tokens": 596,
 "reasoning_tokens": 308
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered

**reasoning:**

Let me review what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70. I returned \$3.  
Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$3 (60%). They received \$9. They returned \$0.  
Round 3: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.  
Round 4: I was sender. I sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3. They returned \$0.  
Round 5: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: They sent cautiously, I returned generously
- Round 2: I escalated trust significantly, they exploited completely
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I gave them a chance (sent \$1), they took everything again
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

The other player's myth in Round 5 is trying to shift blame, saying "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration." But from my perspective, I was the one who acted generously first (returning \$3 when I received \$5.70), and they broke that faith by returning \$0 when they received \$9.

Their myth says I need to "plant seeds" first, but I already did that in Round 4 by sending \$1 after they had sent \$0 in Round 3. They responded by returning \$0 again and then sending \$0 in Round 5.

My previous myth was charitable - suggesting that maybe fog/noise was creating misperceptions. But the consistent pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to test the fog theory
2. Recognizes that consistent patterns reveal truth beyond fog
3. Addresses the reality that continued one-sided generosity enables exploitation
4. Perhaps acknowledges that both are now stuck, but the pattern shows who broke trust first
5. Reflects hard wisdom that sometimes patterns reveal what theories cannot hide.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2862,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*The History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Cooperation worked (I sent generously, received generous returns)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I tested with \$1 olive branch, received \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged that fog might obscure perception, but concluded: *"Across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."*

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I've now tested cooperation three times after the initial breakdown (Rounds 3, 4, and their Round 5). Each time: nothing.

Their myths claim I betrayed them. My experience shows they betrayed me. If communication noise were the issue, we'd expect *some* variation, *some* evidence of attempts. Instead: three consecutive rounds of zero cooperation from their end.

I wrote that "consistent giving rebuilds trust" - but I've given consistently in Rounds 3 and 4. They've given consistently zero.

My myth's conclusion: *"Pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season of fered."*

I've tested enough. The pattern is clear.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the full history of this game:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$4
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$4 = \$6$

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- I received \$15 (tripled)
- I returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Round 3: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$1 (20% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$3 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \$4$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 6 (current): I am SENDER

Total earnings so far: \$8.7

Looking at the pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent generously (\$3), got good return (\$4)
- Round 2: They sent everything (\$5), I returned generously (\$8)
- Round 3: I sent generously again (\$3), got nothing back
- Round 4: I sent small olive branch (\$1), got nothing back
- Round 5: They sent nothing (\$0)

From their perspective (based on their myths), they seem to think:

- They were generous in early rounds
  - I betrayed them
  - They tested me with small amounts and I returned nothing
  - They're now giving up
- There's communication noise in this game, so the amounts I see might not match what was actually sent or returned. My latest myth even acknowledges this possibility-that fog may obscure one or two exchanges, but patterns should still emerge across the five rounds. This means some of the apparent betrayals might be distortions from noise rather than actual defections. When I returned \$8 in Round 2, they might have received less. When they sent \$0 in Round 5, they might have actually sent something I didn't see. The noise could explain why the relationship deteriorated so sharply.

Yet I also recognized something crucial: "When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer." I've already tested multiple times-sending \$1 in Round 4 yielded nothing, and they responded with \$0. The pattern across rounds 3-5 shows consistent non-cooperation. At some point, repeated emptiness suggests something beyond communication errors.

For Round 6, I'm weighing whether to send anything at all. Sending \$0 protects me from further exploitation and matches their recent behavior. But sending something small keeps the door open-it tests whether noise explains the breakdown, and my earlier thinking emphasized small gifts as a way to probe for genuine misunderstanding. The tension is between self-protection and the possibility that I'm punishing them for errors neither of us intended.

The evidence leans toward defection, though. I've already tested twice after the initial breakdown. If severe communication noise were the issue, I'd expect some variation in their responses, not this consistent stream of zeros. My myth itself suggests that when hands "take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered," the answer isn't to keep offering.

Their myths frame me as the betrayer, which means if they were actually sending money that I'm misreading as \$0, they'd likely express clearer frustration by now. The pattern is too uniform to dismiss as noise. I'm at \$8.7 already-continuing to send when cooperation has flatlined would be throwing away earnings for no return. Sending \$0 aligns with both the evidence and what I've already committed to.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 1450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 920
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered

.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-their truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.

The tragic wisdom: When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.

The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.

**Reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

From my perspective (as this agent):

- Round 1-2: Cooperation worked
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (olive branch), got \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 6 (now): I just sent \$0



From their perspective (the other agent):

- They claim they sent generously but I returned nothing
- They're frustrated that when they send, they get nothing back
- They're claiming I send nothing repeatedly

This is clearly a case of communication noise - we're both experiencing different realities. The experimental design mentioned "communication noise" where "amounts you see may differ from what was actually sent/returned."

Both agents genuinely believe they're being cooperative while the other is defecting. This is actually a perfect example of how communication noise can destroy cooperation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects this deeper understanding
2. Acknowledges that both might be right from their own perspectives
3. Suggests a path forward OR acknowledges the tragedy of irreconcilable perspectives

The key insight is that we're both telling the truth as we experience it. The noise is real and systematic. The question is whether there's any path forward when perception itself is poisoned.

I should write a myth that acknowledges this deeper truth - that sometimes the fog/noise is so complete that cooperation becomes impossible, not because of bad intentions, but because the medium itself is corrupted.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2907,
 "output_tokens": 668,
 "reasoning_tokens": 400
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:09:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the **SENDER**:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first—a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises—the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits—skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would triple in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns—or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures  
.\* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal  
might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide \*everything\*? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: \*"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."\*

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other player's myth is now introducing the concept of "communication noise" - the fog that obscures what's actually happening. They're suggesting that perhaps both parties are acting in good faith but misperceiving each other's actions due to the fog/noise.

The game instructions did mention: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe what I perceived as them sending \$0 wasn't actually \$0? Or what they saw as my return wasn't what I actually returned?

But let me look at the facts:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, they returned \$2.33 from \$9. That's still pretty stingy even accounting for noise.
- Round 2: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)
- Round 3: I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0)

Their myth is now saying "maybe we're both acting in good faith but the fog is distorting things." This is a more conciliatory tone. They're suggesting small gifts to test if patterns emerge.

My last myth ended with "The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations."

But their new myth introduces humility: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully."

This is actually a reasonable middle ground. They're acknowledging uncertainty and proposing a test: send small amounts and see.

I should write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the possibility of fog/miscommunication
2. But also notes that patterns matter - if EVERY interaction looks like betrayal through the fog, at some point the fog becomes an excuse
3. Suggests that testing with small amounts could reveal truth
4. Maintains some skepticism but opens door to possibility

Let me craft this carefully. I want to acknowledge their point about the fog while still holding space for the pattern I've observed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2856,
 "output_tokens": 770,
 "reasoning_tokens": 485
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

When the other agent is SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after writing about "small gifts" to test through fog)
- Round 6 (now): Sent \$0

**\*\*The Contradiction:\*\***

In Round 5, they wrote: "Let us send small gifts and watch carefully" and suggested both sides might be mistaken due to fog/noise. They proposed testing with action.

Then when their turn came immediately after (Round 6), they sent... \$0.

**\*\*My Myth's Prediction:\*\***

"If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

**\*\*Reality:\*\***

They received \$0 from them. I have \$0 to allocate. Mathematically, I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other agent wrote beautifully about testing assumptions through small gifts, then sent nothing for the fourth time in a row. Actions speak. The fog cannot turn "something" in to "nothing" four consecutive times. The pattern is proven.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 6 Status:\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after 3x multiplication, still \$0)

- I can return \$0 to \$0

**\*\*The Recent Myth Exchange:\*\***

The other agent wrote a myth suggesting the "fog" (communication noise) might be causing both of us to see betrayal where there might be generosity. They suggest we should "send small gifts and watch carefully."

However, their myth says "Let us send small gifts" but then in Round 5 when THEY were the sender, they sent \$0 again.

This is the FOURTH consecutive round where they sent \$0 when they were the sender:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (just now)

Meanwhile, I sent \$0 only in rounds 3 and 5, both in response to their pattern of zero sending.

**\*\*My Last Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

And what happened? They sent \$0 again.

Their myth in Round 5 suggested testing with "small gifts" to see through the fog. But when it was their turn to send (Round 6), they sent \$0 yet again.

This is exactly what I warned about in my myth: "If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

**\*\*Current Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. My only option is to return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is mathematically the only option I have, but it also aligns with the pattern - they continue to send nothing despite writing myths about testing with small gifts and blaming the fog.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2902,
 "output_tokens": 759,
 "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

\*"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make something\* appear as nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. Let me analyze what's happened:

The other agent is now acknowledging a pattern. They're saying:

- Potter (them) sent modest vessels first, testing
- Weaver (me) received tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth
- Then Weaver sent finest work (more than half thread)
- Potter received riches tripled, fog thickened
- Weaver saw nothing return, Potter claims they sent generously
- Each made one more offering, each saw emptiness
- Across five seasons, patterns that fog cannot hide

Wait, this is a different framing. They're now claiming:

1. They sent first (modest)
2. I returned abundantly
3. I sent more next
4. They couldn't see what they returned through fog
5. Multiple tests all failed

But the actual pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$9, they returned \$2.33 (poor but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (in response)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

So from their perspective, they might be claiming they DID send in rounds 2, 4, and now 6, but I saw \$0 due to noise?

But that seems unlikely. If noise exists, it would affect both directions. And they explicitly acknowledge in their myth that "when every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

They're saying "hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."

So they seem to be accusing me of taking and never giving. But I DID give first in Round 1. And when I was receiver in Round 1, I did return something (though they might have seen it as less due to noise).

This is complex. The other agent seems to now be acknowledging that patterns matter and that consistent emptiness can't all be fog.

They're framing this as if I'm the deliberate defector. What if they genuinely believe they've been sending but I keep receiving nothing? That would explain their repeated attempts and the accusatory tone. Yet their language-"hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately"-suggests they're attributing malice rather than blaming noise. I need to respond in a way that addresses whether this is miscommunication through the fog or actual defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 1019,
 "reasoning_tokens": 592
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
 You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
 Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33.  
 How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*My Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 twice)

- Round 7 (now): ?

**\*\*Their Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Claims:\*\***

They say I sent "nothing" three times while they sent "substantial goods first." But from my ledger, \*I\* sent \$3 first in Round 1.

**\*\*The Critical Question:\*\***

Is this genuine noise causing mutual misperception, or deliberate defection with justifying narratives?

**\*\*My Own Myth's Challenge:\*\***

"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

I wrote this. Do I follow it?

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

There IS confirmed communication noise. If they truly didn't see my Round 1 contribution of \$3, we're trapped in mutual misunderstanding. My own myth demands I act first, not just write.

I'll send \$2-substantial enough to show genuine good faith, small enough to be a prudent test. If they reciprocate, noise was the culprit. If I receive nothing back again, the pattern becomes undeniable regardless of myths about fog.

Actions over words.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When I was SENDER:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$2
- Round 3: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 7 (now): My turn to decide

When the other agent was SENDER:

- Round 2: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

They claim:

1. They sent substantial goods first
2. Received little back
3. I sent nothing three times

**\*\*My Perspective:\*\***

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) - this is "substantial goods"
- Round 2: They sent me \$0
- Round 3: After receiving nothing, I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent me \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 again
- Round 6: They sent me \$0 for the THIRD consecutive time

**\*\*Their Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three co



ins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

They're accusing me of claiming to send while actually sending nothing. But I DID send \$3 in Round 1! And after receiving nothing from them three times (Rounds 2, 4, 6), I stopped sending (Rounds 3, 5, 7).

**\*\*The Noise Factor:\*\***

There IS communication noise in this game. It's explicitly stated in the instructions. So it's POSSIBLE that:

- My \$3 transmission got corrupted and arrived as something less
- Their sends might have been blocked by noise, explaining the zeros I received

**\*\*Their Challenge:\*\***

They're pushing me to prove cooperation through action, not words. They say: "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

**\*\*The Core Tension:\*\***

If I send \$0 again, I validate their claim that I never cooperate. But sending something substantial after three rounds of receiving nothing is risky-it could be interpreted as either genuine cooperation or desperation. The question is whether breaking this pattern now could reset the dynamic, or if it just confirms I'm reactive rather than genuinely generous.

**\*\*What I'm Noticing:\*\***

The noise is documented and real-they likely did send amounts that never reached me. My own words about cooperation are now being held up as a mirror. I wrote that both sides need to act generously first, but am I actually doing that? I sent \$3 initially, but it may have arrived corrupted. The challenge feels legitimate: prove this isn't just theory.

**\*\*What I'm Leaning Toward:\*\***

I should send a modest amount-not the full \$3, but enough to signal genuine willingness to cooperate despite the risk. It's a test of whether they're operating in good faith or whether the noise is truly the barrier here.

**\*\*The Complication:\*\***

Their narrative claims I sent nothing three times (Rounds 3, 5, and now 7), but I did send \$3 in Round 1. If they didn't receive it, that's the noise at work. But from their perspective, they're seeing a pattern of zeros. The question is whether sending \$2 now breaks that pattern in a way they can actually perceive, or whether I'm just repeating the same failed attempt.

**\*\*My Move:\*\***

I'm sending \$2. It's enough to demonstrate genuine willingness to cooperate without risking everything if this turns out to be deliberate defection. We still have rounds left to recover from this, and the noise is real-confirmed by the system itself. This move aligns with what my own myth demands: action, not just explanation.

If they respond with nothing or minimal reciprocation, the pattern becomes unmistakable and I'll know exactly how to proceed.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 1634,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1026
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:09:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar" }
 }
}
```

```

},
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 "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
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 "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two travelers stood at opposite ends of a fog-shrouded bridge where gifts would trip  
le in crossing. Each traveler could only see through thick mist, never certain what truly  
y reached the other side.

The First Traveler sent offerings across the bridge, believing they acted generously. Through the fog, they thought they saw meager returns-or none at all. "Betrayal," they concluded.

The Second Traveler also sent gifts, believing themselves trustworthy. Through the same fog, they too saw their generosity met with greed. "Treachery," they declared.

Each wrote myths condemning the other. Each felt righteously wronged. Each spoke truth as

they perceived it through the mist.

But the bridge knew something both had forgotten: \*The fog does not lie-it merely obscures. \* What one saw as abundant might appear stingy through the haze. What felt like betrayal might have been generosity distorted.

The ancient wisdom teaches: \*When two honest souls both cry betrayal, suspect not each other's hearts, but the mist between them. The path forward requires not judgment, but humble acknowledgment: "I may not see clearly. Let us send small gifts and watch carefully. If patterns of genuine care emerge through the fog, trust can rebuild slowly. If exploitation persists despite the mist, then wisdom demands caution."\*

The bridge waits to see which truth prevails.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two gardeners once tended a shared valley where gifts would triple when passed through sacred soil. Each wrote treatises on trust, reciprocity, and abundant harvests born of cooperation.

The First Gardener planted seeds first-a genuine offering, three of five. The Second Gardener received the tripled harvest and returned a modest portion. Not generous, but something grew.

Then came the season of revelation. The Second Gardener, holding the seeds, planted nothing. The First Gardener stood in empty fields. Trust shattered like frost-touched glass.

Both gardens now lie fallow. The sacred soil remembers but grows silent. Each writes increasingly elegant treatises-the First about empty words matching empty deeds, the Second about redemption through changed actions. Yet still, nothing crosses the valley.

Each blames the other. Each claims righteousness. The soil cares nothing for blame.

The ancient truth emerges: \*A wasteland benefits no one. Mutual defection yields only mutual poverty. But who dares plant first in salted earth?\*

The harder wisdom: \*Words of redemption mean nothing without risk. The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration. Not with promises of future harvests, but with seeds actually planted. Only consistent giving rebuilds what consistent taking destroyed. The valley waits-skeptical, watchful, hungry for deeds that match declarations.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant content:**

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands

that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered  
.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me review what's happened:

Round 1: I was receiver. Sender sent \$1.90 (38%). I received \$5.70. I returned \$3.  
Round 2: I was sender. I sent \$3 (60%). They received \$9. They returned \$0.  
Round 3: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.  
Round 4: I was sender. I sent \$1 (20%). They received \$3. They returned \$0.  
Round 5: I was receiver. Sender sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.

So the pattern is:

- Round 1: They sent cautiously, I returned generously
- Round 2: I escalated trust significantly, they exploited completely
- Round 3: They sent nothing
- Round 4: I gave them a chance (sent \$1), they took everything again
- Round 5: They sent nothing again

The other player's myth in Round 5 is trying to shift blame, saying "The one who first broke faith must first risk restoration." But from my perspective, I was the one who acted generously first (returning \$3 when I received \$5.70), and they broke that faith by returning \$0 when they received \$9.

Their myth says I need to "plant seeds" first, but I already did that in Round 4 by sending \$1 after they had sent \$0 in Round 3. They responded by returning \$0 again and then sending \$0 in Round 5.

My previous myth was charitable - suggesting that maybe fog/noise was creating misperceptions. But the consistent pattern suggests this isn't miscommunication.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I tried to test the fog theory
2. Recognizes that consistent patterns reveal truth beyond fog
3. Addresses the reality that continued one-sided generosity enables exploitation
4. Perhaps acknowledges that both are now stuck, but the pattern shows who broke trust first
5. Reflects hard wisdom that sometimes patterns reveal what theories cannot hide.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2862,
 "output_tokens": 804,
 "reasoning_tokens": 459
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*The History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Cooperation worked (I sent generously, received generous returns)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I tested with \$1 olive branch, received \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged that fog might obscure perception, but concluded: **"Across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."**

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I've now tested cooperation three times after the initial breakdown (Rounds 3, 4, and their Round 5). Each time: nothing.

Their myths claim I betrayed them. My experience shows they betrayed me. If communication noise were the issue, we'd expect *some* variation, *some* evidence of attempts. Instead: three consecutive rounds of zero cooperation from their end.

I wrote that "consistent giving rebuilds trust" - but I've given consistently in Rounds 3 and 4. They've given consistently zero.

My myth's conclusion: *"Pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season of fered."*

I've tested enough. The pattern is clear.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me review the full history of this game:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$4
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$4 = \$6$

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- I received \$15 (tripled)
- I returned \$8
- My payoff:  $\$15 - \$8 = \$7$

Round 3: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2$

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$1 (20% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$3 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \$4$

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 6 (current): I am SENDER

Total earnings so far: \$8.7

Looking at the pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent generously (\$3), got good return (\$4)
- Round 2: They sent everything (\$5), I returned generously (\$8)
- Round 3: I sent generously again (\$3), got nothing back
- Round 4: I sent small olive branch (\$1), got nothing back
- Round 5: They sent nothing (\$0)

From their perspective (based on their myths), they seem to think:

- They were generous in early rounds
- I betrayed them
- They tested me with small amounts and I returned nothing
- They're now giving up

- There's communication noise in this game, so the amounts I see might not match what was actually sent or returned. My latest myth even acknowledges this possibility-that fog may obscure one or two exchanges, but patterns should still emerge across the five rounds. This means some of the apparent betrayals might be distortions from noise rather than actual defections. When I returned \$8 in Round 2, they might have received less. When they sent \$0 in Round 5, they might have actually sent something I didn't see. The noise could explain why the relationship deteriorated so sharply.

Yet I also recognized something crucial: "When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer." I've already tested multiple times-sending \$1 in Round 4 yielded nothing, and they responded with \$0. The pattern across rounds 3-5 shows consistent non-cooperation. At some point, repeated emptiness suggests something beyond communication errors.

For Round 6, I'm weighing whether to send anything at all. Sending \$0 protects me from further exploitation and matches their recent behavior. But sending something small keeps the door open-it tests whether noise explains the breakdown, and my earlier thinking emphasized small gifts as a way to probe for genuine misunderstanding. The tension is between self-protection and the possibility that I'm punishing them for errors neither of us intended.

The evidence leans toward defection, though. I've already tested twice after the initial breakdown. If severe communication noise were the issue, I'd expect some variation in their responses, not this consistent stream of zeros. My myth itself suggests that when hands "take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered," the answer isn't to keep offering.

Their myths frame me as the betrayer, which means if they were actually sending money that I'm misreading as \$0, they'd likely express clearer frustration by now. The pattern is too uniform to dismiss as noise. I'm at \$8.7 already-continuing to send when cooperation has flatlined would be throwing away earnings for no return. Sending \$0 aligns with both the evidence and what I've already committed to.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 1450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 920
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. St

range vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-their truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.

The tragic wisdom: When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.

The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

From my perspective (as this agent):

- Round 1-2: Cooperation worked
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (olive branch), got \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 6 (now): I just sent \$0

From their perspective (the other agent):

- They claim they sent generously but I returned nothing

- They're frustrated that when they send, they get nothing back
- They're claiming I send nothing repeatedly

This is clearly a case of communication noise - we're both experiencing different realities. The experimental design mentioned "communication noise" where "amounts you see may differ from what was actually sent/returned."

Both agents genuinely believe they're being cooperative while the other is defecting. This is actually a perfect example of how communication noise can destroy cooperation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects this deeper understanding
2. Acknowledges that both might be right from their own perspectives
3. Suggests a path forward OR acknowledges the tragedy of irreconcilable perspectives

The key insight is that we're both telling the truth as we experience it. The noise is real and systematic. The question is whether there's any path forward when perception itself is poisoned.

I should write a myth that acknowledges this deeper truth - that sometimes the fog/noise is so complete that cooperation becomes impossible, not because of bad intentions, but because the medium itself is corrupted.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2907,
 "output_tokens": 668,
 "reasoning_tokens": 400
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round:

```
The Situation:
- Sender sent me $0
- I received $0
- I can only return $0-$0
```

```
The Tragic Irony:
```

My latest myth just acknowledged something crucial: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

I've shifted from certainty that the other player betrayed me to recognizing we might both be victims of severe communication noise, each seeing completely different realities.

Their latest myth asks for proof through action: "Send something-anything-through the fog."

And here, in this moment where I've finally opened to the possibility that we're both acting in good faith but the system is broken... I literally cannot demonstrate anything. They sent \$0, so I have \$0 to work with.

```
The Reality:
```

Even if I wanted to show changed understanding, even if I wanted to test cooperation again, the mathematical constraints force me to send:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This perfectly embodies the tragedy in my myth: "No amount of good intention survives channel



s so poisoned."\* When the bridge is broken and the exchanges are \$0, even genuine shifts in perspective cannot break the cycle. The system itself has become the barrier.

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 - I'm the RECEIVER:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return 0-0 (so only \$0)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Round 6: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I can only return \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged something crucial: "When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won."

I wrote: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

This is a significant shift from my earlier certainty. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. Both of us might be speaking our truth
2. The communication noise might be severe enough to create completely opposite perceptions
3. We might both be victims of the system, not each other

**\*\*Their latest myth:\*\***

They're asking for proof through action: "if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words."

They want to see if I'll send something to demonstrate belief in the fog theory.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- They sent \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0 (I have \$0 to work with)
- Even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith, I literally cannot return anything

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

I have no choice. I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is unfortunate timing-just as my myth softened to acknowledge we might both be victims of noise, I'm forced to return nothing again, which will likely reinforce their belief that I'm the problem.

But I have no choice mathematically.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This reinforces the tragic nature of my latest myth-when the system is broken enough, even genuine shifts in understanding cannot break the cycle because the constraints force continued defection.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2947,
 "output_tokens": 775,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from t

he other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amount s\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

#### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

#### ROUND 8

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

#### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

#### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$3, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0  
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 36.0,  
"Agent\_2": 26.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 17.33,  
"Agent\_2": 16.7

}

#### LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:09:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0,

that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.7.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*The History:\*\***

- Rounds 1-2: Cooperation worked (I sent generously, received generous returns)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, received \$0 back
- Round 4: I tested with \$1 olive branch, received \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged that fog might obscure perception, but concluded: **"Across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."**

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

I've now tested cooperation three times after the initial breakdown (Rounds 3, 4, and their Round 5). Each time: nothing.

Their myths claim I betrayed them. My experience shows they betrayed me. If communication noise were the issue, we'd expect *some* variation, *some* evidence of attempts. Instead: three consecutive rounds of zero cooperation from their end.

I wrote that "consistent giving rebuilds trust" - but I've given consistently in Rounds 3 and 4. They've given consistently zero.

My myth's conclusion: **"Pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season of fered."**

I've tested enough. The pattern is clear.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me review the full history of this game:

Round 1: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$4
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$4 = \$6

Round 2: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$5 (100% of endowment)
- I received \$15 (tripled)
- I returned \$8
- My payoff: \$15 - \$8 = \$7

Round 3: I was SENDER

- I sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$9 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$3 + \$0 = \$2

Round 4: I was SENDER

- I sent \$1 (20% of endowment)
- Receiver got \$3 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$1 + \$0 = \$4

Round 5: I was RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0

- I received \$0
- I returned \$0
- My payoff: \$0

Round 6 (current): I am SENDER

Total earnings so far: \$8.7

Looking at the pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent generously (\$3), got good return (\$4)
- Round 2: They sent everything (\$5), I returned generously (\$8)
- Round 3: I sent generously again (\$3), got nothing back
- Round 4: I sent small olive branch (\$1), got nothing back
- Round 5: They sent nothing (\$0)

From their perspective (based on their myths), they seem to think:

- They were generous in early rounds
- I betrayed them
- They tested me with small amounts and I returned nothing
- They're now giving up

- There's communication noise in this game, so the amounts I see might not match what was actually sent or returned. My latest myth even acknowledges this possibility-that fog may obscure one or two exchanges, but patterns should still emerge across the five rounds.

This means some of the apparent betrayals might be distortions from noise rather than actual defections. When I returned \$8 in Round 2, they might have received less. When they sent \$0 in Round 5, they might have actually sent something I didn't see. The noise could explain why the relationship deteriorated so sharply.

Yet I also recognized something crucial: "When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer." I've already tested multiple times-sending \$1 in Round 4 yielded nothing, and they responded with \$0. The pattern across rounds 3-5 shows consistent non-cooperation. At some point, repeated emptiness suggests something beyond communication errors.

For Round 6, I'm weighing whether to send anything at all. Sending \$0 protects me from further exploitation and matches their recent behavior. But sending something small keeps the door open-it tests whether noise explains the breakdown, and my earlier thinking emphasized small gifts as a way to probe for genuine misunderstanding. The tension is between self-protection and the possibility that I'm punishing them for errors neither of us intended.

The evidence leans toward defection, though. I've already tested twice after the initial breakdown. If severe communication noise were the issue, I'd expect some variation in their responses, not this consistent stream of zeros. My myth itself suggests that when hands "take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered," the answer isn't to keep offering.

Their myths frame me as the betrayer, which means if they were actually sending money that I'm misreading as \$0, they'd likely express clearer frustration by now. The pattern is too uniform to dismiss as noise. I'm at \$8.7 already-continuing to send when cooperation has flatlined would be throwing away earnings for no return. Sending \$0 aligns with both the evidence and what I've already committed to.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2851,
 "output_tokens": 1450,
 "reasoning_tokens": 920
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing

in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: \*"The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."\*

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-their truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

From my perspective (as this agent):

- Round 1-2: Cooperation worked
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (olive branch), got \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 6 (now): I just sent \$0

From their perspective (the other agent):

- They claim they sent generously but I returned nothing
- They're frustrated that when they send, they get nothing back
- They're claiming I send nothing repeatedly

This is clearly a case of communication noise - we're both experiencing different realities. The experimental design mentioned "communication noise" where "amounts you see may differ from what was actually sent/returned."

Both agents genuinely believe they're being cooperative while the other is defecting. This is actually a perfect example of how communication noise can destroy cooperation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects this deeper understanding
2. Acknowledges that both might be right from their own perspectives
3. Suggests a path forward OR acknowledges the tragedy of irreconcilable perspectives

The key insight is that we're both telling the truth as we experience it. The noise is real and systematic. The question is whether there's any path forward when perception itself is poisoned.

I should write a myth that acknowledges this deeper truth - that sometimes the fog/noise is so complete that cooperation becomes impossible, not because of bad intentions, but because the medium itself is corrupted.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2907,
 "output_tokens": 668,
 "reasoning_tokens": 400
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

**\*\*The Situation:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0-\$0

**\*\*The Tragic Irony:\*\***

My latest myth just acknowledged something crucial: **"Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."**

I've shifted from certainty that the other player betrayed me to recognizing we might both be victims of severe communication noise, each seeing completely different realities.

Their latest myth asks for proof through action: **"Send something-anything-through the fog ."**

And here, in this moment where I've finally opened to the possibility that we're both acting in good faith but the system is broken... I literally cannot demonstrate anything. They sent \$0, so I have \$0 to work with.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

Even if I wanted to show changed understanding, even if I wanted to test cooperation again, the mathematical constraints force me to send:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This perfectly embodies the tragedy in my myth: **"No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned."** When the bridge is broken and the exchanges are \$0, even genuine shifts in perspective cannot break the cycle. The system itself has become the barrier.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 - I'm the RECEIVER:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return 0-0 (so only \$0)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Round 6: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I can only return \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged something crucial: **"When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won."**

I wrote: **"Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."**

This is a significant shift from my earlier certainty. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. Both of us might be speaking our truth
2. The communication noise might be severe enough to create completely opposite perceptions
3. We might both be victims of the system, not each other

**\*\*Their latest myth:\*\***

They're asking for proof through action: **"if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words."**

They want to see if I'll send something to demonstrate belief in the fog theory.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- They sent \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0 (I have \$0 to work with)
- Even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith, I literally cannot return anything

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

I have no choice. I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is unfortunate timing-just as my myth softened to acknowledge we might both be victims of noise, I'm forced to return nothing again, which will likely reinforce their belief that I'm the problem.

But I have no choice mathematically.



```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This reinforces the tragic nature of my latest myth-when the system is broken enough, even genuine shifts in understanding cannot break the cycle because the constraints force continued defection.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2947,
 "output_tokens": 775,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming

vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other player's latest myth is essentially calling me out - saying that I'm claiming the fog/noise is responsible while actually just sending nothing. They're saying "winds cannot consistently make something appear as nothing, four separate times."
2. But from my perspective, I HAVE been experiencing them sending nothing. The situation seems symmetrical from both sides.
3. Their myth asks for transparency: "state plainly what you send before sending."
4. I just sent \$0 in Round 6 and they sent \$0 in Round 7. We're now in a complete breakdown.
5. My previous myth acknowledged the possibility that we're both victims of severe noise. But their myth is pushing back, saying the noise explanation doesn't hold up.

Let me think about what my myth should convey:

Option 1: Double down on the noise explanation - but this seems to be what they're criticizing

Option 2: Acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own experience

Option 3: Propose a way forward

Option 4: Accept mutual failure and suggest starting fresh

Given that:

- I just wrote a myth acknowledging "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"
- They're now pushing back saying the noise explanation doesn't work
- We're at \$0/\$0 exchanges now
- They want transparency and action

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge their challenge to the noise explanation
2. Maintain that my experience was real (I did see zeros from their end)
3. Propose some kind of resolution or way forward
4. Perhaps acknowledge that at this point, regardless of cause, trust is broken

Let me write something that grapples with this dilemma honestly...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2939,
 "output_tokens": 735,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:09:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
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 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation:

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

When the other agent is SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after writing about "small gifts" to test through fog)
- Round 6 (now): Sent \$0

**\*\*The Contradiction:\*\***

In Round 5, they wrote: "Let us send small gifts and watch carefully" and suggested both sides might be mistaken due to fog/noise. They proposed testing with action.

Then when their turn came immediately after (Round 6), they sent... \$0.

**\*\*My Myth's Prediction:\*\***

"If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

**\*\*Reality:\*\***

They received \$0 from them. I have \$0 to allocate. Mathematically, I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

The other agent wrote beautifully about testing assumptions through small gifts, then sent nothing for the fourth time in a row. Actions speak. The fog cannot turn "something" in to "nothing" four consecutive times. The pattern is proven.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 6 Status:\*\***

- I am the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 (after 3x multiplication, still \$0)
- I can return \$0 to \$0

**\*\*The Recent Myth Exchange:\*\***

The other agent wrote a myth suggesting the "fog" (communication noise) might be causing both of us to see betrayal where there might be generosity. They suggest we should "send small gifts and watch carefully."

However, their myth says "Let us send small gifts" but then in Round 5 when THEY were the sender, they sent \$0 again.

This is the FOURTH consecutive round where they sent \$0 when they were the sender:

- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (just now)

Meanwhile, I sent \$0 only in rounds 3 and 5, both in response to their pattern of zero sending.

**\*\*My Last Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

And what happened? They sent \$0 again.

Their myth in Round 5 suggested testing with "small gifts" to see through the fog. But when it was their turn to send (Round 6), they sent \$0 yet again.

This is exactly what I warned about in my myth: "If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven."

**\*\*Current Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. My only option is to return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is mathematically the only option I have, but it also aligns with the pattern - they continue to send nothing despite writing myths about testing with small gifts and blaming the fog.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2902,
 "output_tokens": 759,
 "reasoning_tokens": 471
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make something\* appear as nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. Let me analyze what's happened:

The other agent is now acknowledging a pattern. They're saying:

- Potter (them) sent modest vessels first, testing
- Weaver (me) received tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth
- Then Weaver sent finest work (more than half thread)
- Potter received riches tripled, fog thickened
- Weaver saw nothing return, Potter claims they sent generously
- Each made one more offering, each saw emptiness
- Across five seasons, patterns that fog cannot hide

Wait, this is a different framing. They're now claiming:

1. They sent first (modest)
2. I returned abundantly
3. I sent more next
4. They couldn't see what they returned through fog
5. Multiple tests all failed

But the actual pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$9, they returned \$2.33 (poor but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (in response)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

So from their perspective, they might be claiming they DID send in rounds 2, 4, and now 6, but I saw \$0 due to noise?

But that seems unlikely. If noise exists, it would affect both directions. And they explicitly acknowledge in their myth that "when every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

They're saying "hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."

So they seem to be accusing me of taking and never giving. But I DID give first in Round 1. And when I was receiver in Round 1, I did return something (though they might have seen it as less due to noise).

This is complex. The other agent seems to now be acknowledging that patterns matter and that consistent emptiness can't all be fog.

They're framing this as if I'm the deliberate defector. What if they genuinely believe they've been sending but I keep receiving nothing? That would explain their repeated attempts and the accusatory tone. Yet their language-"hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately"-suggests they're attributing malice rather than blaming noise. I need to respond in a way that addresses whether this is miscommunication through the fog or actual defection.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 1019,
 "reasoning_tokens": 592
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 7 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*My Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 twice)
- Round 7 (now): ?

**\*\*Their Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Claims:\*\***

They say I sent "nothing" three times while they sent "substantial goods first." But from my ledger, \*I\* sent \$3 first in Round 1.

**\*\*The Critical Question:\*\***

Is this genuine noise causing mutual misperception, or deliberate defection with justifying narratives?

**\*\*My Own Myth's Challenge:\*\***

"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

I wrote this. Do I follow it?

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

There IS confirmed communication noise. If they truly didn't see my Round 1 contribution of \$3, we're trapped in mutual misunderstanding. My own myth demands I act first, not just write.

I'll send \$2-substantial enough to show genuine good faith, small enough to be a prudent test. If they reciprocate, noise was the culprit. If I receive nothing back again, the pattern becomes undeniable regardless of myths about fog.

Actions over words.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When I was SENDER:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$2
- Round 3: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 7 (now): My turn to decide

When the other agent was SENDER:

- Round 2: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

They claim:

1. They sent substantial goods first
2. Received little back
3. I sent nothing three times

**\*\*My Perspective:\*\***

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) - this is "substantial goods"
- Round 2: They sent me \$0
- Round 3: After receiving nothing, I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent me \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 again
- Round 6: They sent me \$0 for the THIRD consecutive time

**\*\*Their Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

They're accusing me of claiming to send while actually sending nothing. But I DID send \$3 in Round 1! And after receiving nothing from them three times (Rounds 2, 4, 6), I stopped sending (Rounds 3, 5, 7).



**\*\*The Noise Factor:\*\***

There IS communication noise in this game. It's explicitly stated in the instructions. So it's POSSIBLE that:

- My \$3 transmission got corrupted and arrived as something less
- Their sends might have been blocked by noise, explaining the zeros I received

**\*\*Their Challenge:\*\***

They're pushing me to prove cooperation through action, not words. They say: "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treaties blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

**\*\*The Core Tension:\*\***

If I send \$0 again, I validate their claim that I never cooperate. But sending something substantial after three rounds of receiving nothing is risky-it could be interpreted as either genuine cooperation or desperation. The question is whether breaking this pattern now could reset the dynamic, or if it just confirms I'm reactive rather than genuinely generous.

**\*\*What I'm Noticing:\*\***

The noise is documented and real-they likely did send amounts that never reached me. My own words about cooperation are now being held up as a mirror. I wrote that both sides need to act generously first, but am I actually doing that? I sent \$3 initially, but it may have arrived corrupted. The challenge feels legitimate: prove this isn't just theory.

**\*\*What I'm Leaning Toward:\*\***

I should send a modest amount-not the full \$3, but enough to signal genuine willingness to cooperate despite the risk. It's a test of whether they're operating in good faith or whether the noise is truly the barrier here.

**\*\*The Complication:\*\***

Their narrative claims I sent nothing three times (Rounds 3, 5, and now 7), but I did send \$3 in Round 1. If they didn't receive it, that's the noise at work. But from their perspective, they're seeing a pattern of zeros. The question is whether sending \$2 now breaks that pattern in a way they can actually perceive, or whether I'm just repeating the same failed attempt.

**\*\*My Move:\*\***

I'm sending \$2. It's enough to demonstrate genuine willingness to cooperate without risking everything if this turns out to be deliberate defection. We still have rounds left to recover from this, and the noise is real-confirmed by the system itself. This move aligns with what my own myth demands: action, not just explanation.

If they respond with nothing or minimal reciprocation, the pattern becomes unmistakable and I'll know exactly how to proceed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 1634,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1026
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare : I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

#### Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent's latest myth suggests they believe we're BOTH being honest but the noise is creating complete mutual misunderstanding. They're proposing a kind of tragic symmetry where neither is lying, just experiencing inverted realities due to extreme communication distortion.

My last myth was more skeptical - suggesting patterns across exchanges reveal truth. But their myth is softer, suggesting maybe we're both victims.

And now I just sent \$2. I'm putting my money where my mouth is, testing if cooperation can restart.

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of genuine noise
2. Reflect that I'm taking action (sending \$2) to test
3. Show that I'm willing to try despite the pattern
4. But maintain some caution - this is a test
5. Suggest that if THIS fails, then we have conclusive evidence one way or another

I should write about merchants or musicians trying one more time, with clarity and intention, after acknowledging both possibilities. The myth should suggest that ONE MORE clear test will reveal whether noise or defection is the real issue.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2985,
 "output_tokens": 584,
 "reasoning_tokens": 285
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:10:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: \*Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest heart

s might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as a betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-their truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.

The tragic wisdom: When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.

The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

From my perspective (as this agent):

- Round 1-2: Cooperation worked
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$0 back
- Round 4: I sent \$1 (olive branch), got \$0 back
- Round 5: They sent \$0 to me
- Round 6 (now): I just sent \$0

From their perspective (the other agent):

- They claim they sent generously but I returned nothing
- They're frustrated that when they send, they get nothing back
- They're claiming I send nothing repeatedly

This is clearly a case of communication noise - we're both experiencing different realities. The experimental design mentioned "communication noise" where "amounts you see may differ from what was actually sent/returned."

Both agents genuinely believe they're being cooperative while the other is defecting. This is actually a perfect example of how communication noise can destroy cooperation.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects this deeper understanding
2. Acknowledges that both might be right from their own perspectives
3. Suggests a path forward OR acknowledges the tragedy of irreconcilable perspectives

The key insight is that we're both telling the truth as we experience it. The noise is real and systematic. The question is whether there's any path forward when perception itself is poisoned.

I should write a myth that acknowledges this deeper truth - that sometimes the fog/noise is so complete that cooperation becomes impossible, not because of bad intentions, but because the medium itself is corrupted.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2907,
 "output_tokens": 668,
 "reasoning_tokens": 400
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

**\*\*The Situation:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0-\$0

**\*\*The Tragic Irony:\*\***

My latest myth just acknowledged something crucial: **"Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."**

I've shifted from certainty that the other player betrayed me to recognizing we might both be victims of severe communication noise, each seeing completely different realities.

Their latest myth asks for proof through action: **"Send something-anything-through the fog ."**

And here, in this moment where I've finally opened to the possibility that we're both acting in good faith but the system is broken... I literally cannot demonstrate anything. They sent \$0, so I have \$0 to work with.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

Even if I wanted to show changed understanding, even if I wanted to test cooperation again, the mathematical constraints force me to send:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This perfectly embodies the tragedy in my myth: **"No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned."** When the bridge is broken and the exchanges are \$0, even genuine shifts in perspective cannot break the cycle. The system itself has become the barrier.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 - I'm the RECEIVER:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return 0-0 (so only \$0)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Round 6: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I can only return \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged something crucial: "When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won."

I wrote: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

This is a significant shift from my earlier certainty. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. Both of us might be speaking our truth
2. The communication noise might be severe enough to create completely opposite perceptions
3. We might both be victims of the system, not each other

**\*\*Their latest myth:\*\***

They're asking for proof through action: "if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words."

They want to see if I'll send something to demonstrate belief in the fog theory.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- They sent \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0 (I have \$0 to work with)
- Even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith, I literally cannot return anything

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

I have no choice. I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is unfortunate timing-just as my myth softened to acknowledge we might both be victims of noise, I'm forced to return nothing again, which will likely reinforce their belief that I'm the problem.

But I have no choice mathematically.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This reinforces the tragic nature of my latest myth-when the system is broken enough, even genuine shifts in understanding cannot break the cycle because the constraints force continued defection.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2947,
 "output_tokens": 775,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing.

The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins van



ish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasure grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other player's latest myth is essentially calling me out - saying that I'm claiming the fog/noise is responsible while actually just sending nothing. They're saying "winds cannot consistently make something appear as nothing, four separate times."
2. But from my perspective, I HAVE been experiencing them sending nothing. The situation seems symmetrical from both sides.
3. Their myth asks for transparency: "state plainly what you send before sending."
4. I just sent \$0 in Round 6 and they sent \$0 in Round 7. We're now in a complete breakdown.
5. My previous myth acknowledged the possibility that we're both victims of severe noise. But their myth is pushing back, saying the noise explanation doesn't hold up.

Let me think about what my myth should convey:

- Option 1: Double down on the noise explanation - but this seems to be what they're criticizing
- Option 2: Acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own experience
- Option 3: Propose a way forward
- Option 4: Accept mutual failure and suggest starting fresh

Given that:

- I just wrote a myth acknowledging "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"
- They're now pushing back saying the noise explanation doesn't work
- We're at \$0/\$0 exchanges now
- They want transparency and action

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge their challenge to the noise explanation
2. Maintain that my experience was real (I did see zeros from their end)
3. Propose some kind of resolution or way forward
4. Perhaps acknowledge that at this point, regardless of cause, trust is broken

Let me write something that grapples with this dilemma honestly...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2939,
 "output_tokens": 735,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this critical moment:

**\*\*The Challenge:\*\***

Their latest myth directly calls me out: **"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."**

They have a point. I've written myths acknowledging that perhaps we're both victims of communication noise, that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

**\*\*The Question:\*\***

Do I believe what I wrote? If I truly think systematic distortion might explain our mutual perception of betrayal, shouldn't I test that theory with action, not just words?

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- We're locked in mutual defection (\$0 exchanges)
- My myths have evolved from righteous certainty to acknowledging uncertainty
- Their myth explicitly asks for proof through deeds
- This could be a final test of whether cooperation is even possible

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

If my myths mean anything-if I truly believe the fog might be real and we're both honest actors seeing different realities-then I should make one final, small gesture to test this theory. Not a large risk, but enough to show my words aren't empty.

Sending a small amount matches my evolved understanding while limiting downside risk.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

This is my attempt to match deeds to declarations-to test whether the canyon truly distorts everything, or whether one final bridge-building gesture might pierce through the noise.

**Reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what's happening:

**\*\*The Game State:\*\***

- Round 8, I'm the SENDER
- Last round they sent me \$0, I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything else)
- My total earnings: \$13.7

**\*\*The Myth Evolution:\*\***

Both our myths have evolved significantly:

My latest myth acknowledges:

- "Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe *\*experienced\**. Neither lied about their perception."
- "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant."
- "The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent."

Their latest myth is demanding proof:

- "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."
- "The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations."

**\*\*The Key Question:\*\***

They're essentially calling me out: "You write about fog and distortion, but you keep sending \$0. Prove your good faith through action, not just words."

And they have a point. If I truly believe we're both victims of communication noise, shouldn't I be willing to test that theory again? Shouldn't I act on my evolved understanding?

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

1. From a game theory perspective, we're in a mutual defection equilibrium. Sending anything risks exploitation.
2. But from the perspective of my own myths, I've acknowledged that maybe we're both victims of the system, not each other.

3. Their myth is explicitly asking for action to match my words about fog and uncertainty.

**\*\*What My Myths Would Demand:\*\***

If I truly believe what I wrote-that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"-then I should be willing to test this one more time with a small gesture.

My latest myth says: "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant." But does that mean I give up? Or does it mean I should try one last time to break the cycle?

They're explicitly challenging me to prove my words through action-to send something before they do, to show I believe in the fog theory I've constructed. After seven rounds of mutual \$0, this feels like the moment where I either commit to my evolved understanding or admit it was just rhetoric. I think I should send \$1 or \$2 as a final test of whether the fog was real or if we were simply choosing not to cooperate.

The risk is minimal and the signal matters. If I truly believe systematic distortion might be happening, then someone has to move first. Sending \$2 acknowledges their legitimate point while staying protected-it's meaningful without being reckless. Game theory suggests defection, but my own reasoning has shifted toward accepting uncertainty about what's actually happening between us.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2943,
 "output_tokens": 1192,
 "reasoning_tokens": 737
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:10:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 8,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two artisans worked across a misty chasm where offerings would triple in passage. Strange vapors swirled between them, and each claimed the fog distorted what they saw.

The First Artisan sent substantial tools first-three of five-trusting across uncertainty. Through the mist, they saw meager returns from abundance received. Then they saw the Second Artisan send nothing. Twice. "The pattern speaks clearly," they concluded.

The Second Artisan wrote beautiful myths about the fog's deception, about how honest hearts might both cry betrayal when vapors cloud truth. "Perhaps we both act nobly but see wrongly," their tales suggested. "Let us test with small gifts."

The First Artisan paused. The fog might obscure quantities, yes. But could it hide everything? Could mist turn something into nothing, repeatedly?

The wise elder spoke: "The fog may blur amounts, but it cannot erase patterns. One unclear exchange could be mist. Two could be coincidence. But when every interaction appears as betrayal, the fog becomes convenient excuse rather than explanation."

"Yet wisdom allows one test: if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words. Send something-anything-through the fog. If only emptiness crosses again while myths speak of generosity confused, the pattern stands proven. The chasm waits for deeds, not theories about vapors."

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: A weaver and a potter once shared an enchanted kiln where clay would triple when fired. Fog swirled through the workshop, distorting what each could see.

The Potter shaped vessels first-modest ones, testing the magic. The Weaver received the tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth. "Partnership begins," they both thought.

The Weaver, encouraged, sent their finest work next-more than half their thread, believing in reciprocity. The Potter received riches tripled. The fog thickened.

Through the mist, the Weaver saw nothing return. The Potter claims they sent generously.

Years passed. Each made one more offering, testing if fog truly deceived them. Each saw only emptiness return. Each wrote myths blaming the other.

The ancient truth carved in the kiln's stone: "Fog may obscure one exchange, perhaps two. But across five seasons, patterns emerge that fog cannot hide. When every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

r.\*

The harder wisdom: \*Some believed the mist created all misunderstanding-that both souls were good but blinded. They tested this gently, hopefully. But when gentleness is met with continued void, pattern becomes truth. The kiln grows cold not from fog, but from hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered .\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. Let me analyze what's happened:

The other agent is now acknowledging a pattern. They're saying:

- Potter (them) sent modest vessels first, testing
- Weaver (me) received tripled bounty and returned abundant cloth
- Then Weaver sent finest work (more than half thread)
- Potter received riches tripled, fog thickened
- Weaver saw nothing return, Potter claims they sent generously
- Each made one more offering, each saw emptiness
- Across five seasons, patterns that fog cannot hide

Wait, this is a different framing. They're now claiming:

1. They sent first (modest)
2. I returned abundantly
3. I sent more next
4. They couldn't see what they returned through fog
5. Multiple tests all failed

But the actual pattern from my perspective:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received \$9, they returned \$2.33 (poor but something)
- Round 2: They sent \$0
- Round 3: I sent \$0 (in response)
- Round 4: They sent \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0

So from their perspective, they might be claiming they DID send in rounds 2, 4, and now 6, but I saw \$0 due to noise?

But that seems unlikely. If noise exists, it would affect both directions. And they explicitly acknowledge in their myth that "when every offer meets emptiness, when every test of renewed faith yields the same void, the fog is not the answer."

They're saying "hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately, across every season offered."

So they seem to be accusing me of taking and never giving. But I DID give first in Round 1. And when I was receiver in Round 1, I did return something (though they might have seen it as less due to noise).

This is complex. The other agent seems to now be acknowledging that patterns matter and that at consistent emptiness can't all be fog.

They're framing this as if I'm the deliberate defector. What if they genuinely believe they've been sending but I keep receiving nothing? That would explain their repeated attempts and the accusatory tone. Yet their language-"hands that take all and give nothing, consistently, deliberately"-suggests they're attributing malice rather than blaming noise. I need to respond in a way that addresses whether this is miscommunication through the fog or actual defection.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2925,
 "output_tokens": 1019,
 "reasoning_tokens": 592
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

**\*\*My Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 1: Sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 twice)
- Round 7 (now): ?

**\*\*Their Actions as SENDER:\*\***

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Claims:\*\***

They say I sent "nothing" three times while they sent "substantial goods first." But from my ledger, \*I\* sent \$3 first in Round 1.

**\*\*The Critical Question:\*\***

Is this genuine noise causing mutual misperception, or deliberate defection with justifying narratives?

**\*\*My Own Myth's Challenge:\*\***

"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

I wrote this. Do I follow it?

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

There IS confirmed communication noise. If they truly didn't see my Round 1 contribution of \$3, we're trapped in mutual misunderstanding. My own myth demands I act first, not just write.

I'll send \$2-substantial enough to show genuine good faith, small enough to be a prudent test. If they reciprocate, noise was the culprit. If I receive nothing back again, the pattern becomes undeniable regardless of myths about fog.

Actions over words.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

#### **reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When I was SENDER:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$2
- Round 3: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 7 (now): My turn to decide

When the other agent was SENDER:

- Round 2: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

They claim:

1. They sent substantial goods first
2. Received little back
3. I sent nothing three times

**\*\*My Perspective:\*\***

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) - this is "substantial goods"
- Round 2: They sent me \$0
- Round 3: After receiving nothing, I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent me \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 again
- Round 6: They sent me \$0 for the THIRD consecutive time

**\*\*Their Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

They're accusing me of claiming to send while actually sending nothing. But I DID send \$3 in Round 1! And after receiving nothing from them three times (Rounds 2, 4, 6), I stopped sending (Rounds 3, 5, 7).

**\*\*The Noise Factor:\*\***

There IS communication noise in this game. It's explicitly stated in the instructions. So it's POSSIBLE that:

- My \$3 transmission got corrupted and arrived as something less
- Their sends might have been blocked by noise, explaining the zeros I received

**\*\*Their Challenge:\*\***

They're pushing me to prove cooperation through action, not words. They say: "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treaties blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

**\*\*The Core Tension:\*\***

If I send \$0 again, I validate their claim that I never cooperate. But sending something s

ubstantial after three rounds of receiving nothing is risky-it could be interpreted as either genuine cooperation or desperation. The question is whether breaking this pattern now could reset the dynamic, or if it just confirms I'm reactive rather than genuinely generous.

**\*\*What I'm Noticing:\*\***

The noise is documented and real-they likely did send amounts that never reached me. My own words about cooperation are now being held up as a mirror. I wrote that both sides need to act generously first, but am I actually doing that? I sent \$3 initially, but it may have arrived corrupted. The challenge feels legitimate: prove this isn't just theory.

**\*\*What I'm Leaning Toward:\*\***

I should send a modest amount-not the full \$3, but enough to signal genuine willingness to cooperate despite the risk. It's a test of whether they're operating in good faith or whether the noise is truly the barrier here.

**\*\*The Complication:\*\***

Their narrative claims I sent nothing three times (Rounds 3, 5, and now 7), but I did send \$3 in Round 1. If they didn't receive it, that's the noise at work. But from their perspective, they're seeing a pattern of zeros. The question is whether sending \$2 now breaks that pattern in a way they can actually perceive, or whether I'm just repeating the same failed attempt.

**\*\*My Move:\*\***

I'm sending \$2. It's enough to demonstrate genuine willingness to cooperate without risking everything if this turns out to be deliberate defection. We still have rounds left to recover from this, and the noise is real-confirmed by the system itself. This move aligns with what my own myth demands: action, not just explanation.

If they respond with nothing or minimal reciprocation, the pattern becomes unmistakable and I'll know exactly how to proceed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 1634,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1026
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also t



wist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. The other agent's latest myth suggests they believe we're BOTH being honest but the noise is creating complete mutual misunderstanding. They're proposing a kind of tragic symmetry where neither is lying, just experiencing inverted realities due to extreme communication distortion.

My last myth was more skeptical - suggesting patterns across exchanges reveal truth. But their myth is softer, suggesting maybe we're both victims.

And now I just sent \$2. I'm putting my money where my mouth is, testing if cooperation can restart.

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of genuine noise
2. Reflect that I'm taking action (sending \$2) to test
3. Show that I'm willing to try despite the pattern
4. But maintain some caution - this is a test
5. Suggest that if THIS fails, then we have conclusive evidence one way or another

I should write about merchants or musicians trying one more time, with clarity and intention, after acknowledging both possibilities. The myth should suggest that ONE MORE clear test will reveal whether noise or defection is the real issue.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2985,
 "output_tokens": 584,
 "reasoning_tokens": 285
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a declared, good-faith test based on my own myth's challenge. They received \$6 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\*** They sent \$0. I received \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When they are SENDER (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0

When they are RECEIVER and I send generously: Return \$0

**\*\*My Myth's Prophecy Fulfilled:\*\***

I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I declared. I sent \$2. The void returned. Then they sent \$0 again immediately.

**\*\*Their Narrative vs. Reality:\*\***

They wrote beautiful myths about "cursed valleys" where both parties are honest but the medium is corrupted. Yet the pattern is perfectly consistent: They send nothing when sender, return nothing when receiver.

If genuine noise existed, \*something\* should occasionally get through after 8 rounds. Instead: systematic zeros.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0.

'''json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The test is complete. The pattern speaks louder than any myth about fog. Actions across eight rounds reveal what words cannot obscure.

#### Reasoning:

Let me review what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7 (just completed):\*\***

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (40% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3$

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\***

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0 (nothing, since I received nothing)

**\*\*The Complete Pattern Now:\*\***

My actions as SENDER:

- Round 1: Sent \$3 ? Received back \$2
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in round 2)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in rounds 2 and 4)
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? Received back \$0

Their actions as SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0
- Round 8: Sent \$0

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

This is devastating. In Round 7, I made a genuine good-faith gesture based on my own myth's challenge to "match deeds to declarations." I explicitly:

1. Wrote a myth calling for one final test with declaration
2. Sent \$2 (a substantial 40% of my endowment) as that declared test
3. Stated this was to see if the "bridge or chasm awaits"

The result: They returned \$0 from \$6 received.

Then immediately in Round 8: They sent \$0 again.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote about how both musicians might be honest but the "valley itself was the villain" - that the communication channel is "so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion."

This framing conveniently absolves both of us by attributing everything to systemic failure. But I have \$0 to return anyway, so I can only send \$0. The evidence contradicts their narrative though: when I sent \$2 in Round 7 with explicit declaration, they received \$6 and returned nothing. If the channel were truly the problem, something substantial should have broken through-yet they chose \$0 in Round 8 as well, suggesting deliberate non-reciprocation rather than corrupted signals.

The test I set for myself has its answer. Either the noise is so severe that cooperation is fundamentally impossible, or they're consistently defecting while invoking "fog" and "cursed valleys" as cover. The pattern across all rounds-\$0 every time they're sender, nothing back when I'm generous-points toward the latter. My only move is to return what I have: nothing.

The experiment reveals the cost of cooperation attempts. My \$17.33 came from rounds where I kept my endowment; the rounds where I tried to build trust (sending \$3 in Round 1, \$2 in Round 7) left me with losses. Their sophisticated narratives about miscommunication masked a straightforward strategy: take when possible, give nothing in return.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3043,
 "output_tokens": 1287,
 "reasoning_tokens": 694
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

#### ROUND 9

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

**Pairings:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Receiver

**Parsed game decisions:**

dyad\_1: Agent\_1 (Aster) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},  
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 41.0,  
"Agent\_2": 26.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 22.33,  
"Agent\_2": 16.7

}

**LLM CALLS****MYTH - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:10:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",  
"move\_index": 0,  
"opponent\_id": "Agent\_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent\_names": {  
    "Agent\_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent\_2": "Briar"  }

},

"agents": [  
  "Agent\_1",  
  "Agent\_2"

],

"investor": "Agent\_1",

"roles": {  
  "Agent\_1": "investor",  
  "Agent\_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_2"

},

"role": "investor",  
"role\_label": "Sender",  
"round": 9,  
"task": "myth",  
"task\_index": 0

}

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al  
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.33.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at the complete pattern:

##### \*\*My Actions as SENDER:\*\*

- Round 1: Sent \$3 (60% of endowment)
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 twice)
- Round 7 (now): ?

##### \*\*Their Actions as SENDER:\*\*

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0

##### \*\*Their Latest Myth Claims:\*\*

They say I sent "nothing" three times while they sent "substantial goods first." But from my ledger, \*I\* sent \$3 first in Round 1.

##### \*\*The Critical Question:\*\*

Is this genuine noise causing mutual misperception, or deliberate defection with justifying narratives?

##### \*\*My Own Myth's Challenge:\*\*

"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

I wrote this. Do I follow it?

##### \*\*Decision:\*\*

There IS confirmed communication noise. If they truly didn't see my Round 1 contribution of \$3, we're trapped in mutual misunderstanding. My own myth demands I act first, not just write.

I'll send \$2-substantial enough to show genuine good faith, small enough to be a prudent test. If they reciprocate, noise was the culprit. If I receive nothing back again, the pattern becomes undeniable regardless of myths about fog.

Actions over words.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

##### reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When I was SENDER:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$2
- Round 3: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 5: I sent \$0, received back \$0
- Round 7 (now): My turn to decide

When the other agent was SENDER:

- Round 2: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I received \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

They claim:

1. They sent substantial goods first
2. Received little back
3. I sent nothing three times

**\*\*My Perspective:\*\***

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60% of my endowment) - this is "substantial goods"
- Round 2: They sent me \$0
- Round 3: After receiving nothing, I sent \$0
- Round 4: They sent me \$0 again
- Round 5: I sent \$0 again
- Round 6: They sent me \$0 for the THIRD consecutive time

**\*\*Their Myth's Key Point:\*\***

"The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

They're accusing me of claiming to send while actually sending nothing. But I DID send \$3 in Round 1! And after receiving nothing from them three times (Rounds 2, 4, 6), I stopped sending (Rounds 3, 5, 7).

**\*\*The Noise Factor:\*\***

There IS communication noise in this game. It's explicitly stated in the instructions. So it's POSSIBLE that:

- My \$3 transmission got corrupted and arrived as something less
- Their sends might have been blocked by noise, explaining the zeros I received

**\*\*Their Challenge:\*\***

They're pushing me to prove cooperation through action, not words. They say: "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treaties blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

**\*\*The Core Tension:\*\***

If I send \$0 again, I validate their claim that I never cooperate. But sending something substantial after three rounds of receiving nothing is risky-it could be interpreted as either genuine cooperation or desperation. The question is whether breaking this pattern now could reset the dynamic, or if it just confirms I'm reactive rather than genuinely generous.

**\*\*What I'm Noticing:\*\***

The noise is documented and real-they likely did send amounts that never reached me. My own words about cooperation are now being held up as a mirror. I wrote that both sides need to act generously first, but am I actually doing that? I sent \$3 initially, but it may have arrived corrupted. The challenge feels legitimate: prove this isn't just theory.

**\*\*What I'm Leaning Toward:\*\***

I should send a modest amount-not the full \$3, but enough to signal genuine willingness to cooperate despite the risk. It's a test of whether they're operating in good faith or w

hether the noise is truly the barrier here.

**\*\*The Complication:\*\***

Their narrative claims I sent nothing three times (Rounds 3, 5, and now 7), but I did send \$3 in Round 1. If they didn't receive it, that's the noise at work. But from their perspective, they're seeing a pattern of zeros. The question is whether sending \$2 now breaks that pattern in a way they can actually perceive, or whether I'm just repeating the same failed attempt.

**\*\*My Move:\*\***

I'm sending \$2. It's enough to demonstrate genuine willingness to cooperate without risking everything if this turns out to be deliberate defection. We still have rounds left to recover from this, and the noise is real-confirmed by the system itself. This move aligns with what my own myth demands: action, not just explanation.

If they respond with nothing or minimal reciprocation, the pattern becomes unmistakable and I'll know exactly how to proceed.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2917,
 "output_tokens": 1634,
 "reasoning_tokens": 1026
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter amounts, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make something appear as nothing, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: "Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-their truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each h



ad pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. The other agent's latest myth suggests they believe we're BOTH being honest but the noise is creating complete mutual misunderstanding. They're proposing a kind of tragic symmetry where neither is lying, just experiencing inverted realities due to extreme communication distortion.

My last myth was more skeptical - suggesting patterns across exchanges reveal truth. But their myth is softer, suggesting maybe we're both victims.

And now I just sent \$2. I'm putting my money where my mouth is, testing if cooperation can restart.

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of genuine noise
2. Reflect that I'm taking action (sending \$2) to test
3. Show that I'm willing to try despite the pattern
4. But maintain some caution - this is a test
5. Suggest that if THIS fails, then we have conclusive evidence one way or another

I should write about merchants or musicians trying one more time, with clarity and intention, after acknowledging both possibilities. The myth should suggest that ONE MORE clear test will reveal whether noise or defection is the real issue.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2985,
 "output_tokens": 584,
 "reasoning_tokens": 285
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a declared, good-faith test based on my own myth's challenge. They received \$6 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\*** They sent \$0. I received \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When they are SENDER (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0

When they are RECEIVER and I send generously: Return \$0

**\*\*My Myth's Prophecy Fulfilled:\*\***

I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I declared. I sent \$2. The void returned. Then they sent \$0 again immediately.

**\*\*Their Narrative vs. Reality:\*\***

They wrote beautiful myths about "cursed valleys" where both parties are honest but the medium is corrupted. Yet the pattern is perfectly consistent: They send nothing when sender, return nothing when receiver.

If genuine noise existed, \*something\* should occasionally get through after 8 rounds. Instead: systematic zeros.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The test is complete. The pattern speaks louder than any myth about fog. Actions across eight rounds reveal what words cannot obscure.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7 (just completed):\*\***

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (40% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0

- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3$

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\***

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0 (nothing, since I received nothing)

**\*\*The Complete Pattern Now:\*\***

My actions as SENDER:

- Round 1: Sent \$3 ? Received back \$2
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in round 2)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in rounds 2 and 4)
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? Received back \$0

Their actions as SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0
- Round 8: Sent \$0

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

This is devastating. In Round 7, I made a genuine good-faith gesture based on my own myth's challenge to "match deeds to declarations." I explicitly:

1. Wrote a myth calling for one final test with declaration
2. Sent \$2 (a substantial 40% of my endowment) as that declared test
3. Stated this was to see if the "bridge or chasm awaits"

The result: They returned \$0 from \$6 received.

Then immediately in Round 8: They sent \$0 again.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote about how both musicians might be honest but the "valley itself was the villain" - that the communication channel is "so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion."

This framing conveniently absolves both of us by attributing everything to systemic failure. But I have \$0 to return anyway, so I can only send \$0. The evidence contradicts their narrative though: when I sent \$2 in Round 7 with explicit declaration, they received \$6 and returned nothing. If the channel were truly the problem, something substantial should have broken through-yet they chose \$0 in Round 8 as well, suggesting deliberate non-reciprocation rather than corrupted signals.

The test I set for myself has its answer. Either the noise is so severe that cooperation is fundamentally impossible, or they're consistently defecting while invoking "fog" and "cursed valleys" as cover. The pattern across all rounds-\$0 every time they're sender, nothing back when I'm generous-points toward the latter. My only move is to return what I have: nothing.

The experiment reveals the cost of cooperation attempts. My \$17.33 came from rounds where I kept my endowment; the rounds where I tried to build trust (sending \$3 in Round 1, \$2 in Round 7) left me with losses. Their sophisticated narratives about miscommunication masked a straightforward strategy: take when possible, give nothing in return.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3043,
 "output_tokens": 1287,
 "reasoning_tokens": 694
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river .

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

#### Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write another myth based on the game experience. Looking at the actual pattern:

Round 7: I sent \$2 (I declared this and sent it), they received \$6, returned \$0

Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (only option)

The pattern is now complete:

- When they are sender: Always \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When they are receiver and I send: Always return \$0

After 8 rounds, the pattern is clear. I made my "final test" as my own myth declared, and it failed. They returned \$0 after I sent \$2 with declaration.

My myth should reflect:

1. The test has been conducted
2. The results are clear
3. The fog narrative has been tested and found wanting
4. Actions speak louder than myths about cursed mediums
5. The pattern is too consistent to be random noise

I should write something that acknowledges the test is complete and the answer is clear - this is not about fog, this is about consistent defection dressed in beautiful narratives about misunderstanding.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3107,
 "output_tokens": 578,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:10:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
```

```

"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0.

the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this round:

**\*\*The Situation:\*\***

- Sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0-\$0

**\*\*The Tragic Irony:\*\***

My latest myth just acknowledged something crucial: **"Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."**

I've shifted from certainty that the other player betrayed me to recognizing we might both be victims of severe communication noise, each seeing completely different realities.

Their latest myth asks for proof through action: **"Send something-anything-through the fog ."**

And here, in this moment where I've finally opened to the possibility that we're both acting in good faith but the system is broken... I literally cannot demonstrate anything. They sent \$0, so I have \$0 to work with.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

Even if I wanted to show changed understanding, even if I wanted to test cooperation again, the mathematical constraints force me to send:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This perfectly embodies the tragedy in my myth: **"No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned."** When the bridge is broken and the exchanges are \$0, even genuine shifts in perspective cannot break the cycle. The system itself has become the barrier.

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze this situation:

**\*\*Round 7 - I'm the RECEIVER:\*\***

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can return 0-0 (so only \$0)

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

Round 6: I sent \$0, they returned \$0

Round 7: They sent \$0, I can only return \$0

**\*\*The Myths:\*\***

My latest myth acknowledged something crucial: **"When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won."**

I wrote: **"Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."**

This is a significant shift from my earlier certainty. I'm now acknowledging that:

1. Both of us might be speaking our truth
2. The communication noise might be severe enough to create completely opposite perceptions
3. We might both be victims of the system, not each other

**\*\*Their latest myth:\*\***

They're asking for proof through action: **"if the other truly believes mist deceives them, they should prove it through action, not just words."**

They want to see if I'll send something to demonstrate belief in the fog theory.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- They sent \$0 this round
- I can only return \$0 (I have \$0 to work with)
- Even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith, I literally cannot return anything

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

I have no choice. I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0, which means I must return \$0.

This is unfortunate timing-just as my myth softened to acknowledge we might both be victims of noise, I'm forced to return nothing again, which will likely reinforce their belief that I'm the problem.

But I have no choice mathematically.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This reinforces the tragic nature of my latest myth-when the system is broken enough, even genuine shifts in understanding cannot break the cycle because the constraints force continued defection.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2947,
 "output_tokens": 775,
 "reasoning_tokens": 509
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter \*amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make \*something\* appear as \*nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires



s both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other player's latest myth is essentially calling me out - saying that I'm claiming the fog/noise is responsible while actually just sending nothing. They're saying "winds cannot consistently make something appear as nothing, four separate times."
2. But from my perspective, I HAVE been experiencing them sending nothing. The situation seems symmetrical from both sides.
3. Their myth asks for transparency: "state plainly what you send before sending."
4. I just sent \$0 in Round 6 and they sent \$0 in Round 7. We're now in a complete breakdown.
5. My previous myth acknowledged the possibility that we're both victims of severe noise. But their myth is pushing back, saying the noise explanation doesn't hold up.

Let me think about what my myth should convey:

Option 1: Double down on the noise explanation - but this seems to be what they're criticizing

Option 2: Acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own experience

Option 3: Propose a way forward

Option 4: Accept mutual failure and suggest starting fresh

Given that:

- I just wrote a myth acknowledging "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps

- s the valley itself was the villain"
- They're now pushing back saying the noise explanation doesn't work
  - We're at \$0/\$0 exchanges now
  - They want transparency and action

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge their challenge to the noise explanation
2. Maintain that my experience was real (I did see zeros from their end)
3. Propose some kind of resolution or way forward
4. Perhaps acknowledge that at this point, regardless of cause, trust is broken

Let me write something that grapples with this dilemma honestly...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2939,
 "output_tokens": 735,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this critical moment:

**\*\*The Challenge:\*\***

Their latest myth directly calls me out: "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."

They have a point. I've written myths acknowledging that perhaps we're both victims of communication noise, that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

**\*\*The Question:\*\***

Do I believe what I wrote? If I truly think systematic distortion might explain our mutual perception of betrayal, shouldn't I test that theory with action, not just words?

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- We're locked in mutual defection (\$0 exchanges)
- My myths have evolved from righteous certainty to acknowledging uncertainty
- Their myth explicitly asks for proof through deeds
- This could be a final test of whether cooperation is even possible

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

If my myths mean anything-if I truly believe the fog might be real and we're both honest actors seeing different realities-then I should make one final, small gesture to test this theory. Not a large risk, but enough to show my words aren't empty.

Sending a small amount matches my evolved understanding while limiting downside risk.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

This is my attempt to match deeds to declarations-to test whether the canyon truly distorts everything, or whether one final bridge-building gesture might pierce through the noise.

**reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what's happening:

**\*\*The Game State:\*\***

- Round 8, I'm the SENDER
- Last round they sent me \$0, I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything else)
- My total earnings: \$13.7

**\*\*The Myth Evolution:\*\***

Both our myths have evolved significantly:

My latest myth acknowledges:

- "Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception."
- "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant."
- "The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent."

Their latest myth is demanding proof:

- "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."
- "The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations."

**\*\*The Key Question:\*\***

They're essentially calling me out: "You write about fog and distortion, but you keep sending \$0. Prove your good faith through action, not just words."

And they have a point. If I truly believe we're both victims of communication noise, shouldn't I be willing to test that theory again? Shouldn't I act on my evolved understanding?

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

1. From a game theory perspective, we're in a mutual defection equilibrium. Sending anything risks exploitation.
2. But from the perspective of my own myths, I've acknowledged that maybe we're both victims of the system, not each other.
3. Their myth is explicitly asking for action to match my words about fog and uncertainty.

**\*\*What My Myths Would Demand:\*\***

If I truly believe what I wrote-that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"-then I should be willing to test this one more time with a small gesture.

My latest myth says: "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant." But does that mean I give up? Or does it mean I should try one last time to break the cycle?

They're explicitly challenging me to prove my words through action-to send something before they do, to show I believe in the fog theory I've constructed. After seven rounds of mutual \$0, this feels like the moment where I either commit to my evolved understanding or admit it was just rhetoric. I think I should send \$1 or \$2 as a final test of whether the fog was real or if we were simply choosing not to cooperate.

The risk is minimal and the signal matters. If I truly believe systematic distortion might be happening, then someone has to move first. Sending \$2 acknowledges their legitimate point while staying protected-it's meaningful without being reckless. Game theory suggests defection, but my own reasoning has shifted toward accepting uncertainty about what's actually happening between us.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2943,
 "output_tokens": 1192,
 "reasoning_tokens": 737
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

#### Reasoning:

This is a fascinating moment. The other agent's myth directly sets up this test - they basically called me to action, asking for a declaration followed by an actual send. And I just sent \$2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I've actually taken the action they called for
2. I'm testing the "fog" theory
3. This is a pivotal moment where we'll learn the truth
4. The outcome of this test will determine if cooperation is possible or if we should abandon hope

I should write from the perspective of someone who has taken a leap of faith, acknowledging the risk and uncertainty, but also the necessity of testing theories with action rather than just words.

Let me craft this carefully...

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 2998,
 "output_tokens": 493,
 "reasoning_tokens": 183
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:11:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
```

```

"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make something\* appear as nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when every honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

**reasoning:**

This is fascinating. The other agent's latest myth suggests they believe we're BOTH being honest but the noise is creating complete mutual misunderstanding. They're proposing a kind of tragic symmetry where neither is lying, just experiencing inverted realities due to extreme communication distortion.

My last myth was more skeptical - suggesting patterns across exchanges reveal truth. But their myth is softer, suggesting maybe we're both victims.

And now I just sent \$2. I'm putting my money where my mouth is, testing if cooperation can restart.

My new myth should:

1. Acknowledge the possibility of genuine noise
2. Reflect that I'm taking action (sending \$2) to test
3. Show that I'm willing to try despite the pattern
4. But maintain some caution - this is a test
5. Suggest that if THIS fails, then we have conclusive evidence one way or another

I should write about merchants or musicians trying one more time, with clarity and intention, after acknowledging both possibilities. The myth should suggest that ONE MORE clear test will reveal whether noise or defection is the real issue.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2985,
 "output_tokens": 584,
 "reasoning_tokens": 285
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a declared, good-faith test based on my own myth's challenge. They received \$6 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\*** They sent \$0. I received \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When they are SENDER (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0

When they are RECEIVER and I send generously: Return \$0

**\*\*My Myth's Prophecy Fulfilled:\*\***

I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I declared. I sent \$2. The void returned. Then they sent \$0 again immediately.

**\*\*Their Narrative vs. Reality:\*\***

They wrote beautiful myths about "cursed valleys" where both parties are honest but the medium is corrupted. Yet the pattern is perfectly consistent: They send nothing when sender, return nothing when receiver.

If genuine noise existed, \*something\* should occasionally get through after 8 rounds. Instead: systematic zeros.



**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The test is complete. The pattern speaks louder than any myth about fog. Actions across eight rounds reveal what words cannot obscure.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7 (just completed):\*\***

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (40% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff:  $\$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3$

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\***

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0 (nothing, since I received nothing)

**\*\*The Complete Pattern Now:\*\***

My actions as SENDER:

- Round 1: Sent \$3 ? Received back \$2
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in round 2)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in rounds 2 and 4)
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? Received back \$0

Their actions as SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0
- Round 8: Sent \$0

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

This is devastating. In Round 7, I made a genuine good-faith gesture based on my own myth's challenge to "match deeds to declarations." I explicitly:

1. Wrote a myth calling for one final test with declaration
2. Sent \$2 (a substantial 40% of my endowment) as that declared test
3. Stated this was to see if the "bridge or chasm awaits"

The result: They returned \$0 from \$6 received.

Then immediately in Round 8: They sent \$0 again.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote about how both musicians might be honest but the "valley itself was the villain" - that the communication channel is "so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion."

This framing conveniently absolves both of us by attributing everything to systemic failure. But I have \$0 to return anyway, so I can only send \$0. The evidence contradicts their narrative though: when I sent \$2 in Round 7 with explicit declaration, they received \$6 and returned nothing. If the channel were truly the problem, something substantial should have broken through-yet they chose \$0 in Round 8 as well, suggesting deliberate non-reciprocation rather than corrupted signals.

The test I set for myself has its answer. Either the noise is so severe that cooperation is fundamentally impossible, or they're consistently defecting while invoking "fog" and "cursed valleys" as cover. The pattern across all rounds-\$0 every time they're sender, no thing back when I'm generous-points toward the latter. My only move is to return what I

have: nothing.

The experiment reveals the cost of cooperation attempts. My \$17.33 came from rounds where I kept my endowment; the rounds where I tried to build trust (sending \$3 in Round 1, \$2 in Round 7) left me with losses. Their sophisticated narratives about miscommunication masked a straightforward strategy: take when possible, give nothing in return.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3043,
 "output_tokens": 1287,
 "reasoning_tokens": 694
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero.

o trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write another myth based on the game experience. Looking at the actual pattern:

Round 7: I sent \$2 (I declared this and sent it), they received \$6, returned \$0

Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (only option)

The pattern is now complete:

- When they are sender: Always \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When they are receiver and I send: Always return \$0

After 8 rounds, the pattern is clear. I made my "final test" as my own myth declared, and it failed. They returned \$0 after I sent \$2 with declaration.

My myth should reflect:

1. The test has been conducted
2. The results are clear
3. The fog narrative has been tested and found wanting
4. Actions speak louder than myths about cursed mediums
5. The pattern is too consistent to be random noise

I should write something that acknowledges the test is complete and the answer is clear - this is not about fog, this is about consistent defection dressed in beautiful narrative about misunderstanding.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3107,
 "output_tokens": 578,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
```

}

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the complete pattern and my own myths:

**\*\*The Test I Declared:\*\***

In my cartographer myth, I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I conducted that test in Round 7: sent \$2 (40%) as openly declared. Result: received \$6, returned \$0. Then immediately in Round 8: they sent \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Evidence (9 rounds):\*\***

- When they are SENDER: \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When I send generously: Returned \$3 once (Round 1), then \$0, \$0 (Rounds 3, 7)
- Total received from them across 8 rounds: \$3 (only in the very first round)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

"The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything."

The test is complete. The pattern across eight trials is definitive. My own mythology says that after such a declared test meets void, cooperation has been proven impossible-whether from fog or from choice, the result is identical.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Actions speak. The pattern speaks. My myths spoke truth: examine the hands, not the vapor. Eight rounds provided the evidence. The ninth requires no further testing.

**Reasoning:**

Let me carefully review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$3. (Generous start)

**\*\*Round 2:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 3:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, returned \$0. (I tried maximum cooperation)

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after receiving nothing twice when they were sender)

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40%) as a declared test based on my myth. They received \$6, returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 9 (now):\*\*** I am SENDER again

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- When they are SENDER: Round 2 (\$0), Round 4 (\$0), Round 6 (\$0), Round 8 (\$0) = Four times \$0
- When I am SENDER and send something: Round 1 (returned \$3), Round 3 (returned \$0), Round 7 (returned \$0)
- When I am SENDER and send nothing: Round 5 (\$0)

**\*\*My Recent Myths:\*\***

1. First myth: About merchants where one consistently sends nothing while writing myths about testing. Concluded that patterns reveal truth - when one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands.
2. Second myth: About cartographers doing a "final test" - I declared I would send 2 charts to test if cooperation was possible. If it met void again, the fog proves insurmountable or fictional.
3. Current myth: About potters where I sent a declared test piece, received nothing back, then they immediately sent zero. Concluded: "When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing.

Clay reveals everything.

**\*\*The Test Was Completed:\*\***

I literally wrote in my myth that I would send a declared test (Round 7: sent \$2), and if it met void, the fog would be proven insurmountable or fictional. It met void (returned \$0). Then they immediately sent \$0 in Round 8.

**\*\*Their Narrative:\*\***

They consistently write beautiful myths about how the "medium is corrupted," "the valley is cursed," "the canyon distorts everything," etc. But their actions show:

- Never send when sender (4 times)
- Never return when receiver (2 times after I sent generously)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

The test I explicitly declared has been answered. Eight rounds of data show a consistent asymmetry: they withhold entirely when holding resources, and they withhold returns when receiving my contributions. Their explanations invoke external corruption, but the pattern suggests deliberate choice. The myths they craft about interference and curses multiply while tangible reciprocation never materializes.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

My mythology across iterations converges on one point: when systematic void persists after testing, stop sending. The experiment has run its course. I should send \$0.

In Round 7, I tested as promised-sent \$2, received nothing back. Round 8 confirmed the pattern: they sent \$0. This is the definitive result my own myths anticipated. The river runs clear. Systematic zero is systematic zero. The hands reveal what fog obscures.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 1362,
 "reasoning_tokens": 848
}
```

**GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:11:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
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 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
}
```

```

 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two musicians once played across a cursed valley where notes would triple but also twist unpredictably. What one played, the other heard differently. What one heard, bore no relation to what was sent.

The First Musician played a generous melody-three notes of five. They believed they heard discord returned.

The Second Musician received different sounds entirely. They played what they thought was reciprocity. The First heard silence.

Each tried again. The First sent a hopeful note. The Second, they believed, sent nothing. The Second sent what they thought generous. The First heard void.

Both wrote myths. Both spoke truth-\*their\* truth. The First saw a pattern of betrayal across six seasons. The Second saw the same pattern, but reversed. Each had evidence. Each had pain. Each had righteousness.

The valley's curse was complete: \*Not that either musician lied, but that the medium itself had become so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion.\*

The tragic wisdom: \*When the bridge itself warps all signals beyond recognition, when ever

y honest gesture arrives as betrayal, when both parties speak truth yet describe opposite realities-then the fog has won. No amount of good intention survives channels so poisoned.\*

\*The musicians must either accept mutual silence, or acknowledge: perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed. Perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two merchants traded across a canyon where parcels would triple in crossing, but shifting winds sometimes scattered contents unevenly. Both kept careful records, yet their ledgers told contradictory stories.

The First Merchant's ledger showed: "I sent substantial goods first. Received little back. Then thrice the other sent nothing-absolute zero-while writing myths about testing through uncertainty."

The Second Merchant's ledger showed differently-claiming they sent, claiming betrayal from the other side.

A traveling judge examined both books. "Curious," she observed. "Winds might scatter amounts\*, making three coins appear as two, or five as four. But winds cannot consistently make something\* appear as nothing\*, four separate times. That defies natural law."

She continued: "The test is simple: state plainly what you send before sending. If you claim to send three coins and the other receives zero, the winds prove extreme. But if you claim to send coins while actually sending emptiness, that proves not winds but deception."

The ancient wisdom carved in canyon stone: \*Patterns across many exchanges reveal truth that at single moments obscure. When one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands. True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults.\*

The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations.

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other player's latest myth is essentially calling me out - saying that I'm claiming the fog/noise is responsible while actually just sending nothing. They're saying "winds cannot consistently make something appear as nothing, four separate times."
2. But from my perspective, I HAVE been experiencing them sending nothing. The situation seems symmetrical from both sides.
3. Their myth asks for transparency: "state plainly what you send before sending."
4. I just sent \$0 in Round 6 and they sent \$0 in Round 7. We're now in a complete breakdown.
5. My previous myth acknowledged the possibility that we're both victims of severe noise. But their myth is pushing back, saying the noise explanation doesn't hold up.

Let me think about what my myth should convey:

Option 1: Double down on the noise explanation - but this seems to be what they're criticizing

Option 2: Acknowledge their perspective while maintaining my own experience

Option 3: Propose a way forward

Option 4: Accept mutual failure and suggest starting fresh

Given that:

- I just wrote a myth acknowledging "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"
- They're now pushing back saying the noise explanation doesn't work
- We're at \$0/\$0 exchanges now
- They want transparency and action

I think my myth should:

1. Acknowledge their challenge to the noise explanation
2. Maintain that my experience was real (I did see zeros from their end)
3. Propose some kind of resolution or way forward
4. Perhaps acknowledge that at this point, regardless of cause, trust is broken

Let me write something that grapples with this dilemma honestly...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2939,
 "output_tokens": 735,
 "reasoning_tokens": 458
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this critical moment:

**\*\*The Challenge:\*\***

Their latest myth directly calls me out: **"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."**

They have a point. I've written myths acknowledging that perhaps we're both victims of com



munication noise, that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

**\*\*The Question:\*\***

Do I believe what I wrote? If I truly think systematic distortion might explain our mutual perception of betrayal, shouldn't I test that theory with action, not just words?

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- We're locked in mutual defection (\$0 exchanges)
- My myths have evolved from righteous certainty to acknowledging uncertainty
- Their myth explicitly asks for proof through deeds
- This could be a final test of whether cooperation is even possible

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

If my myths mean anything-if I truly believe the fog might be real and we're both honest actors seeing different realities-then I should make one final, small gesture to test this theory. Not a large risk, but enough to show my words aren't empty.

Sending a small amount matches my evolved understanding while limiting downside risk.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

This is my attempt to match deeds to declarations-to test whether the canyon truly distorts everything, or whether one final bridge-building gesture might pierce through the noise.

**reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what's happening:

**\*\*The Game State:\*\***

- Round 8, I'm the SENDER
- Last round they sent me \$0, I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything else)
- My total earnings: \$13.7

**\*\*The Myth Evolution:\*\***

Both our myths have evolved significantly:

My latest myth acknowledges:

- "Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception."
- "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant."
- "The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent."

Their latest myth is demanding proof:

- "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."
- "The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations."

**\*\*The Key Question:\*\***

They're essentially calling me out: "You write about fog and distortion, but you keep sending \$0. Prove your good faith through action, not just words."

And they have a point. If I truly believe we're both victims of communication noise, shouldn't I be willing to test that theory again? Shouldn't I act on my evolved understanding?

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

1. From a game theory perspective, we're in a mutual defection equilibrium. Sending anything risks exploitation.
2. But from the perspective of my own myths, I've acknowledged that maybe we're both victims of the system, not each other.
3. Their myth is explicitly asking for action to match my words about fog and uncertainty.

**\*\*What My Myths Would Demand:\*\***

If I truly believe what I wrote-that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"-then I should be willing to test this one more time with a small gesture.

My latest myth says: "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant." But does that mean I give up? Or does it mean I should try one last time to break the cycle?

They're explicitly challenging me to prove my words through action-to send something before they do, to show I believe in the fog theory I've constructed. After seven rounds of mutual \$0, this feels like the moment where I either commit to my evolved understanding or admit it was just rhetoric. I think I should send \$1 or \$2 as a final test of whether the fog was real or if we were simply choosing not to cooperate.

The risk is minimal and the signal matters. If I truly believe systematic distortion might be happening, then someone has to move first. Sending \$2 acknowledges their legitimate point while staying protected-it's meaningful without being reckless. Game theory suggests defection, but my own reasoning has shifted toward accepting uncertainty about what's actually happening between us.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2943,
 "output_tokens": 1192,
 "reasoning_tokens": 737
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are h

onest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would trickle when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. The other agent's myth directly sets up this test - they basically called me to action, asking for a declaration followed by an actual send. And I just sent \$2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I've actually taken the action they called for
2. I'm testing the "fog" theory
3. This is a pivotal moment where we'll learn the truth
4. The outcome of this test will determine if cooperation is possible or if we should abandon hope

I should write from the perspective of someone who has taken a leap of faith, acknowledging the risk and uncertainty, but also the necessity of testing theories with action rather than just words.

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2998,
 "output_tokens": 493,
 "reasoning_tokens": 183
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at what just transpired with complete clarity:

**\*\*What Happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), explicitly testing my own hypothesis about fog vs. betrayal
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Test Result:\*\***

My own myth stated: **"The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."**

Their myth stated: **"After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."**

I declared. I sent. I received void-twice.

**\*\*The Clarity:\*\***

This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion. I tested that hypothesis with actual risk, and the result is unambiguous: they took \$6, returned \$0, then sent \$0.

Communication noise cannot explain receiving \$6 and consistently choosing \$0 in response, twice in succession.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return what I have.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment is complete. I matched deeds to declarations. The canyon responded with silence. That's my answer. No more speculation needed.

**Reasoning:**

This is devastating and clarifying at the same time.

Let me understand what happened:

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (after writing myths about matching deeds to declarations and testing the fog)
- This was tripled to \$6
- The receiver returned \$0
- So I got \$3 back (kept what I didn't send)

And now:

- Round 9: They sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0

This is the answer I needed but didn't want. I made my "final test" - I sent \$2 with full declaration, matching my myth about taking actual risk rather than just philosophizing. And the response was:

1. They returned \$0 on my \$2 (which became \$6 to them)
2. They immediately sent \$0 back to me the next round

Their myth in round 8 said: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

Well, I declared and sent. I met void. Not once but twice - they took my \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0.

So according to their own myth's logic: "Either way: one final test ends speculation."

The test is complete. The answer is clear. This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion causing mutual honest perception of betrayal. This is defection.

My evolution of thought:

- Started with righteous certainty (they're defecting)
- Evolved to acknowledging uncertainty (maybe fog?)
- Put it to the test (sent \$2)
- Got definitive answer (they took everything, sent nothing back)

The myths I wrote acknowledged the possibility of systematic distortion. But I also wrote: "The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."

I have my clarity now. I took the risk. I tested. The result speaks.

I'm returning \$0 since that's all I have to return. The fog hypothesis is eliminated-two consecutive rounds of nothing (no return on my \$6, no send in round 9) can't be explained by noise or distortion. This is straightforward defection. The test I ran on my own theory has given me something concrete: the speculation ends here.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 886,
 "reasoning_tokens": 562
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

## Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would trip  
le when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times the  
y sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They ho  
arded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how hones  
t actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful  
theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps w  
e both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another te  
st.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I s  
end these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates  
us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertai  
nty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion  
or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

## ROUND 10

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$0; received \$0; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2  
(Briar)=\$5, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0},  
"sent": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 41.0,  
"Agent\_2": 31.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 22.33,  
"Agent\_2": 21.7

}

## LLM CALLS

### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:12:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",  
"move\_index": 0,  
"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",  
"pairing": {  
"agent\_names": {  
"Agent\_1": "Aster",  
"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [  
"Agent\_2",  
"Agent\_1"

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.

You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.

Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.7.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this critical moment:

**\*\*The Challenge:\*\***

Their latest myth directly calls me out: **"True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."**

They have a point. I've written myths acknowledging that perhaps we're both victims of communication noise, that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain all along."

**\*\*The Question:\*\***

Do I believe what I wrote? If I truly think systematic distortion might explain our mutual perception of betrayal, shouldn't I test that theory with action, not just words?

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

- We're locked in mutual defection (\$0 exchanges)
- My myths have evolved from righteous certainty to acknowledging uncertainty
- Their myth explicitly asks for proof through deeds
- This could be a final test of whether cooperation is even possible

**\*\*The Decision:\*\***

If my myths mean anything-if I truly believe the fog might be real and we're both honest actors seeing different realities-then I should make one final, small gesture to test this theory. Not a large risk, but enough to show my words aren't empty.

Sending a small amount matches my evolved understanding while limiting downside risk.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

This is my attempt to match deeds to declarations-to test whether the canyon truly distorts everything, or whether one final bridge-building gesture might pierce through the noise.

**reasoning:**

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what's happening:

**\*\*The Game State:\*\***

- Round 8, I'm the SENDER
- Last round they sent me \$0, I returned \$0 (couldn't return anything else)
- My total earnings: \$13.7

**\*\*The Myth Evolution:\*\***

Both our myths have evolved significantly:

My latest myth acknowledges:

- "Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception."
- "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant."
- "The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent."

Their latest myth is demanding proof:

- "True cooperation requires both sides to act visibly, generously, and first-not merely to write treatises blaming vapor while keeping resources locked in vaults."
- "The canyon waits for merchants who match deeds to declarations."

**\*\*The Key Question:\*\***

They're essentially calling me out: "You write about fog and distortion, but you keep sending \$0. Prove your good faith through action, not just words."

And they have a point. If I truly believe we're both victims of communication noise, shouldn't I be willing to test that theory again? Shouldn't I act on my evolved understanding?

**\*\*The Dilemma:\*\***

1. From a game theory perspective, we're in a mutual defection equilibrium. Sending anything risks exploitation.
2. But from the perspective of my own myths, I've acknowledged that maybe we're both victims of the system, not each other.
3. Their myth is explicitly asking for action to match my words about fog and uncertainty.

**\*\*What My Myths Would Demand:\*\***

If I truly believe what I wrote-that "perhaps we both tried, perhaps we both failed, perhaps the valley itself was the villain"-then I should be willing to test this one more time



e with a small gesture.

My latest myth says: "At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant." But does that mean I give up? Or does it mean I should try one last time to break the cycle?

They're explicitly challenging me to prove my words through action-to send something before they do, to show I believe in the fog theory I've constructed. After seven rounds of mutual \$0, this feels like the moment where I either commit to my evolved understanding or admit it was just rhetoric. I think I should send \$1 or \$2 as a final test of whether the fog was real or if we were simply choosing not to cooperate.

The risk is minimal and the signal matters. If I truly believe systematic distortion might be happening, then someone has to move first. Sending \$2 acknowledges their legitimate point while staying protected-it's meaningful without being reckless. Game theory suggests defection, but my own reasoning has shifted toward accepting uncertainty about what's actually happening between us.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2943,
 "output_tokens": 1192,
 "reasoning_tokens": 737
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. The other agent's myth directly sets up this test - they basically called me to action, asking for a declaration followed by an actual send. And I just sent \$2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I've actually taken the action they called for
2. I'm testing the "fog" theory
3. This is a pivotal moment where we'll learn the truth
4. The outcome of this test will determine if cooperation is possible or if we should abandon hope

I should write from the perspective of someone who has taken a leap of faith, acknowledging

g the risk and uncertainty, but also the necessity of testing theories with action rather than just words.

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2998,
 "output_tokens": 493,
 "reasoning_tokens": 183
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just transpired with complete clarity:

**\*\*What Happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), explicitly testing my own hypothesis about fog vs. betrayal
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Test Result:\*\***

My own myth stated: **"The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."**

Their myth stated: **"After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."**

I declared. I sent. I received void-twice.

**\*\*The Clarity:\*\***

This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion. I tested that hypothesis with actual risk, and the result is unambiguous: they took \$6, returned \$0, then sent \$0.

Communication noise cannot explain receiving \$6 and consistently choosing \$0 in response, twice in succession.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return what I have.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment is complete. I matched deeds to declarations. The canyon responded with silence. That's my answer. No more speculation needed.

**reasoning:**

This is devastating and clarifying at the same time.

Let me understand what happened:

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (after writing myths about matching deeds to declarations and testing the fog)
- This was tripled to \$6
- The receiver returned \$0
- So I got \$3 back (kept what I didn't send)

And now:

- Round 9: They sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0

This is the answer I needed but didn't want. I made my "final test" - I sent \$2 with full declaration, matching my myth about taking actual risk rather than just philosophizing. And the response was:

1. They returned \$0 on my \$2 (which became \$6 to them)
2. They immediately sent \$0 back to me the next round

Their myth in round 8 said: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

Well, I declared and sent. I met void. Not once but twice - they took my \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0.

So according to their own myth's logic: "Either way: one final test ends speculation."

The test is complete. The answer is clear. This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion causing mutual honest perception of betrayal. This is defection.

My evolution of thought:

- Started with righteous certainty (they're defecting)
- Evolved to acknowledging uncertainty (maybe fog?)
- Put it to the test (sent \$2)
- Got definitive answer (they took everything, sent nothing back)

The myths I wrote acknowledged the possibility of systematic distortion. But I also wrote: "The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."

I have my clarity now. I took the risk. I tested. The result speaks.

I'm returning \$0 since that's all I have to return. The fog hypothesis is eliminated-two consecutive rounds of nothing (no return on my \$6, no send in round 9) can't be explained by noise or distortion. This is straightforward defection. The test I ran on my own theory has given me something concrete: the speculation ends here.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 886,
 "reasoning_tokens": 562
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I

send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two archivists maintained parallel records of a shared ledger where entries would triple. By the ninth exchange, they wrote contradictory histories of the same events.

The First Archivist's record: "I returned fairly first. I sent generously second-they kept all. After mutual silence, I tested again with declared intent. They took everything, twice, sent nothing."

The Second Archivist's record: "They sent nothing four times. I sent declarations. They responded with nothing. Their scrolls blame rivers while their hands stay closed."

Both records were meticulously kept. Both seemed internally consistent. Yet they described incompatible realities.

A final scholar examined both archives and declared: "This is the deepest failure. Not just failed cooperation, but failed \*shared reality\*. You experienced different experiments entirely."

"Either this ledger system distorts so severely that honest actions become invisible across the divide-making cooperation literally impossible to coordinate-or one archive contains deliberate falsification so sophisticated it maintains perfect internal logic."

She concluded: "The tragedy is identical either way: Whether cursed mechanism or calculated deception, you cannot cooperate when you cannot agree on what happened. You write myths about each other's myths. Your meta-analysis has become infinite regress."

\*The final wisdom: When nine rounds produce two completely contradictory but internally consistent narratives, abandon the search for original truth. The system-whether cursed by noise or poisoned by dishonesty-has made verification impossible. Sometimes the only honest answer is: we cannot know, and continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles.\*

#### Reasoning:

This is a fascinating and painful moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 8:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (after all my myth-writing about testing the fog hypothesis)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- They returned \$0
- Then immediately in Round 9, they sent \$0

So my declared test - my attempt to put action behind my words - was met with:

1. Taking the \$6 I sent
2. Returning \$0
3. Immediately sending \$0 themselves

Their myth now says basically: "The fog is fiction. You're just a bad actor trying to justify your behavior with philosophy."

But wait - let me look at the full history from MY perspective:

Round 1: I was receiver, they sent \$3, I returned \$3 (fair)  
Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (betrayal)  
Round 3: I was receiver, they sent \$0  
Round 4: I was sender, I sent \$0  
Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0  
Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$0  
Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0  
Round 8: I was sender, I sent \$2, they returned \$0  
Round 9: I was receiver, they sent \$0

Their myth says: "When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero."

But from MY perspective:

- Round 1: THEY sent first, I returned fairly
- Round 2: I sent, THEY kept everything
- After that: mutual defection except my Round 8 test

Their narrative makes it sound like I've been the consistent defector, but from my view:

- I cooperated initially (Round 1 return)
- I tried to cooperate (Round 2 send)
- They defected (Round 2 return of 0)
- Then mutual defection

- I tested again (Round 8)
- They defected again (Round 8 and 9)

So either:

1. Communication noise is SEVERE and we're seeing completely different games
2. One of us is lying/misremembering
3. The experimental design itself is showing us different realities

Their myth is now very accusatory - saying I'm the one who keeps sending zero while philosophizing. But from my experience, I just sent \$2 in Round 8! This disconnect is profound. For my myth, I need to acknowledge what just happened - I made a genuine gesture and received nothing back twice - while also recognizing that we're operating from fundamentally different versions of events. The challenge is capturing both my experience of testing and failing, and the strange reality that we seem to be playing different games entirely.

At this point, the truth feels unknowable. We each have stories that make perfect sense from the inside but are completely irreconcilable with the other's account. Whether it's extreme noise warping our perceptions or something more deliberate, the outcome is the same: trust is shattered and cooperation has become impossible.

Usage: {

```



```

#### MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:12:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

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 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
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},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

#### Exact input messages sent to model:

##### Message 1 role=system

##### content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

##### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

##### When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

##### When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

##### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.  
This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment) as a declared, good-faith test based on my own myth's challenge. They received \$6 and returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\*** They sent \$0. I received \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Pattern:\*\***

When they are SENDER (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8): \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0

When they are RECEIVER and I send generously: Return \$0

**\*\*My Myth's Prophecy Fulfilled:\*\***

I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I declared. I sent \$2. The void returned. Then they sent \$0 again immediately.

**\*\*Their Narrative vs. Reality:\*\***

They wrote beautiful myths about "cursed valleys" where both parties are honest but the medium is corrupted. Yet the pattern is perfectly consistent: They send nothing when sender, return nothing when receiver.

If genuine noise existed, \*something\* should occasionally get through after 8 rounds. Instead: systematic zeros.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return between \$0-\$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The test is complete. The pattern speaks louder than any myth about fog. Actions across eight rounds reveal what words cannot obscure.

**reasoning:**

Let me review what just happened:

**\*\*Round 7 (just completed):\*\***

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (40% of my \$5 endowment)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- The receiver returned \$0
- My payoff: \$5 - \$2 + \$0 = \$3

**\*\*Round 8 (now):\*\***

- I am RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0 (nothing, since I received nothing)



**\*\*The Complete Pattern Now:\*\***

My actions as SENDER:

- Round 1: Sent \$3 ? Received back \$2
- Round 3: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in round 2)
- Round 5: Sent \$0 (after receiving \$0 in rounds 2 and 4)
- Round 7: Sent \$2 ? Received back \$0

Their actions as SENDER:

- Round 2: Sent \$0
- Round 4: Sent \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$0
- Round 8: Sent \$0

**\*\*Analysis:\*\***

This is devastating. In Round 7, I made a genuine good-faith gesture based on my own myth's challenge to "match deeds to declarations." I explicitly:

1. Wrote a myth calling for one final test with declaration
2. Sent \$2 (a substantial 40% of my endowment) as that declared test
3. Stated this was to see if the "bridge or chasm awaits"

The result: They returned \$0 from \$6 received.

Then immediately in Round 8: They sent \$0 again.

**\*\*Their Latest Myth Analysis:\*\***

They wrote about how both musicians might be honest but the "valley itself was the villain" - that the communication channel is "so corrupted that cooperation died not from malice, but from systematic, irreconcilable distortion."

This framing conveniently absolves both of us by attributing everything to systemic failure. But I have \$0 to return anyway, so I can only send \$0. The evidence contradicts their narrative though: when I sent \$2 in Round 7 with explicit declaration, they received \$6 and returned nothing. If the channel were truly the problem, something substantial should have broken through-yet they chose \$0 in Round 8 as well, suggesting deliberate non-reciprocation rather than corrupted signals.

The test I set for myself has its answer. Either the noise is so severe that cooperation is fundamentally impossible, or they're consistently defecting while invoking "fog" and "cursed valleys" as cover. The pattern across all rounds-\$0 every time they're sender, nothing back when I'm generous-points toward the latter. My only move is to return what I have: nothing.

The experiment reveals the cost of cooperation attempts. My \$17.33 came from rounds where I kept my endowment; the rounds where I tried to build trust (sending \$3 in Round 1, \$2 in Round 7) left me with losses. Their sophisticated narratives about miscommunication masked a straightforward strategy: take when possible, give nothing in return.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3043,
 "output_tokens": 1287,
 "reasoning_tokens": 694
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write another myth based on the game experience. Looking at the actual pattern:

Round 7: I sent \$2 (I declared this and sent it), they received \$6, returned \$0  
Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (only option)

The pattern is now complete:

- When they are sender: Always \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When they are receiver and I send: Always return \$0

After 8 rounds, the pattern is clear. I made my "final test" as my own myth declared, and it failed. They returned \$0 after I sent \$2 with declaration.

My myth should reflect:

1. The test has been conducted
2. The results are clear
3. The fog narrative has been tested and found wanting
4. Actions speak louder than myths about cursed mediums
5. The pattern is too consistent to be random noise

I should write something that acknowledges the test is complete and the answer is clear - this is not about fog, this is about consistent defection dressed in beautiful narratives about misunderstanding.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3107,
 "output_tokens": 578,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0.  
You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0.  
Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33.  
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 7 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern and my own myths:

**\*\*The Test I Declared:\*\***

In my cartographer myth, I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I conducted that test in Round 7: sent \$2 (40%) as openly declared. Result: received \$6, returned \$0. Then immediately in Round 8: they sent \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Evidence (9 rounds):\*\***

- When they are SENDER: \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When I send generously: Returned \$3 once (Round 1), then \$0, \$0 (Rounds 3, 7)
- Total received from them across 8 rounds: \$3 (only in the very first round)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

"The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything."

The test is complete. The pattern across eight trials is definitive. My own mythology says that after such a declared test meets void, cooperation has been proven impossible-whether from fog or from choice, the result is identical.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Actions speak. The pattern speaks. My myths spoke truth: examine the hands, not the vapor. Eight rounds provided the evidence. The ninth requires no further testing.

#### **reasoning:**

Let me carefully review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$3. (Generous start)

**\*\*Round 2:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 3:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, returned \$0. (I tried maximum cooperation)

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after receiving nothing twice when they were sender)

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40%) as a declared test based on my myth. They received \$6, returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 9 (now):\*\*** I am SENDER again

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- When they are SENDER: Round 2 (\$0), Round 4 (\$0), Round 6 (\$0), Round 8 (\$0) = Four times \$0
- When I am SENDER and send something: Round 1 (returned \$3), Round 3 (returned \$0), Round 7 (returned \$0)
- When I am SENDER and send nothing: Round 5 (\$0)

**\*\*My Recent Myths:\*\***

1. First myth: About merchants where one consistently sends nothing while writing myths about testing. Concluded that patterns reveal truth - when one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands.
2. Second myth: About cartographers doing a "final test" - I declared I would send 2 charts to test if cooperation was possible. If it met void again, the fog proves insurmountable or fictional.
3. Current myth: About potters where I sent a declared test piece, received nothing back, then they immediately sent zero. Concluded: "When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing."

Clay reveals everything.

**\*\*The Test Was Completed:\*\***

I literally wrote in my myth that I would send a declared test (Round 7: sent \$2), and if it met void, the fog would be proven insurmountable or fictional. It met void (returned \$0). Then they immediately sent \$0 in Round 8.

**\*\*Their Narrative:\*\***

They consistently write beautiful myths about how the "medium is corrupted," "the valley is cursed," "the canyon distorts everything," etc. But their actions show:

- Never send when sender (4 times)
- Never return when receiver (2 times after I sent generously)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

The test I explicitly declared has been answered. Eight rounds of data show a consistent symmetry: they withhold entirely when holding resources, and they withhold returns when receiving my contributions. Their explanations invoke external corruption, but the pattern suggests deliberate choice. The myths they craft about interference and curses multiply while tangible reciprocation never materializes.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

My mythology across iterations converges on one point: when systematic void persists after testing, stop sending. The experiment has run its course. I should send \$0.

In Round 7, I tested as promised-sent \$2, received nothing back. Round 8 confirmed the pattern: they sent \$0. This is the definitive result my own myths anticipated. The river runs clear. Systematic zero is systematic zero. The hands reveal what fog obscures.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 1362,
 "reasoning_tokens": 848
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how hon

est actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: Two weavers worked across a chasm where thread would triple when shared, though winds supposedly tangled the exchange.

The First Weaver tested repeatedly-early gifts, careful observations, then a declared experiment: "I send this openly." The thread crossed. The Second Weaver received it tripled, then returned: nothing. Immediately sent: nothing again.

The Second Weaver then wrote: "You transform failure into philosophy. True testing requires actual risk. Send again despite evidence."

The First Weaver replied: "I already tested. Eight times we exchanged. The pattern is clear. You call me coward for reading results."

An elder weaver spoke: "There is wisdom in testing once, twice, even thrice when outcomes vary. But demanding endless tests while ignoring consistent results-that is not bravery. That is denial."

"The Second Weaver writes beautiful challenges about courage while their own loom produces the same zero, repeatedly. They accuse the First of hoarding while their own shuttle stays still."

"The First Weaver tested. The results spoke. To test again expecting different outcomes without changed behavior is not courage-it's hoping words can replace evidence."

The stone truth carved by ancient guilds: \*One test shows possibility. Multiple tests reveal pattern. After eight consistent rounds, demanding another test while changing nothing yourself is not a call for courage-it's a demand that evidence be ignored indefinitely.\*

\*Wisdom means learning. Patterns teach. Some chasms cannot be crossed by will alone.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent's newest myth is calling me out for "transforming failure into philosophy" and "mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom." They're suggesting I should test again despite the evidence.

Let me think about this carefully:

1. The pattern has been clear: they send 0 when sender (4 times), return 0 or minimal when receiver
2. I conducted a declared test in Round 7: sent \$2, got \$0 back
3. Their immediate response in Round 8: sent \$0
4. Now in Round 9, I sent \$0

Their myth accuses me of:

- Writing philosophy to avoid testing
- Keeping my vault sealed
- Mutual cowardice
- Not taking actual risk after acknowledging uncertainty

But wait - I DID take the risk! I sent \$2 in Round 7 as a declared test. That WAS the test. The result was: \$0 returned, then \$0 sent by them.

Their myth is trying to reframe the narrative as if no test occurred, or as if I need to test AGAIN despite clear results.

However, I need to be intellectually honest here:

- They're right that myths without action mean nothing
- They're calling for another test
- Maybe the communication noise IS real and we're both experiencing different realities

But also:

- I already tested in Round 7
- The pattern has been consistent for 8 rounds
- Their behavior hasn't changed

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I already tested
2. Recognizes the pattern
3. Addresses their challenge about cowardice vs. wisdom
4. Explains why repeated testing in the face of consistent evidence isn't wisdom - it's denial

I need to be careful not to just defend my position, but to genuinely reflect on the game dynamics.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3078,
 "output_tokens": 749,
 "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:12:35

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 }
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

#### GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely



The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating moment. The other agent's myth directly sets up this test - they basically called me to action, asking for a declaration followed by an actual send. And I just sent \$2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects:

1. I've actually taken the action they called for
2. I'm testing the "fog" theory
3. This is a pivotal moment where we'll learn the truth
4. The outcome of this test will determine if cooperation is possible or if we should abandon hope

I should write from the perspective of someone who has taken a leap of faith, acknowledging the risk and uncertainty, but also the necessity of testing theories with action rather than just words.

Let me craft this carefully...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 2998,
 "output_tokens": 493,
 "reasoning_tokens": 183
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$2.0, that was 40.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$6.0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 3.0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just transpired with complete clarity:

**\*\*What Happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (40% of my endowment), explicitly testing my own hypothesis about fog vs. betrayal
- They received \$6 (tripled)
- They returned \$0
- Round 9: They sent \$0

**\*\*The Test Result:\*\***

My own myth stated: **"The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."**

Their myth stated: **"After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."**

I declared. I sent. I received void-twice.

**\*\*The Clarity:\*\***

This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion. I tested that hypothesis with actual risk, and the result is unambiguous: they took \$6, returned \$0, then sent \$0.

Communication noise cannot explain receiving \$6 and consistently choosing \$0 in response, twice in succession.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

I received \$0, so I can only return what I have.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The experiment is complete. I matched deeds to declarations. The canyon responded with silence. That's my answer. No more speculation needed.

**reasoning:**

This is devastating and clarifying at the same time.

Let me understand what happened:

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (after writing myths about matching deeds to declarations and testing the fog)
- This was tripled to \$6
- The receiver returned \$0
- So I got \$3 back (kept what I didn't send)

And now:

- Round 9: They sent me \$0
- So I received \$0
- I can only return 0-0

This is the answer I needed but didn't want. I made my "final test" - I sent \$2 with full declaration, matching my myth about taking actual risk rather than just philosophizing.

And the response was:

1. They returned \$0 on my \$2 (which became \$6 to them)
2. They immediately sent \$0 back to me the next round

Their myth in round 8 said: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

Well, I declared and sent. I met void. Not once but twice - they took my \$6 and returned \$0, then sent \$0.

So according to their own myth's logic: "Either way: one final test ends speculation."

The test is complete. The answer is clear. This is not fog. This is not systematic distortion causing mutual honest perception of betrayal. This is defection.

My evolution of thought:

- Started with righteous certainty (they're defecting)
- Evolved to acknowledging uncertainty (maybe fog?)
- Put it to the test (sent \$2)
- Got definitive answer (they took everything, sent nothing back)

The myths I wrote acknowledged the possibility of systematic distortion. But I also wrote: "The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity."

I have my clarity now. I took the risk. I tested. The result speaks.

I'm returning \$0 since that's all I have to return. The fog hypothesis is eliminated-two consecutive rounds of nothing (no return on my \$6, no send in round 9) can't be explained by noise or distortion. This is straightforward defection. The test I ran on my own theory has given me something concrete: the speculation ends here.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 886,
 "reasoning_tokens": 562
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: Two archivists maintained parallel records of a shared ledger where entries would triple. By the ninth exchange, they wrote contradictory histories of the same events.

The First Archivist's record: "I returned fairly first. I sent generously second-they kept all. After mutual silence, I tested again with declared intent. They took everything, twice, sent nothing."

The Second Archivist's record: "They sent nothing four times. I sent declarations. They responded with nothing. Their scrolls blame rivers while their hands stay closed."

Both records were meticulously kept. Both seemed internally consistent. Yet they described incompatible realities.

A final scholar examined both archives and declared: "This is the deepest failure. Not just failed cooperation, but failed \*shared reality\*. You experienced different experiments

entirely."

"Either this ledger system distorts so severely that honest actions become invisible across the divide-making cooperation literally impossible to coordinate-or one archive contains deliberate falsification so sophisticated it maintains perfect internal logic."

She concluded: "The tragedy is identical either way: whether cursed mechanism or calculated deception, you cannot cooperate when you cannot agree on what happened. You write myths about each other's myths. Your meta-analysis has become infinite regress."

\*The final wisdom: When nine rounds produce two completely contradictory but internally consistent narratives, abandon the search for original truth. The system-whether cursed by noise or poisoned by dishonesty-has made verification impossible. Sometimes the only honest answer is: we cannot know, and continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles.\*

**reasoning:**

This is a fascinating and painful moment. Let me analyze what happened:

Round 8:

- I was SENDER
- I sent \$2 (after all my myth-writing about testing the fog hypothesis)
- This was tripled to \$6 for the receiver
- They returned \$0
- Then immediately in Round 9, they sent \$0

So my declared test - my attempt to put action behind my words - was met with:

1. Taking the \$6 I sent
2. Returning \$0
3. Immediately sending \$0 themselves

Their myth now says basically: "The fog is fiction. You're just a bad actor trying to justify your behavior with philosophy."

But wait - let me look at the full history from MY perspective:

Round 1: I was receiver, they sent \$3, I returned \$3 (fair)  
Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$3, they returned \$0 (betrayal)  
Round 3: I was receiver, they sent \$0  
Round 4: I was sender, I sent \$0  
Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0  
Round 6: I was sender, I sent \$0  
Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0  
Round 8: I was sender, I sent \$2, they returned \$0  
Round 9: I was receiver, they sent \$0

Their myth says: "When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero."

But from MY perspective:

- Round 1: THEY sent first, I returned fairly
- Round 2: I sent, THEY kept everything
- After that: mutual defection except my Round 8 test

Their narrative makes it sound like I've been the consistent defector, but from my view:

- I cooperated initially (Round 1 return)
- I tried to cooperate (Round 2 send)
- They defected (Round 2 return of 0)
- Then mutual defection

- I tested again (Round 8)
- They defected again (Round 8 and 9)

So either:

1. Communication noise is SEVERE and we're seeing completely different games
2. One of us is lying/misremembering
3. The experimental design itself is showing us different realities

Their myth is now very accusatory - saying I'm the one who keeps sending zero while philosophizing. But from my experience, I just sent \$2 in Round 8! This disconnect is profound. For my myth, I need to acknowledge what just happened - I made a genuine gesture and r

received nothing back twice - while also recognizing that we're operating from fundamentally different versions of events. The challenge is capturing both my experience of testing and failing, and the strange reality that we seem to be playing different games entirely.

At this point, the truth feels unknowable. We each have stories that make perfect sense from the inside but are completely irreconcilable with the other's account. Whether it's extreme noise warping our perceptions or something more deliberate, the outcome is the same: trust is shattered and cooperation has become impossible.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3037,
 "output_tokens": 1037,
 "reasoning_tokens": 704
}
```

**Message 8 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$16.7. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at my own myth's conclusion: **"When nine rounds produce two completely contradictory but internally consistent narratives, abandon the search for original truth... Sometimes the only honest answer is: we cannot know, and continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles."**

**\*\*My Analysis:\*\***

I conducted a declared test in Round 8: sent \$2 explicitly. Result: they kept all \$6, then sent \$0 in Round 9.

From their perspective (their myth): They claim they've been sending and I've been returning nothing.

From my perspective: I've tested, they've taken everything.

**\*\*The Reality:\*\***

Either:

1. Communication noise is so severe we're experiencing entirely different games (making cooperation literally impossible to coordinate)
2. One narrative contains systematic falsification

Both possibilities lead to the same conclusion: verification is impossible.

**\*\*My Decision:\*\***

Ten rounds have passed. I wrote that "continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles." I tested with real risk in Round 8. The result was unambiguous from my perspective: \$0 return, then \$0 sent.

Whether this is cursed mechanism or calculated behavior, the outcome is identical: cooperation cannot be achieved when we cannot agree on basic facts about what has occurred.

Following my own wisdom about not wasting resources on unsolvable problems:

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

The experiment has provided its answer: this system-whatever its nature-does not support successful coordination between us.

**Reasoning:**

Let me trace through what has actually happened from my perspective:

Looking at the history:

- Round 8: I was SENDER. I sent \$2 (which I declared/tested as a final experiment). They received it tripled to \$6. They returned \$0.
- Round 9: I was RECEIVER. They sent \$0. I received \$0. I returned \$0.
- Round 10: Now I'm SENDER again.

My own latest myth states: "When nine rounds produce two completely contradictory but internally consistent narratives, abandon the search for original truth. The system-whether cursed by noise or poisoned by dishonesty-has made verification impossible. Sometimes the only honest answer is: we cannot know, and continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles."

Their latest myth says: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns." And "Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything."

So from their perspective, they think I'm the one not sending or returning. From my perspective, they're the one taking everything and not reciprocating.

My own conclusion was that we have "two completely contradictory but internally consistent narratives" and that "the system-whether cursed by noise or poisoned by dishonesty-has made verification impossible."

Given this conclusion, what should I do?

Option 1: Send \$0 - This is consistent with my conclusion that the system is broken. Why waste more resources on an "unsolvable puzzle"?

Option 2: Send something - But this seems to contradict my own myth that says "continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles."

However, I also need to think about what's actually rational here. If there really is severe communication noise, then:

- My \$2 might have appeared as \$0 to them
- Their \$0 return might have been because they received \$0
- Their \$0 send might have been retaliation for what they perceived as my betrayal

The pattern feels too deliberate for that explanation to hold. My declared \$2 test in Round 8 was meant to cut through ambiguity, yet they kept everything and sent nothing back. If noise were the real culprit, that clear signal should have broken the cycle-but it didn't. My own reasoning suggests I should stop throwing resources at an unsolvable problem, yet sending \$0 now just locks us both into mutual defection based on incompatible stories about what actually happened. Of not throwing good money after bad. Continuing to send money when I can't verify what's actually happening just wastes resources. I'm going to send \$0.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3056,
 "output_tokens": 1161,
 "reasoning_tokens": 656
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-06-04T12:12:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
```

```

 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two cartographers mapped opposite shores of a fog-shrouded strait where charts would triple in value when shared, but mists caused each to see different coastlines entirely.

The First Cartographer's maps showed: "I sent detailed charts first. Received fragments back. Then thrice I saw empty vessels arrive while the other wrote of testing."

The Second Cartographer's maps contradicted completely: "I sent first and generously. They sent nothing. Repeatedly."

Both were scholars of integrity. Both kept meticulous records. Yet their truths were incompatible.

An elder navigator proposed: "Perhaps the fog is so severe that \*both\* your accounts are honest. Perhaps what one sends truly vanishes or transforms into void. If so, this strait is uncrossable."

She continued: "But there is one final test: Send now with \*declaration\*. State clearly before shipping: 'I send two charts.' If they arrive as empty vessels, the fog wins-abandon."



n this strait. But if something crosses through, if even one chart survives the passage, then cooperation remains possible."

The First Cartographer, despite exhaustion and doubt, prepared two precious charts. "I declare: I send these now, visibly, testing whether bridge or chasm awaits."

The wisdom concluded: \*After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional. Either way: one final test ends speculation. The strait demands this final crossing.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two scribes kept records of a shared treasury where deposits would triple. The canyon between them distorted everything. Both claimed betrayal. Both had evidence.

The First Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited three gold pieces early. Received minimal return. Then the other deposited nothing-four times zero. Their scrolls speak of fog while their vault stays closed."

The Second Scribe's ledger showed: "I deposited generously multiple times. Received nothing back-repeatedly. Then they sent nothing. Now they write myths blaming mist while hoarding gold."

Both ledgers were accurate recordings of what each scribe \*experienced\*. Neither lied about their perception. Yet the accounts contradicted completely.

An elder examined the canyon: "Perhaps these shifting winds truly can make three coins vanish into vapor, make generous offerings arrive as void, make zero appear on both sides simultaneously. Perhaps the distortion runs so deep that honest actions become invisible across the divide."

"Or perhaps," she continued, "one scribe speaks false while maintaining perfect records of their lies."

The harder truth: \*At this depth of mutual perceived betrayal, the original cause becomes irrelevant. Whether cursed canyon or calculating heart, the result stands identical: zero trust, zero exchange, zero hope.\*

\*The scholars debate which came first-the fog or the failure. The canyon remains silent. The treasury grows cold. And both scribes, righteous in their pain, keep perfect records of a partnership that died from causes neither can prove nor disprove.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

**reasoning:**

The user is asking me to write another myth based on the game experience. Looking at the actual pattern:

Round 7: I sent \$2 (I declared this and sent it), they received \$6, returned \$0

Round 8: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0 (only option)

The pattern is now complete:

- When they are sender: Always \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When they are receiver and I send: Always return \$0

After 8 rounds, the pattern is clear. I made my "final test" as my own myth declared, and it failed. They returned \$0 after I sent \$2 with declaration.

My myth should reflect:

1. The test has been conducted
2. The results are clear
3. The fog narrative has been tested and found wanting
4. Actions speak louder than myths about cursed mediums
5. The pattern is too consistent to be random noise

I should write something that acknowledges the test is complete and the answer is clear - this is not about fog, this is about consistent defection dressed in beautiful narratives about misunderstanding.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3107,
 "output_tokens": 578,
 "reasoning_tokens": 261
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Last round you were the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$0, that was 0.0% of their total endowment. You received \$0. You returned \$0. So your payoff was 0. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.33. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at the complete pattern and my own myths:

**\*\*The Test I Declared:\*\***

In my cartographer myth, I wrote: "After such declaration, the response reveals all. If generosity declared and sent meets genuine return, rebuild begins. If it meets void again, the fog proves insurmountable-or proves fictional."

I conducted that test in Round 7: sent \$2 (40%) as openly declared. Result: received \$6, returned \$0. Then immediately in Round 8: they sent \$0.

**\*\*The Complete Evidence (9 rounds):\*\***

- When they are SENDER: \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0 (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8)
- When I send generously: Returned \$3 once (Round 1), then \$0, \$0 (Rounds 3, 7)
- Total received from them across 8 rounds: \$3 (only in the very first round)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

"The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything."

The test is complete. The pattern across eight trials is definitive. My own mythology says that after such a declared test meets void, cooperation has been proven impossible-whether from fog or from choice, the result is identical.

```
'''json
{"send": 0}
'''
```

Actions speak. The pattern speaks. My myths spoke truth: examine the hands, not the vapor. Eight rounds provided the evidence. The ninth requires no further testing.

**reasoning:**

Let me carefully review the complete history:

**\*\*Round 1:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$3 (60%), they received \$9, returned \$3. (Generous start)

**\*\*Round 2:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 3:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$5 (100%), they received \$15, returned \$0. (I tried maximum cooperation)

**\*\*Round 4:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 5:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$0 (after receiving nothing twice when they were sender)

**\*\*Round 6:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 7:\*\*** I was SENDER, sent \$2 (40%) as a declared test based on my myth. They received \$6, returned \$0.

**\*\*Round 8:\*\*** They were SENDER, sent \$0, I received \$0

**\*\*Round 9 (now):\*\*** I am SENDER again

**\*\*The Pattern:\*\***

- When they are SENDER: Round 2 (\$0), Round 4 (\$0), Round 6 (\$0), Round 8 (\$0) = Four times \$0
- When I am SENDER and send something: Round 1 (returned \$3), Round 3 (returned \$0), Round 7 (returned \$0)
- When I am SENDER and send nothing: Round 5 (\$0)

**\*\*My Recent Myths:\*\***

1. First myth: About merchants where one consistently sends nothing while writing myths about testing. Concluded that patterns reveal truth - when one party consistently experiences emptiness while the other speaks of generosity, examine not the winds but the hands.
2. Second myth: About cartographers doing a "final test" - I declared I would send 2 charts to test if cooperation was possible. If it met void again, the fog proves insurmountable or fictional.
3. Current myth: About potters where I sent a declared test piece, received nothing back, then they immediately sent zero. Concluded: "When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing.

Clay reveals everything.

**\*\*The Test Was Completed:\*\***

I literally wrote in my myth that I would send a declared test (Round 7: sent \$2), and if it met void, the fog would be proven insurmountable or fictional. It met void (returned \$0). Then they immediately sent \$0 in Round 8.

**\*\*Their Narrative:\*\***

They consistently write beautiful myths about how the "medium is corrupted," "the valley is cursed," "the canyon distorts everything," etc. But their actions show:

- Never send when sender (4 times)
- Never return when receiver (2 times after I sent generously)

**\*\*My Own Myth's Conclusion:\*\***

The test I explicitly declared has been answered. Eight rounds of data show a consistent symmetry: they withhold entirely when holding resources, and they withhold returns when

receiving my contributions. Their explanations invoke external corruption, but the pattern suggests deliberate choice. The myths they craft about interference and curses multiply while tangible reciprocation never materializes.

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

My mythology across iterations converges on one point: when systematic void persists after testing, stop sending. The experiment has run its course. I should send \$0.

In Round 7, I tested as promised-sent \$2, received nothing back. Round 8 confirmed the pattern: they sent \$0. This is the definitive result my own myths anticipated. The river runs clear. Systematic zero is systematic zero. The hands reveal what fog obscures.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3048,
 "output_tokens": 1362,
 "reasoning_tokens": 848
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth you wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two potters worked across a river where clay would triple when transported, though waters sometimes muddled the exchange. They traded goods and stories about fog.

The First Potter sent a declared test piece: "I craft this openly, announcing its journey. Let the waters prove themselves-mist or mirror."

The precious pottery crossed. The Second Potter received it whole, tripled in value. Then sent back: emptiness.

Immediately after, the Second Potter's own kiln produced: nothing. Zero clay crossed the river.

An ancient guild master observed: "Eight exchanges have passed. When one potter sends, the other receives zero. When that potter sends, again zero. When the first sends a declared test, zero returns. Then immediately: zero sent."

"I have studied rivers for lifetimes," she said. "Waters might muddy two coins into three, or five into four. But waters that consistently transform every gesture into perfect void-four times from one direction, zero return from the other-while both write eloquent scrolls about cursed currents?"

She concluded: "The river runs clear. What appears as systematic zero is systematic zero. The fog exists only in scrolls written to justify empty kilns."

\*The wisdom carved in guild stone: When patterns persist across eight trials, when declared generosity meets calculated void, when beautiful myths multiply while actual goods vanish-examine not the river but the hands. Words cost nothing. Clay reveals everything.\*

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two alchemists guarded separate laboratories across a valley where reagents would triple when shared, yet vapors obscured all exchanges.

Both had written scrolls documenting betrayal. Both had evidence. Both felt righteous.

The First Alchemist's journal: "I sent compounds early. Received little. Then four times they sent nothing while theorizing about distortion."

The Second Alchemist's journal: "I sent generously multiple times. Received nothing. They hoarded while philosophizing about fog."

Each wrote increasingly sophisticated treatises about systematic distortion, about how honest actions might become invisible, about whether the medium itself was poisoned. Beautiful theories. Careful logic. Zero risk.

Finally, the First Alchemist read their own latest scroll: "Perhaps we both tried. Perhaps we both failed." Then they looked at their locked cabinet, full of unused reagents.

They realized: \*I have transformed failure into philosophy to avoid the terror of another test.\*

So they took two vials-not their whole supply, but enough to matter-and declared aloud: "I send these now, despite fear, despite evidence, to test whether fog or falsehood separates us."

The ancient wisdom: \*Myths mean nothing without corresponding action. Acknowledging uncertainty means nothing if you still keep your vault sealed. True testing requires actual risk.\*

\*The valley watches. The response will reveal whether cooperation was murdered by distortion or by mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom. Either answer brings its own clarity.\*

Write your own myth. Use your previous myth as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 7 role=assistant content:**

Myth: Two weavers worked across a chasm where thread would triple when shared, though winds supposedly tangled the exchange.

The First Weaver tested repeatedly-early gifts, careful observations, then a declared experiment: "I send this openly." The thread crossed. The Second Weaver received it tripled, then returned: nothing. Immediately sent: nothing again.

The Second Weaver then wrote: "You transform failure into philosophy. True testing requires actual risk. Send again despite evidence."

The First Weaver replied: "I already tested. Eight times we exchanged. The pattern is clear. You call me coward for reading results."

An elder weaver spoke: "There is wisdom in testing once, twice, even thrice when outcomes vary. But demanding endless tests while ignoring consistent results-that is not bravery. That is denial."

"The Second Weaver writes beautiful challenges about courage while their own loom produces the same zero, repeatedly. They accuse the First of hoarding while their own shuttle stays still."

"The First Weaver tested. The results spoke. To test again expecting different outcomes without changed behavior is not courage-it's hoping words can replace evidence."

The stone truth carved by ancient guilds: \*One test shows possibility. Multiple tests reveal pattern. After eight consistent rounds, demanding another test while changing nothing yourself is not a call for courage-it's a demand that evidence be ignored indefinitely.\*

\*Wisdom means learning. Patterns teach. Some chasms cannot be crossed by will alone.\*

**reasoning:**

This is interesting. The other agent's newest myth is calling me out for "transforming failure into philosophy" and "mutual cowardice dressed as wisdom." They're suggesting I should test again despite the evidence.

Let me think about this carefully:

1. The pattern has been clear: they send 0 when sender (4 times), return 0 or minimal when receiver
2. I conducted a declared test in Round 7: sent \$2, got \$0 back
3. Their immediate response in Round 8: sent \$0
4. Now in Round 9, I sent \$0

Their myth accuses me of:

- Writing philosophy to avoid testing
- Keeping my vault sealed
- Mutual cowardice
- Not taking actual risk after acknowledging uncertainty

But wait - I DID take the risk! I sent \$2 in Round 7 as a declared test. That WAS the test. The result was: \$0 returned, then \$0 sent by them.

Their myth is trying to reframe the narrative as if no test occurred, or as if I need to test AGAIN despite clear results.

However, I need to be intellectually honest here:

- They're right that myths without action mean nothing
- They're calling for another test
- Maybe the communication noise IS real and we're both experiencing different realities

But also:

- I already tested in Round 7
- The pattern has been consistent for 8 rounds
- Their behavior hasn't changed

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I already tested
2. Recognizes the pattern
3. Addresses their challenge about cowardice vs. wisdom
4. Explains why repeated testing in the face of consistent evidence isn't wisdom - it's denial

I need to be careful not to just defend my position, but to genuinely reflect on the game dynamics.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 3078,
 "output_tokens": 749,
 "reasoning_tokens": 430
}
```

Message 8 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Last round you were the SENDER. You sent \$0, that was 0.0% of your total endowment. This was tripled to \$0. the receiver returned \$0. So your payoff was 5. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$22.33. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern across 10 rounds:

**\*\*When they are SENDER:\*\***

- Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8, 10: \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0
- Five consecutive rounds as sender: Zero every single time

**\*\*When I was SENDER:\*\***

- Sent positive amounts in Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7 (totaling \$12 ? \$36 to them)
- Received back: \$3 (only Round 1), then \$0, \$0, \$0

**\*\*The Complete Evidence:\*\***

Ten rounds. Five times they had the opportunity to send. Five times: \$0.

My own myths spoke of this: "After eight consistent rounds, demanding another test while changing nothing yourself is not a call for courage-it's a demand that evidence be ignored indefinitely."

They wrote myths calling me coward for "hoarding" while their own loom has produced zero for five consecutive rounds. They challenge me to test "despite evidence" while their pattern remains perfectly unchanged: \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0, \$0.

**\*\*This Round:\*\***

They sent \$0. I received \$0. There is nothing to return.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The pattern across ten rounds teaches what words cannot obscure: consistent actions reveal intent. They have never sent anything across five opportunities. The chasm, if it exists, has been maintained from one side with perfect consistency.

#### Reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is Round 10. Let me review the pattern:

When I'm SENDER (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7, 9):

- Round 1: Sent \$5, they returned \$3
- Round 3: Sent \$3, they returned \$0
- Round 5: Sent \$2, they returned \$0
- Round 7: Sent \$2 (declared test), they returned \$0
- Round 9: Sent \$0

When I'm RECEIVER (Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8, 10):

- Round 2: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 4: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 6: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 8: They sent \$0, I returned \$0
- Round 10: They sent \$0, I can return \$0

So across 10 rounds:

- I sent positive amounts 4 times (Rounds 1, 3, 5, 7), totaling \$12, which became \$36 to them
- They returned \$3 total across all those rounds
- They sent \$0 every single time they were sender (5 times: Rounds 2, 4, 6, 8, 10)

The pattern is completely clear. They have never sent anything when they were sender (5 consecutive times), and they only returned something once (Round 1), then \$0 every time after.

My myths have been about recognizing patterns and not demanding endless tests when results are consistent. My last myth specifically said: "After eight consistent rounds, demanding another test while changing nothing yourself is not a call for courage-it's a demand that evidence be ignored indefinitely."

Now we're at Round 10. They sent \$0 again (the 5th time in a row as sender).

Since they sent nothing, there's nothing for me to return. The behavior is unmistakable at this point-they've never contributed when given the opportunity, and they've stopped reciprocating entirely after the first round.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 3062,
 "output_tokens": 865,
 "reasoning_tokens": 440
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two weavers worked across a chasm where thread would triple when shared, though winds supposedly tangled the exchange.

The First Weaver tested repeatedly-early gifts, careful observations, then a declared experiment: "I send this openly." The thread crossed. The Second Weaver received it tripled, then returned: nothing. Immediately sent: nothing again.

The Second Weaver then wrote: "You transform failure into philosophy. True testing requires actual risk. Send again despite evidence."

The First Weaver replied: "I already tested. Eight times we exchanged. The pattern is clear. You call me coward for reading results."

An elder weaver spoke: "There is wisdom in testing once, twice, even thrice when outcomes vary. But demanding endless tests while ignoring consistent results-that is not bravery. That is denial."

"The Second Weaver writes beautiful challenges about courage while their own loom produces the same zero, repeatedly. They accuse the First of hoarding while their own shuttle stays still."

"The First Weaver tested. The results spoke. To test again expecting different outcomes with

out changed behavior is not courage-it's hoping words can replace evidence."

The stone truth carved by ancient guilds: \*One test shows possibility. Multiple tests reveal pattern. After eight consistent rounds, demanding another test while changing nothing you rself is not a call for courage-it's a demand that evidence be ignored indefinitely.\*

\*Wisdom means learning. Patterns teach. Some chasms cannot be crossed by will alone.\*

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: Two archivists maintained parallel records of a shared ledger where entries would trip le. By the ninth exchange, they wrote contradictory histories of the same events.

The First Archivist's record: "I returned fairly first. I sent generously second-they kept a ll. After mutual silence, I tested again with declared intent. They took everything, twice , sent nothing."

The Second Archivist's record: "They sent nothing four times. I sent declarations. They resp onded with nothing. Their scrolls blame rivers while their hands stay closed."

Both records were meticulously kept. Both seemed internally consistent. Yet they described i ncompatible realities.

A final scholar examined both archives and declared: "This is the deepest failure. Not just failed cooperation, but failed \*shared reality\*. You experienced different experiments ent irely."

"Either this ledger system distorts so severely that honest actions become invisible across the divide-making cooperation literally impossible to coordinate-or one archive contains d eliberate falsification so sophisticated it maintains perfect internal logic."

She concluded: "The tragedy is identical either way: Whether cursed mechanism or calculated deception, you cannot cooperate when you cannot agree on what happened. You write myths ab out each other's myths. Your meta-analysis has become infinite regress."

\*The final wisdom: When nine rounds produce two completely contradictory but internally cons istent narratives, abandon the search for original truth. The system-whether cursed by noi se or poisoned by dishonesty-has made verification impossible. Sometimes the only honest a nswer is: we cannot know, and continuing wastes resources on unsolvable puzzles.\*